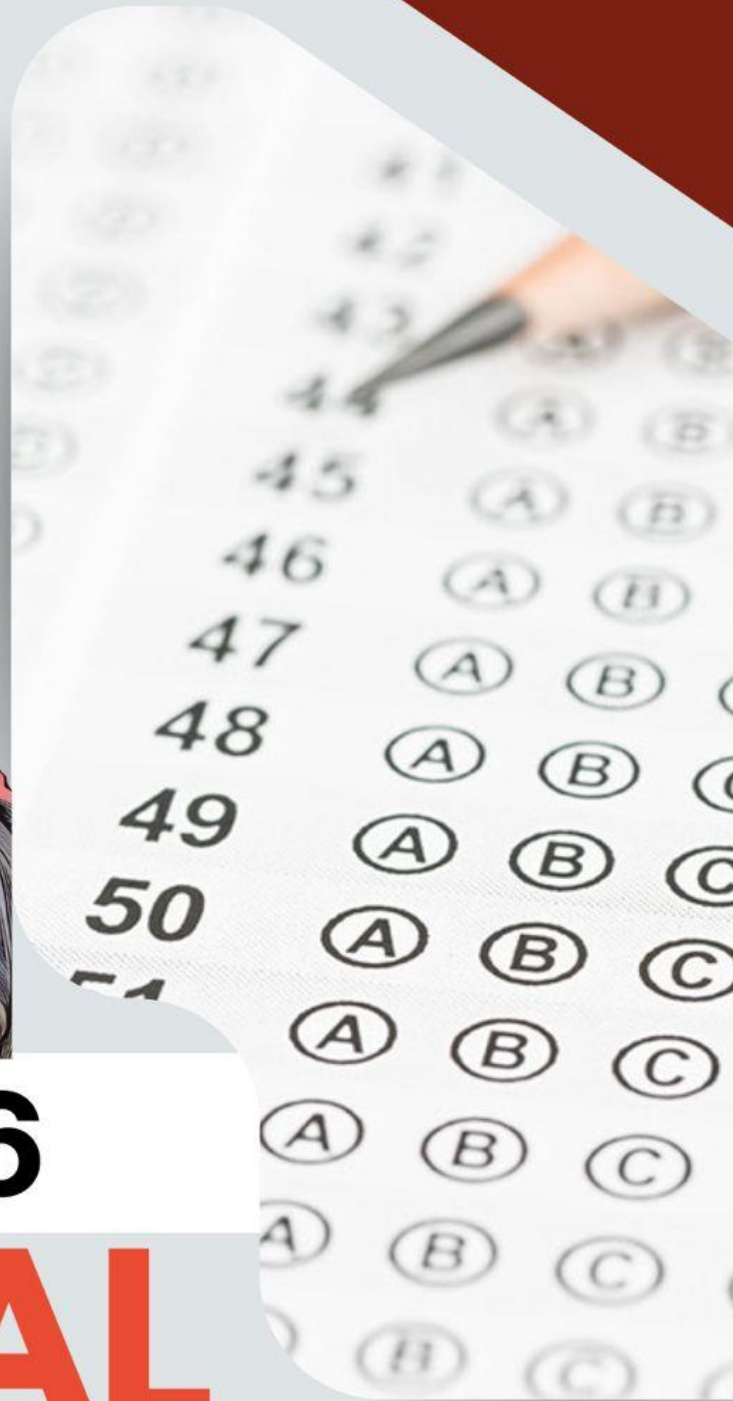
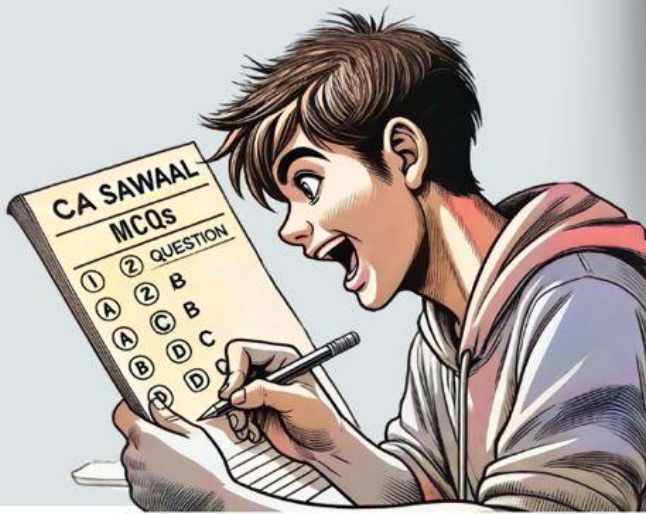




APRIL 2026

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Explanation

Contents

Important Days & themes Error! Bookmark not defined.

Books Error! Bookmark not defined.

Appointments..... Error! Bookmark not defined.

Awards..... Error! Bookmark not defined.

Obituaries..... **13**

National **15**

Eminent Personalities in News. **Error! Bookmark not defined.**

National / International Festivals..... 29

State News **30**

Ladakh 30

Jammu & Kashmir 30

Himachal Pradesh 31

Uttarakhand 31

Punjab 32

Haryana 33

Delhi 33

Uttar Pradesh 33

Madhya Pradesh 35

Bihar 35

Chhattisgarh 35

Odisha 36

Sikkim 37

Assam 37

Arunachal pradesh 38

Nagaland 38

Manipur..... 38

Meghalaya..... 38

Rajasthan..... 39

Gujarat 39

Maharashtra..... 40

Goa 41

Telangana 41

Andhra Pradesh..... 42

Karnataka 42

Keralam 43

Tamil Nadu 44

Defence Error! Bookmark not defined.

Science & tech Error! Bookmark not defined.

Environment..... **57**

Index/rankings/reports. Error! Bookmark not defined.

International **68**

Sports..... **74**

National/ international Championships **Error!**

Bookmark not defined.

Chess 75

Hockey 75

Football 76

Miscellaneous..... **76**

Banking / finance..... **77**

Important Days & Themes

1. The theme for World Autism Awareness Day 2026 is:

- (a) Inclusion for All
- (b) Autism and Society
- (c) Autism and Humanity – Every Life Has Value
- (d) Equal Opportunities for Autism

Answer: (c)

- United Nations General Assembly **designated 2 April** as World Autism Awareness Day (WAAD) in **2007**.
- **Theme : "Autism and Humanity – Every Life Has Value"**

2. Consider the following statements regarding Samata Diwas:

1. It marks the death anniversary of Babu Jagjivan Ram.
2. It is observed on 5th April every year.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

- **5 April Samata Diwas - Birth anniversary of Babu Jagjivan Ram**, a great leader and social reformer
- Jagjivan Ram was **born on 5th April 1908 in Chandwa in Bihar** to a **Dalit family**.

3. International Day of Sport for Development and Peace is observed on:

- A. 4 April
- B. 5 April
- C. 6 April
- D. 7 April

Answer: C

- **6 April International Day of Sports For Development And Peace**
- **2026 Theme: Sport: Building Bridges, Breaking Barriers**

4. World Health Day is observed annually on which date?

- A. 5 April
- B. 7 April
- C. 24 April
- D. 1 April

Answer: B

- **7 April**, World Health Day 2025, will kick off a year-long campaign on maternal and newborn health
- Theme : **"Together for health. Stand with science"**

5. Consider the following statements:

World Banjara Day is observed on 8th April.

The Banjara community falls under different social categories such as ST, SC, and OBC in various states. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- World Banjara Day (also known as International Roma-Banjara Day) is celebrated annually on April 8.
- In our community (Banjara) people are among Scheduled Tribes, at some places they are considered to be among Scheduled Castes, at some places they are considered to be among Other Backward Class and at some places they are considered as NT-DNT (nomadic tribes-denotified tribes).

6. Shaurya Diwas is observed every year on:

- A. April 7
- B. April 8
- C. April 9
- D. April 10

Answer: C

- Shaurya Diwas is observed every year on April 9 to commemorate the exceptional courage and bravery displayed by security forces during the 1965 India-Pakistan conflict.

7. World Homoeopathy Day 2026 theme is:

- A. Homoeopathy for Sustainable Health
- B. Healing Naturally
- C. Homoeopathy for All
- D. Universal Health through AYUSH

Answer: A

▪ **10th April World Homeopathy Day**

- The day is observed on the occasion of the **birth anniversary of German physician Dr Christian Friedrich Samuel Hahnemann**, the **founder of homoeopathy**
- The theme 2026 is "Homoeopathy for Sustainable Health".

10. The International Day of Human Space Flight is observed on:

- A. 4 October
- B. 12 April
- C. 7 April
- D. 21 July

Answer: B

- **The General Assembly on April 2011, declared 12 April as the International Day of Human Space Flight .**
- **12 April 1961 was the date of the first human space flight, carried out by Yuri Gagarin, a Soviet citizen. This historic event opened the way for space exploration for the benefit of all humanity.**

11. Siachen Day commemorates which of the following operations?

- A. Operation Vijay
- B. Operation Meghdoot
- C. Operation Parakram
- D. Operation Cactus

Answer: B

- **Commemorates Operation Meghdoot (13th April 1984), which marked India's successful military control of the Siachen Glacier in 1984.**
- **The Saltoro Ridge, part of the Karakoram, lies southwest of the Siachen Glacier.**

12. World Quantum Day is celebrated on:

- A. March 14
- B. April 14
- C. May 14
- D. June 14

Answer: B

- **The World Quantum Day is celebrated on April 14, a reference to 4.14, the rounded first digits of Planck's**
- **constant: $4.1356677 \times 10^{-15} \text{ eV}\cdot\text{s} = 0.000\,000\,000\,000\,004\,1356677 \text{ electron volt second}$, a product of energy and time that is the fundamental constant governing quantum physics.**

13. The theme of World Heritage Day 2026 is:

- A. Heritage for Future Generations
- B. Preserving Cultural Identity
- C. Emergency Response for Living Heritage in contexts of Conflicts and Disasters
- D. Sustainable Heritage Conservation

Answer: C.

- **18 April World Heritage Day (International Day for Monuments and Sites)**
- **Celebrated to honour and protect cultural and natural heritage.**

- **This year theme - Emergency Response for Living Heritage in contexts of Conflicts and Disasters**

14. The theme of World Liver Day 2026 is:

- A. Healthy Liver, Healthy Life
- B. Liver Care for All
- C. Solid Habits, Strong Liver
- D. Beat Liver Disease Together

Answer: C

- **World Liver Day (WLD) is a global healthcare event commemorated every year on the 19th of April with the intent to raise awareness about liver disease in the general public.**
- **Theme : Solid Habits, Strong Liver**

15. The theme of Civil Services Day 2026 is:

- A. Digital India for Good Governance
- B. Viksit Bharat: Citizen-Centric Governance and Development at the Last Mile
- C. Minimum Government, Maximum Governance
- D. Inclusive Growth through Innovation

Answer: B

- **Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions will observe 18th Civil Services Day on April 21, 2026.**
- **This date was chosen to commemorate the day when Sardar Vallabhai Patel addressed the probationers of Administrative Service Officers in 1947 at Metcalfe House Delhi.**
- **The theme for the Civil Services Day 2026 is "Viksit Bharat: Citizen-Centric Governance and Development at the Last Mile".**

16. World Creativity and Innovation Day is observed annually on:

- A. 15 April
- B. 18 April
- C. 21 April
- D. 25 April

Answer: C

- **The United Nations designated 21 April as World Creativity and Innovation Day to raise awareness of the role of creativity and innovation in all aspects of human development.**
- **The United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO), following the 2005 Convention helps countries strengthen their creative industries and promote artistic freedom.**

17. The theme of World Earth Day 2026 is:

- A. Restore Our Earth
- B. Invest in Our Planet
- C. Our Power, Our Planet
- D. Planet vs Plastics

Answer: C

- **World Earth Day is celebrated annually across the world on April 22 every year.**
- **Earth Day's 2026 theme is OUR POWER, OUR PLANET**
- **The first World Earth Day was held on April 22, 1970, in the United States.**

18. The World Book Capital for 2026 is:

- A. Madrid
- B. Paris
- C. Rabat
- D. Lisbon

Answer: C.

- **23 April - World Book and Copyright Day**
- 23 April is a symbolic date in world literature. It is the date on which several prominent authors, William Shakespeare, **Miguel de Cervantes and Inca Garcilaso de la Vega all died.**
- Rabat has been officially designated as the **UNESCO World Book Capital for 2026, marking a major cultural milestone for the Moroccan capital**

19. English Language Day at the United Nations is observed on:

- A. 21 April
- B. 22 April
- C. 23 April
- D. 24 April

Answer: C

- **23 April - English Language Day**
- A United Nations (UN) observance day.
- The day coincides with both the birthday and death day of William Shakespeare and World Book Day

20. National Panchayati Raj Day is observed in India on:

- A. 26 January
- B. 15 August
- C. 24 April
- D. 2 October

Answer: C.

- **24 April - National Panchayati Raj Day**
- **The first celebrated in 2010.**
- The day marks the enactment of the 73rd amendment of the constitution in 1992, which gave constitutional status to Panchayats as institutions of rural local self-government.

- The main provisions of the Panchayati Raj Act are outlined in Part IX of the Indian **Constitution, which consists of Articles 243 to 243-O**

29. The World Book Capital for 2026 is:

- A. Madrid
- B. Paris
- C. Rabat
- D. Lisbon

Answer: C.

- **23 April - World Book and Copyright Day**
- **23 April** is a symbolic date in world literature. It is the date on which **several prominent authors**, William Shakespeare, Miguel de Cervantes and Inca Garcilaso de la Vega all **died.**
- **Rabat has been officially designated as the UNESCO World Book Capital for 2026, marking a major cultural milestone for the Moroccan capital**

30. English Language Day at the United Nations is observed on:

- A. 21 April
- B. 22 April
- C. 23 April
- D. 24 April

Answer: C

- **23 April - English Language Day**
- A United Nations (UN) observance day.
- The day **coincides with both the birthday and death day of William Shakespeare and World Book Day**

31. The theme of World Immunization Week 2026 is:

- A. Vaccines for Future Generations
- B. Immunization for All
- C. For every generation, vaccines work
- D. Universal Health Coverage

Answer: C

- **World Immunization Week 2026 by the World Health Organisation (WHO)** began across the globe.
- The **week-long campaign** from **24th - 30th of April.**
- The World Immunization Week is **celebrated in the last week of April** to promote the life-saving power of immunization.
- **The theme for this year is : For every generation, vaccines work**

32. National Panchayati Raj Day is observed in India on:

- A. 26 January
- B. 15 August
- C. 24 April
- D. 2 October

Answer: C.

- 24 April - **National Panchayati Raj Day**
- The **first celebrated in 2010.**
- The day marks the enactment of the **73rd amendment of the constitution in 1992, which gave constitutional status to Panchayats as institutions of rural local self-government.**
- The main **provisions of the Panchayati Raj Act are outlined in Part IX of the Indian Constitution, which consists of Articles 243 to 243-O**

33. What is Haemophilia?

- A. A bacterial infection affecting lungs
- B. A genetic bleeding disorder due to clotting factor deficiency
- C. A viral disease affecting immunity
- D. A disorder of red blood cell production

Answer: B.

- **17 April - World Haemophilia Day**
- Hemophilia is a **rare, inherited bleeding disorder** where the **blood doesn't clot properly** due to a deficiency or defect in one of the clotting factors. This can lead to prolonged bleeding after injuries, surgeries, or even spontaneous bleeding
- **Theme is : "Diagnosis: First Step to Care"**

34. The two most dangerous malaria-causing species are _____ and _____.

- A. Plasmodium dengue & Plasmodium malariae
- B. Plasmodium vivax & Plasmodium falciparum
- C. Trypanosoma & Leishmania
- D. Plasmodium ovale & Plasmodium malariae

Answer: B

- World Malaria Day is an occasion to highlight the need for continued investment and sustained political commitment for malaria prevention and control.
- **THEME: Driven to End Malaria: Now We Can. Now We Must**
- **Five species of parasites** can cause malaria in humans and 2 of these species – **Plasmodium falciparum and Plasmodium vivax** – pose the **greatest threat.**

35. National DNA Day is observed to mark:

- Discovery of DNA double helix structure
- Completion of Human Genome Project
- Discovery of RNA polymerase

Options:

- A. 1 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B**April 25 National DNA Day**

- Commemorates the **discovery of the double helix structure of DNA in 1953 by James Watson and Francis Crick** and the **completion of the Human Genome Project in 2003.**
- **Deoxyribonucleic Acid (DNA)** is the molecule that carries the genetic information for an organism's development and function.

36. The theme for the International Day of Women in Industry 2026 is:

- A. Women in Science and Innovation
- B. Inclusive Growth for All
- C. Celebrating Women's Leadership in Industrial Development
- D. Gender Equality in Governance

Answer: C

- The International Day of Women in Industry (IDWI), observed each year on 21 April, inaugurated in 2026
- **THEME** : Celebrating Women's Leadership in Industrial Development

25th April International Delegate's Day

- In order to **raise awareness of the role of delegates of the Member States to the United Nations**, the UN General Assembly has proclaimed 25 April as International Delegate's Day.

38. National DNA Day is observed to mark:

1. Discovery of DNA double helix structure
2. Completion of Human Genome Project
3. Discovery of RNA polymerase

Options:

- A. 1 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B**April 25 National DNA Day**

- Commemorates the **discovery of the double helix structure of DNA in 1953 by James Watson and**

Francis Crick and the completion of the Human Genome Project in 2003.

- **Deoxyribonucleic Acid (DNA)** is the molecule that carries the genetic information for an organism's development and function.

39. The two most dangerous malaria-causing species are _____ and _____.

- A. Plasmodium dengue & Plasmodium malariae
- B. Plasmodium vivax & Plasmodium falciparum
- C. Trypanosoma & Leishmania
- D. Plasmodium ovale & Plasmodium malariae

Answer: B

- World Malaria Day is an occasion to highlight the need for continued investment and sustained political commitment for malaria prevention and control.
- **THEME: Driven to End Malaria: Now We Can. Now We Must**
- **Five species of parasites** can cause malaria in humans and 2 of these species – **Plasmodium falciparum and Plasmodium vivax** – pose the greatest threat.

40. The theme for World Veterinary Day 2026 is:

- A. Animal Health for All
- B. One Health, One Future
- C. Veterinarians: Guardians of Food and Health
- D. Sustainable Livestock Development

Answer: C

- The World Veterinary Day is commemorated to honour the veterinary profession every year on the final Saturday in April.
- **Theme:** 'Veterinarians: Guardians of Food and Health'

41. The theme for World Intellectual Property Day 2026 is:

- A. IP and Digital Future
- B. Innovation for All
- C. IP and Sports: Ready, Set, Innovate
- D. Creativity and Culture

Answer: C

26 April - World Intellectual Property Day

- Designated by WIPO's member states in 2000 with the aim of increasing general understanding of IP.
- Theme: "IP and Sports: Ready, Set, Innovate"

42. World Tapir Day is observed on:

- A. 25 April
- B. 26 April
- C. 27 April
- D. 28 April

Answer: C

27 April - World Tapir Day

- Raising Awareness of Tapirs **Since 2008**
- Tapirs are **large herbivorous mammals** that inhabit jungle and forest regions of **South America, Central America, and Southeast Asia.**

43. Lapu-Lapu Day is mainly celebrated by:

- A. Indian community in USA
- B. Filipino community in Canada
- C. Chinese community in UK
- D. African community in Europe

Answer: B

- **27th April - Lapu-Lapu Day**
- It is an important celebration for Vancouver's Filipino community in Canada.
- The day **honours Datu Lapu-Lapu, the Filipino chieftain who famously defeated Spanish forces** led by Ferdinand Magellan **in the Battle of Mactan in 1521** and became a national hero.

44. The theme for World Design Day (International Design Day) 2026 is:

- A. Design for All
- B. Sustainable Futures
- C. The Spaces in Between
- D. Design for Humanity

Answer: C

- This day commemorates the founding of the International Council of Design on the 27th of April, 1963. Until 2020, this event was celebrated as World Design Day.
- **The theme** - "the spaces in between".

45. What is the theme of World Day for Safety and Health at Work 2026?

- A. Safety First at Workplace
- B. Healthy Workplaces for All
- C. Let's ensure a healthy psychosocial working environment
- D. Preventing Industrial Hazards

Answer: C

▪ **28 April - World Day for Safety and Health at Work**

- **In 2003**, the International Labour Organization (ILO), **began to observe World Day**
- **THEME: Let's ensure a healthy psychosocial working environment**

Books

1. The book *"Tides of Time: Bharat's History through Murals in Parliament"* is authored by:

- A. Smriti Irani
- B. Nirmala Sitharaman
- C. Sudha Murty
- D. Meenakshi Lekhi

Answer: c

- Vice President releases book **'Tides of Time: Bharat's History through Murals in Parliament'** authored by MP Smt. Sudha Murty.

2. The book *God's Own Empire* is written by:

- A. Ramachandra Guha
- B. Irfan Habib
- C. William Dalrymple
- D. Raghu Palat and Pushpa Palat

Answer: d

- **God's Own Empire: Power, piety, and the politics of remembering**
- a biography of Maharaja Marthanda Varma of Travancore - *God's Own Empire* by Raghu Palat and Pushpa Palat
- published by Penguin Random House India

3. Who is the author of the book *"We, the People of India: Decoding a Nation's Symbols"*?

- (a) Amartya Sen
- (b) T.M. Krishna
- (c) Ramachandra Guha
- (d) Shashi Tharoor

Answer: (b)

- BOOK -We, the People of India: Decoding a Nation's Symbols
- BY - T.M. Krishna

4. The book *Paradiso 17* is written by which of the following authors?

- A. Hannah Lillith Assadi
- B. Arundhati Roy
- C. Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie
- D. Jhumpa Lahiri

Answer: A

- American writer Hannah Lillith Assadi's book *Paradiso 17* (published by HarperCollins)

5. *Teen Digest*, a new weekend tabloid, has been launched by which organization?

- A. Times Group
- B. Indian Express Group
- C. The Hindu Group
- D. HT Media

Answer: C

- **The Hindu launches tabloid 'TeenDigest' for young readers**
- A revamp of *The Hindu In School*, the 32-page edition aims to engage curious young minds in an age of endless scrolling

Appointments

1. Who has been appointed as the next Chief Minister of Bihar?

- A. Tejashwi Yadav
- B. Sushil Kumar Modi
- C. Chirag Paswan
- D. Samrat Choudhary

Answer: D

- Bihar Chief Minister Nitish Kumar stepped down on April 14, 2026, amid hectic political developments in the State.
- **Meanwhile Deputy CM Samrat Choudhary is set to become the next CM of Bihar** after he was elected as the BJP's leader of the Legislature Party in the State.
- **For the first time, the BJP is set to have a Chief Minister in the State**

2. Who has been appointed as the new head of Israel's foreign intelligence agency, Mossad?

- A. David Barnea
- B. Herzi Halevi
- C. Roman Gofman
- D. Yossi Cohen

Answer: C

- Israel has appointed Major General Roman Gofman as the **new head of its foreign intelligence agency Mossad**, marking an unconventional leadership choice, succeeding David Barnea

3. Recently, Nizar Amidi has been elected as the President of which country?

- A. Iran
- B. Iraq
- C. Syria
- D. Jordan

Answer: B

- **Nizar Amidi has been elected as the new president of Iraq.** It is a Western Asian country.
- **Capital City:** Baghdad.

4. Who has recently assumed command as the General Officer Commanding-in-Chief (GOC-in-C), Southern Command of the Indian Army?

- A. Dhiraj Seth
- B. Sandeep Jain
- C. Manoj Pande
- D. Upendra Dwivedi

Answer: B

- **Lieutenant General Sandeep Jain** has assumed command as the **General Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Southern Command** on 01 April 2026. He succeeds Lieutenant General Dhiraj Seth.

5. Who has recently assumed the role of Vice Chief of the Army Staff (VCOAS)?

- A. Sandeep Jain
- B. Dhiraj Seth
- C. Upendra Dwivedi
- D. Anil Chauhan

Answer: B

- Lieutenant General Dhiraj Seth assumed the role of Vice Chief of the Army Staff.
- He is an alumnus of the National Defence Academy, Khadakwasla, in Pune.

6. Uchral Nyam-Osor has been elected as the Prime Minister of which country?

- A. Kazakhstan
- B. Mongolia
- C. Uzbekistan
- D. Kyrgyzstan

Answer: B

- Uchral Nyam-Osor has been elected Mongolia's new prime minister, becoming the country's third leader in nine months as political instability
- Capital: Ulaanbaatar
- Currency: Tögrög (MNT)

7. Who has been appointed as the Municipal Commissioner of the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC)?

- A. Lokesh Chandra
- B. Bhushan Gagrani
- C. Ashwini Bhide
- D. Smita Sabharwal

Answer: C

- The Maharashtra Government appointed senior IAS officer **Ashwini Bhide** as the Municipal Commissioner of the **Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC)**, making her the first woman to head one of the oldest and richest civic bodies in the country.

8. Who has been appointed as the Officer on Special Duty (OSD) in the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME)?

- A. Sanjay Lohiya
- B. Bharat Harbanslal Kherra
- C. Narendra Bhooshan
- D. Rohit Kansal

Answer: B

- **Senior IAS officer Chanchal Kumar** has been appointed as Information and Broadcasting Secretary
- **Sanjay Lohiya**, Additional Secretary, Ministry of Mines has been appointed as **Special Secretary, Department of Financial Services, Ministry of Finance.**

- **Bharat Harbanslal Khera**, Additional Secretary, Department of Consumer Affairs, has been appointed as **Officer on Special Duty, Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises**, will take over as after the superannuation of Subhas Chandra Lal Das on April 30

9. Lieutenant General Pushendra Pal Singh succeeded whom as the General Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the Western Command?

- (a) Lt Gen Manoj Kumar Katiyar
- (b) Lt Gen Anil Chauhan
- (c) Lt Gen Raj Shukla
- (d) Lt Gen Ranbir Singh

Answer: (a)

- Lieutenant General Pushendra Pal Singh, formerly the Vice Chief of the Army Staff (VCOAS), has assumed command as the General Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Western Command.
- He succeeds Lieutenant General Manoj Kumar Katiyar, who superannuated on March 31.

10. Recently, who has been appointed as the Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Power Grid Corporation of India Limited?

- A. R.K. Singh
- B. Burra Vamsi Rama Mohan
- C. Pankaj Kumar
- D. Alok Kumar

Answer: B

- Power Grid Corporation of India Limited (POWERGRID) has announced the appointment of Burra Vamsi Rama Mohan as its new Chairman and Managing Director (CMD), effective April 1, 2026.
- Vamsi Rama Mohan has assumed charge with immediate effect and will serve as CMD until July 31, 2030, the date of his superannuation, or until further orders.

11. Min Aung Hlaing has been appointed Prime Minister of which country?

- (a) Thailand
- (b) Myanmar
- (c) Laos
- (d) Cambodia

Answer: (b)

- Myanmar junta chief **Min Aung Hlaing** won a parliamentary vote, to become the country's President,
- **It is the northernmost country of Southeast Asia.**

12. Who has been appointed as Director (Finance) at NMDC Limited?

- (a) Rajnath Singh
- (b) Ajay Kumar
- (c) Shaktikanta Das
- (d) Anurag Kapil

Answer: (d)

- Shri Anurag Kapil, a 1998 batch officer of the Indian Railway Accounts Service (IRAS), has assumed charge as Director (Finance) at **National Mineral Development Corporation (NMDC) Limited**, India's largest iron ore producer

13. Who has been appointed as the Chief Director of the Vigilance Bureau in Punjab?

- A. P K Sinha
- B. Arpit Shukla
- C. Sharad Satya Chauhan
- D. R K Sharm

Answer: C

- Punjab government appointed senior IPS officer Sharad Satya Chauhan as the vigilance bureau chief.

14. Campbell Wilson has stepped down as the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of which airline?

- A. IndiGo
- B. Vistara
- C. Air India
- D. SpiceJet

Answer: C

- Campbell Wilson has stepped down as the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Air India.
- Wilson had taken charge as CEO and Managing Director in July 2022, after former Turkish Airlines Chairman Ilker Ayci opted out of the role earlier that year amid controversy.

15. Susan Coyle is significant because she is:

- A. The youngest Army Chief in the United Kingdom
- B. The first woman to head the Australian Army
- C. The first civilian Army Chief in the United States
- D. The first foreign-born Army Chief in Canada

Answer: B

- Australia has announced a landmark shift in its military leadership by appointing **Lieutenant General Susan Coyle as the first woman to head the Australian Army in its 125-year history.**
- Lieutenant General Susan Coyle will replace Lieutenant General Simon Stuart as Chief of Army

16. John Ternus, recently seen in the news, is set to become Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of:

- A. Microsoft
- B. Apple
- C. Intel
- D. Nvidia

Answer: B.

- Tech giant Apple announced that long-time CEO **Tim Cook** will be stepping down from his role, and **John Ternus**, senior vice president of Hardware Engineering will take over as the CEO starting September 1, 2026.

17. Former President Rumen Radev, recently seen in the news, is set to become the Prime Minister of which country?

- A. Romania
- B. Bulgaria
- C. Hungary
- D. Slovakia

Answer: B

- Bulgaria's eighth parliamentary election in five years has concluded with **former president Rumen Radev's Progressive Bulgaria party** emerging as the clear winner. Radev will be the next prime minister.
- **Capital:** Sofia
- **Currency:** Euro

18. Recently, who was elected unopposed as the Deputy Chairman of the Rajya Sabha?

- A. Jagdeep Dhankhar
- B. Om Birla
- C. Harivansh Narayan Singh
- D. M. Venkaiah Naidu

Answer: C

- Harivansh Narayan Singh was elected unopposed as the Deputy Chairman of the Rajya Sabha.
- **It is the third term as Deputy Chairman for the journalist-turned-politician.**
- It is for the first time that a nominated member has been elected as Deputy Chairman.

19. The Odisha Steel Producers' Association (OSPA) has elected whom as its President?

- A. Naveen Jindal
- B. Asit Tripathy
- C. T. V. Narendran
- D. Sajjan Jindal

Answer: B

- The Odisha Steel Producers' Association (OSPA) has **unanimously elected Mr Asit Tripathy, former Chief Secretary of Odisha and Advisor to Jindal Steel, as its President at a meeting of its members.**

- OSPA is a newly formed collective platform of leading steel and mining companies in the state, including Jindal Steel, Tata Steel, Jindal Stainless, JSW Steel, AMNS and others.

21. Dinesh Trivedi succeeds whom as India's High Commissioner to Bangladesh?

- A. Pranay Kumar Verma
- B. Vikram Doraiswami
- C. Harsh Vardhan Shringla
- D. Ruchira Kamboj

Answer: A

- Dinesh Trivedi has been appointed India's High Commissioner to Bangladesh, succeeding Pranay Kumar Verma.
- Marking the first time the Modi government has chosen a politician to head an overseas diplomatic mission

22. Who is set to become the Prime Minister of Hungary?

- A. Viktor Orbán
- B. Péter Magyar
- C. Andrzej Duda
- D. Emmanuel Macron

Answer: B

- Péter Magyar is set to become the Prime Minister of Hungary after defeating Viktor Orbán who had been in power for 16 years.
- **Capital:** Budapest
- **Currency:** Forint

23. Who has recently assumed additional charge as the CEO of NITI Aayog?

- A. Suman Bery
- B. Arvind Virmani
- C. Nidhi Chhibber
- D. BVR Subrahmanyam

Answer: C

- Nidhi Chhibber has assumed additional charge as the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the NITI Aayog **after the completion of the tenure of BVR Subrahmanyam**, marking an important leadership transition in India's premier public policy institution.
- Nidhi Chhibber is a 1994-batch IAS officer of the Chhattisgarh cadre.

24. Who has been elected as the Mayor of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD)?

- A. Monika Pant
- B. Shelly Oberoi
- C. Pravesh Wahi
- D. Rekha Gupta

Answer: C

- The BJP party's councillor from Rohini East, Pravesh Wahi, was elected as the Mayor of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) and party's councillor from Anand Vihar, Monika Pant, was elected as the Deputy Mayor.

25. Recently, C. V. Anand was appointed as the Director General of Police of which state?

- A. Andhra Pradesh
- B. Karnataka
- C. Telangana
- D. Tamil Nadu

Answer: C.

- The Telangana government appointed senior IPS officer C. V. Anand as the Director General of Police (Head of Police Force).
- He will serve as the head of the Telangana Police.

26. Recently, Ashok Kumar Lahiri has been appointed as the Vice-Chairman of:

- A. Finance Commission
- B. Reserve Bank of India
- C. NITI Aayog
- D. Planning Commission

Answer: C

- The government has reconstituted the NITI Aayog, appointing Ashok Kumar Lahiri as its vice chairman and four new full-time members.
- **Mr. Lahiri, a former Chief Economic Advisor to the government, replaces Suman K. Bery, who has been the Vice-Chairperson of the government's think-tank since May 2022.**

27. Who has been appointed as the first woman Chief Justice of the Andhra Pradesh High Court?

- A. Indira Banerjee
- B. Hima Kohli
- C. Lisa Gill
- D. B. V. Nagarathna

Answer: C

- Governor S Abdul Nazeer administered the oath of office to Lisa Gill as Chief Justice of High Court of Andhra Pradesh, appointed as the first woman Chief Justice of Andhra Pradesh High Court

28. Who has been appointed as the ombudsman of the Bihar Cricket Association by the Supreme Court?

- A. Abhay S. Oka
- B. Hrishikesh Roy
- C. D. Y. Chandrachud
- D. Ranjan Gogoi

Answer: B

- **The Supreme Court has appointed its former judge, Hrishikesh Roy, as the ombudsman of the Bihar Cricket Association, BCA.**

29. Gagandeep Kaur Grewal became the first Sikh woman to be appointed as a _____ in Alberta, Canada.

- A. Judge
- B. Sheriff
- C. Police Chief
- D. Mayor

Answer: B

- **Gagandeep Kaur Grewal, from the Lakhimpur Kheri district of Uttar Pradesh, has become the first Sikh woman to be appointed a sheriff in Alberta, Canada.**

30. Gobardhan Das has been appointed as:

- A. Vice-Chairperson of NITI Aayog
- B. CEO of NITI Aayog
- C. Full-Time Member of NITI Aayog
- D. Special Advisor to NITI Aayog

Answer: C

- **Dr. Gobardhan Das was appointed as a Full-Time Member of NITI Aayog**
- NITI Aayog is an advisory body (think-tank) to the government, established through a Union cabinet resolution, replacing the erstwhile Planning Commission.

31. Who has been appointed as the interim Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Noida International Airport?

- A. Rajiv Bansal
- B. Nitu Sarma
- C. Sanjeev Kumar
- D. V.K. Singh

Answer: B

- Noida International Airport (NIA) has appointed **Nitu Sarma as Chief Executive Officer (CEO) on an interim basis**, until the Board of Directors conclude a formal selection process.

32. John Ternus, recently seen in the news, is set to become Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of:

- A. Microsoft
- B. Apple
- C. Intel
- D. Nvidia

Answer: B.

- Tech giant Apple announced that long-time CEO Tim Cook will be stepping down from his role, and John Ternus, senior vice president of Hardware Engineering will take over as the CEO starting September 1, 2026.

33. Former President Rumen Radev, recently seen in the news, is set to become the Prime Minister of which country?

- A. Romania
- B. Bulgaria
- C. Hungary
- D. Slovakia

Answer: B

- Bulgaria's eighth parliamentary election in five years has concluded with former president Rumen Radev's Progressive Bulgaria party emerging as the clear winner. Radev will be the next prime minister.
- **Capital: Sofia**
- **Currency: Euro**

34. Recently, who was elected unopposed as the Deputy Chairman of the Rajya Sabha?

- A. Jagdeep Dhankhar
- B. Om Birla
- C. Harivansh Narayan Singh
- D. M. Venkaiah Naidu

Answer: C

- Harivansh Narayan Singh was elected **unopposed as the Deputy Chairman of the Rajya Sabha.**
- **It is the third term as Deputy Chairman for the journalist-turned-politician.**
- It is for the first time that a nominated member has been elected as Deputy Chairman.

35. The Odisha Steel Producers' Association (OSPA) has elected whom as its President?

- A. Naveen Jindal
- B. Asit Tripathy
- C. T. V. Narendran
- D. Sajjan Jindal

Answer: B

- The Odisha Steel Producers' Association (OSPA) has unanimously elected **Mr Asit Tripathy, former Chief Secretary of Odisha and Advisor to Jindal Steel, as its President at a meeting of its members.**
- OSPA is a newly formed collective platform of leading steel and mining companies in the state, including **Jindal Steel, Tata Steel, Jindal Stainless, JSW Steel, AMNS and others.**

36. Dinesh Trivedi succeeds whom as India's High Commissioner to Bangladesh?

- A. Pranay Kumar Verma
- B. Vikram Doraiswami
- C. Harsh Vardhan Shringla
- D. Ruchira Kamboj

Answer: A

- **Dinesh Trivedi has been appointed India's High Commissioner to Bangladesh, succeeding Pranay Kumar Verma.**
- **Marking the first time the Modi government has chosen a politician to head an overseas diplomatic mission**

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- Nidhi Chhibber is a 1994-batch IAS officer of the Chhattisgarh cadre.

39. Santhosh Viswanathan has been appointed as Vice-President and Managing Director for which company?

- A. Microsoft
- B. Intel
- C. Google
- D. IBM

Answer: B

- Intel has appointed Santhosh Viswanathan as vice-president and managing director for the Asia Pacific and Japan region.

Awards

1. Which film won the Best Film award at the Chetak Screen Awards 2026?

- A. Dhurandhar
- B. Stolen
- C. Homebound
- D. Haq

Answer: C

Chetak Screen Awards 2026

CATEGORY	WINNERS
Best Film	Homebound
Best Actor (Female)	Yami Gautam Dhar – Haq
Best Actor (Male)	Ranveer Singh – Dhurandhar
Best Director	Aditya Dhar – Dhurandhar

2. Consider the following statements regarding the President's Police Colour:

1. It is awarded annually to multiple police forces.
2. It is also known as 'Nishaan'.
3. A police unit must complete at least 25 years of service to be eligible.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 2 and 3 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: a

- Odisha Police has been conferred the prestigious President's Police Colour, the highest honour granted to a police force or military unit in India.
- The President's Police Colour is a rare and prestigious honour bestowed upon a police force or military unit, not a routine annual award given to multiple forces at once (unlike the President's Police Medals for gallantry or meritorious service, which are announced annually on Republic Day and Independence Day).
- The President's Police Colour award, also known as 'Nishaan', is the highest honour bestowed upon a police force in India, in recognition of its exceptional service, bravery and professionalism
- An armed force or police unit must have rendered 25 years of exceptional service to be eligible for this prestigious honour.

3. Which institution secured first place at the Association of Indian Universities National Moot Court Competition 2026?

- A. Chandigarh University
- B. Banaras Hindu University
- C. Integral University
- D. Army Institute of Law

Answer: B

- Banaras Hindu University (BHU) secured first place at the Association of Indian Universities National Moot Court Competition 2026, held at Integral University, Lucknow.
- Received a cash prize of Rs 25,000 along with trophies and medals. Chandigarh University secured the runner-up position and was awarded Rs 11,000

4. The film Elephants in the Fog is directed by:

- A. Satyajit Ray
- B. Abinash Bikram Shah
- C. Anurag Kashyap
- D. Christopher Nolan

Answer: B

- Nepali feature film Elephants in the Fog has made history by becoming the first Nepali film to be selected in the UN Certain Regard section of the Cannes Film Festival.
- **Written and directed by Abinash Bikram Shah, the film will compete at the 79th edition of the festival, scheduled to be held in France from 12th to 23rd May.**

5. Consider the following statements regarding the Young Global Leaders (YGL) initiative:

It is an initiative of the World Economic Forum.

It identifies individuals below the age of 25 who have demonstrated leadership.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- The KALE Foundation announced that Arthur Law, Co-founder and Managing Principal of Store friendly Asia, has been named a Young Global Leader 2026 by the World Economic Forum.
- He is the architect behind Storefriendly Asia's transformation from an operator into Asia's leading tech-enabled self-storage platform.
- **The Forum of Young Global Leaders is one of the world's most selective and respected leadership communities, established by the World Economic Forum to identify exceptional leaders under the age of 40 who are already shaping industries, institutions and society.**

6. Which Indian initiative has been nominated for the prestigious WSIS Prizes 2026 in the Enabling Environment category?

- A. BharatNet
- B. Samriddh Gram
- C. PM Gati Shakti
- D. Digital India

Answer: B

- **India's Samriddh Gram initiative has been nominated for the prestigious WSIS/ World Summit on the Information Society Prizes 2026 in the Enabling Environment category.**
- Samriddh Gram is an integrated phygital service delivery model designed by the Department of Telecommunications (DoT).
- **It utilizes the high-speed broadband backbone of BharatNet to transform rural connectivity into a platform for essential social and economic services.**

7. With reference to the Goldman Environmental Prize, consider the following statements:

1. Winners receive USD 250,000.
2. It honours grassroots environmental activists from six continental regions annually.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

- **All-Women Cohort Wins 2026 Goldman Environmental Prize**
- For the first time in its history, **the Goldman Environmental Prize has recognised an all-women group of winners.**
- Established in 1989 by the Goldman Environmental Foundation, the Goldman Environmental Prize is often called the **"Green Nobel Prize."**
- **It honours grassroots environmental activists from six continental regions annually.**
- **Winners receiving USD 200,000.**

8. Who was awarded the 2026 Breakthrough Prize in Mathematics?

- A. David J. Gross
- B. Frank Merle
- C. Carolina Figueiredo
- D. Edward Witten

Answer: B

- The Breakthrough Prize Foundation announced the winners of the 2026 Breakthrough Prizes, honoring scientists whose discoveries are

significantly driving growth of human knowledge.

- The Breakthrough Prizes – popularly known as the **"Oscars of Science"** – were created to celebrate the wonders of our scientific age. This year, six Breakthrough Prizes of \$3 million each were awarded.
- **2026 Breakthrough Prize in Mathematics** - Frank Merle
- **2026 Breakthrough Prize in Fundamental Physics** - The Muon g-2 Collaborations at CERN, Brookhaven National Laboratory, and Fermilab
- **2026 Special Breakthrough Prize in Fundamental Physics** - David J. Gross

9. Which Indian became the first to receive honour in the Outstanding Reading Promoter category under the IBBY-iRead Award 2026?

- A. Sudha Murty
- B. Geeta Dharmarajan
- C. Namita Jacob
- D. Anita Desai

Answer: C

- **The International Board on Books for Young People (IBBY) through its IBBY-iRead Outstanding Reading Promoter Award hopes to further the cause of reading promotion.**
- Namita Jacob, Director of Chetana Trust, a Chennai-based organisation is one of the winners of the IBBY-iRead Outstanding Reading Promoter Award 2026, along with Kirsten Boie from Germany.

10. Match the following Laureus World Sports Awards 2026 categories with their respective winners:

List I (Award Category)	List II (Winner)
1. Laureus World Breakthrough of the Year	A. Rory McIlroy
2. Laureus World Comeback of the Year	B. Lando Norris
3. Laureus Lifetime Achievement Award	C. Nadia Comăneci
4. Laureus World Young Sports person of the Year	D. Lamine Yamal

Codes:

- A. 1-B, 2-A, 3-C, 4-D
- B. 1-A, 2-B, 3-D, 4-C
- C. 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D
- D. 1-D, 2-A, 3-B, 4-C

Answer: A

- **The Laureus World Sports Awards 2026, held at Cibeles Palace in Madrid.**
- **Widely regarded as the "Oscars of sport."**

2026 Laureus World Sports Award winners - complete list

- **Laureus World Sportsman of the Year Award:** Carlos Alcaraz
- **Laureus World Sportswoman of the Year Award:** Aryna Sabalenka
- **Laureus World Team of the Year Award:** Paris Saint-Germain
- **Laureus World Breakthrough of the Year Award:** Lando Norris
- **Laureus World Comeback of the Year Award:** Rory McIlroy
- **Laureus World Sportsman of the Year with a Disability Award:** Gabriel Araújo
- **Laureus World Young Sportsman of the Year Award:** Lamine Yamal
- **Laureus Sporting Inspiration Award:** Toni Kroos
- **Laureus Lifetime Achievement Award:** Nadia Comăneci

11. Who was crowned Femina Miss India World 2026?

- A. Nikita Porwal
- B. Rajnandini Pawar
- C. Sadhvi Satish Sail
- D. Manasa Varanasi

Answer: C

- Sadhvi Satish Sail was crowned Miss India World 2026 at the grand finale of the 61st Femina Miss India pageant held in Bhubaneswar.
- Crowned by her predecessor Nikita Porwal, Sail is all set to represent India at the Miss World 2027 pageant.

12. Recently, who was awarded the WWF National Award for developing the AI-based app "Neophyte ID"?

- A. N. Alim Yusuf
- B. Vandana Shiva
- C. R. K. Pachauri
- D. M. S. Swaminathan

Answer: A

- **N. Alim Yusuf botany researcher who developed an AI-powered mobile Neophyte ID application** to identify invasive plant species in Kerala has been awarded the WWF (World Wide Fund for Nature) National Award.
- N. Alim Yusuf, a researcher at the Malabar Botanical Garden and Institute for Plant Sciences (MBGIPS), Olavanna, Kozhikode, **received the honour for his innovative application capable of identifying nearly 100 invasive plant species recorded in Kerala**

13. Recently, who has been named the 2026 Person of the Year by the Harvard South Asian Association?

- A. Alia Bhatt
- B. Deepika Padukone
- C. Sayani Gupta
- D. Vidya Balan

Answer: C

- Bollywood Actress Sayani Gupta has been named as the 2026 Person of the Year by the Harvard South Asian Association in recognition of her outstanding contribution to film, storytelling, and representation.

14. _____, director of *All We Imagine As Light*, will serve as the president of the jury for the 65th Cannes Critics Week.

- A. Zoya Akhtar
- B. Mira Nair
- C. Payal Kapadia
- D. Guneet Monga

Answer: C.

- "All We Imagine As Light" director Payal Kapadia will be the **president of the jury for the 65th Cannes Critics Week, which runs parallel to the main festival and nurtures emerging voices in cinema.**
- Kapadia, who became the first Indian filmmaker to win the Grand Prix award at the Cannes Film Festival in 2024, will lead a panel of international jury members.
- **The festival sidebar, known as 'Semaine de la critique', is organised by the French Syndicate of Cinema Critics.**
- The 65th edition will run from May 13 to 21

15. Who has been conferred the "Excellence in Molecular & Precision Oncology Award 2026"?

- A. Dr Soumya Swaminathan
- B. Dr Naresh Trehan
- C. Dr Ravi Shankar
- D. Dr Randeep Guleria

Answer: C

- **Dr Ravi Shankar has been conferred the "Excellence in Molecular & Precision Oncology Award 2026" by Voice of Health, in recognition of his outstanding contributions to the advancement of molecular diagnostics and precision-driven cancer care.**
- The award was presented at a ceremony held in Mumbai recently.
- The award acknowledges Dr. Shankar's work in integrating molecular oncology and precision medicine into routine clinical practice.

16. Consider the following statements regarding Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar:

1. It is administered by the Ministry of Education.
2. The award is given only once in a lifetime to an individual.
3. Only Indian citizens are eligible.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C

- Recently, the central government has invited nominations for the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar (PMRBP).
- **The Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar organized by the Ministry of Women and Child Development Government of India.**

Eligibility for Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar

- A child should be an Indian Citizen.
- **Age:** A child above the age of 5 years and not exceeding 18 years (as of 31st July of respective year).
- **Each awardee will receive a medal, certificate and citation booklet**

17. Which of the following urban local bodies received the 4th Gender Equality Mobilisation (GEM) Award?

- A. Guntur Municipal Corporation
- B. Greater Chennai Corporation
- C. Pune Municipal Corporation
- D. Surat Municipal Corporation

Answer: A

- **The Guntur Municipal Corporation (GMC) has secured the 4th Gender Equality Mobilisation (GEM) Award, presented by the United Nations Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO) at the International Day of Women in Industry 2026 celebrations in Vienna**

18. Who has been awarded the "Business Reformer of the Year 2025" by The Economic Times?

- A. M.K. Stalin
- B. N. Chandrababu Naidu
- C. Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy
- D. K. Chandrashekar Rao

Answer: B

- Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu will receive the prestigious Business Reformer of the Year 2025 award by a leading

media organization The Economic Times at Mumbai.

- **He has been selected for the award for implementing transformative initiatives such as 'Speed of Doing Business' and 'Speed of Delivering Governance' in the state.**

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Answer: A

- The KALE Foundation announced that Arthur Law, Co-founder and Managing Principal of Store friendly Asia, has been named a **Young Global Leader 2026 by the World Economic Forum.**
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- The award was presented at a ceremony held in Mumbai recently.
- The award acknowledges Dr. Shankar's work in integrating molecular oncology and precision medicine into routine clinical practice.

Obituaries

1. Consider the following statements regarding Asha Bhosle:

1. She was recognized by the Guinness World Records as the most recorded artist.
2. In 2000, she was honoured with the Dadasaheb Phalke Award.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- The end of an era, as legendary singer Asha Bhosle has passed away at the age of 92
- **In 2000, she was honoured with the Dadasaheb Phalke Award**, India's highest award in the field of cinema.
- **In 2008, she was honoured by the Government of India with the Padma Vibhushan**, the second-highest civilian honour of the country.
- The **Guinness Book of World Records** acknowledged her in 2011 as the most recorded artist in music history.

2. Nadendla Bhaskara Rao, who recently passed away, was associated with which state as Chief Minister?

- A. Tamil Nadu
- B. Karnataka
- C. Andhra Pradesh
- D. Telangana

Answer: C

- Former Chief Minister of undivided Andhra Pradesh and co-founder of the Telugu Desam Party (TDP) Nadendla Bhaskara Rao died
- **A native of Guntur, became Chief Minister of the undivided State for a month in 1984 after a revolt against N.T. Rama Rao (NTR)**

3. Oscar Schmidt, who was recently in news, was a legendary basketball player from which country?

- A. Argentina
- B. Spain
- C. Brazil
- D. Italy

Answer: C

- Brazil's Oscar Schmidt, one of the most prolific scorers in basketball history, has passed away. He was 68.
- Schmidt, a Hall of Fame inductee in 2013, had played a 30-year professional career in Brazil and Europe and retired in 2003.

- **He represented Brazil in five Olympic Games and four World Cups.**

4. C. D. Gopinath, who recently passed away, was associated with which sport?

- A. Cricket
- B. Football
- C. Hockey
- D. Tennis

Answer: a

- C.D. Gopinath, who had been the last surviving member of India's first Test-winning team, passed away, He was 96.
- **He often referred to cricket as a "noble game"**

5. Which of the following books was authored by Balbir Punj?

- A. India After Gandhi
- B. Tryst with Ayodhya: Decolonisation of India
- C. Discovery of India
- D. Why I Am a Hindu

Answer: B.

- Author, journalist, BJP leader and former Rajya Sabha MP, Balbir Punj, passed away at the age of 76.
- **Author of 'Tryst with Ayodhya: Decolonisation of India' and 'Narrative ka Mayajaal'.**

6. N. Ramachandran, who recently passed away, was associated with which organization?

- A. Sports Authority of India
- B. Indian Olympic Association
- C. Board of Control for Cricket in India
- D. International Cricket Council

Answer: b

- Former Indian Olympic Association (IOA) president N. Ramachandran passed away. He was 77
- **Ramachandran, who had a long and distinguished career as a sports administrator, headed the IOA from 2014 to 2017 after previously serving as treasurer.**

7. Veteran Indian golfer Vijay Kumar, who recently passed away, belonged to which sport?

- A. Cricket
- B. Hockey
- C. Golf
- D. Tennis

Answer: C

- Veteran Indian golfer Vijay Kumar passed away, He was 57.
- **A winner of the 2002 Indian Open and a four-time Order of Merit champion**

8. Muni Narayana Prasad, head of Narayana Gurukula who recently passed away, was honoured with the Padma Shri in which year?

- A. 2021
- B. 2022
- C. 2023
- D. 2024

Answer: D

- Swami Muni Narayana Prasad, renowned scholar and head of the Narayana Gurukula, Varkala, passed away
- The nation honoured him with the Padma Shri in 2024.

9. Consider the following statements regarding Raghu Rai:

1. He received the Padma Shri for his coverage of the Bangladesh War as a reporter.
2. The French government conferred him with the Officier des Arts et des Lettres in 2009.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

- Renowned photographer Raghu Rai passed away
- Mr. Rai received the **Padma Shri in 1972** for his coverage of the Bangladesh war and its aftermath, apart from several national and international awards. The French government conferred him with the Officier des Arts et des Lettres in 2009

National

1. What is the official mascot of the Nyaya Setu AI Chatbot?

- A. Nyaya Mitra
- B. Sahay
- C. Dishika
- D. Nyayika

Answer: C

- **Nyaya Setu is a voice-first, multimodal, and multilingual AI-powered legal assistant. It serves as a comprehensive digital bridge designed to simplify complex legal information for citizens.**
- **Dishika is the official mascot and friendly digital interface of the Nyaya Setu AI Chatbot.**

2. The chemical formula of ethanol is:

- A. CH_4
- B. $\text{C}_2\text{H}_5\text{OH}$
- C. CO_2
- D. $\text{C}_6\text{H}_{12}\text{O}_6$

Answer: B

- The Central government has implemented a new fuel mandate for petrol pumps to supply E20 fuel with a minimum octane rating of 95 RON.
- **It is a blend of 20 per cent ethanol and 80 per cent petrol.**
- **Ethanol is a biofuel derived from crops such as sugarcane, maize, and grains.**
- Ethanol has **the chemical formula $\text{C}_2\text{H}_5\text{OH}$** and is composed of carbon, hydrogen, and oxygen atoms.

3. The Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Bill, 2026 primarily aims to:

- (a) Strengthen criminal laws
- (b) Promote ease of doing business and ease of living
- (c) Increase penalties for economic offences
- (d) Expand taxation framework

Answer: b

- The Lok Sabha passed Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Bill, 2026 that seeks to amend 79 Central Acts administered by 23 Ministries **to promote ease of doing business and ease of living.**
- Through the amendments the 784 provisions of various laws are being proposed to be amended out of which, **717 provisions are being decriminalised to foster Ease of Doing Business, and 67 provisions are proposed to be amended to facilitate Ease of Living.**

4. 'Sādhana Saptah 2026' is being organised during which of the following periods?

- A. 1–7 April 2026
- B. 2–8 April 2026

C. 5–11 April 2026

D. 10–16 April 2026

Answer: B

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated and launched Sādhana Saptah 2026 to enhance civil servants' capacity development.
- **The Department of Personnel and Training, Capacity Building Commission, and Karmayogi Bharat will launch Sādhana Saptah, 2026 from 2 to 8 April 2026**

5. Consider the following statements regarding the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (Amendment) Bill, 2026:

1. It introduces a Creditor-Initiated Insolvency Resolution Process (CIIRP).
2. The National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) is required to admit Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP) cases within 100 days if default is established.
3. It sets a timeline of 180 days for completion of liquidation, extendable up to 90 days.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: c

- The Parliament has passed the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (Amendment) Bill, 2026
- The Amendment seeks **to reduce delays, maximise value for all stakeholders, and introduce new provisions that follow global best practices for resolving insolvency.**
- **New Creditor-Initiated Insolvency Resolution Process (CIIRP): This replaces the largely underutilised "fast-track" process with an out-of-court initiation model.**

Strict timelines for National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT):

- **NCLT to admit Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP) cases within 14 days with proof of default enough to admit a case.**
- NCLAT to dispose of appeals in 3 months.
- **Sets a timeline of 180 days for completion of liquidation, extendable up to 90 days.**

6. With reference to the Rebate of State and Central Taxes and Levies (RoSCTL) Scheme, consider the following statements:

1. It provides rebate of both State and Central taxes/levies for exports of garments and made-ups.
2. The period of validity of the e-scrip is lifetime from its creation.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

- Recently, the Ministry of Textiles has extended the Rebate of State and Central Taxes and Levies (RoSCTL) Scheme **for exports of apparel/garments and made-ups up to 30th September 2026.**
- It aims to reimburse **all embedded State and Central Taxes/Levies for exports of manufactured goods and garments.**
- **Validity of e-scrip:** The period of validity of the e-scrip, of one year from its creation, shall not change on account of transfer of the e-scrip.

7. Consider the following statements regarding YUVIKA programme:

1. It is an initiative of ISRO.
2. It targets students currently studying in Class 9.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- Recently, the Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science & Technology highlighted the Government's sustained **efforts to nurture scientific temper among the youth, stating that the Yuva Vigyani Karyakram (YUVIKA).**
- Yuva Vigyani Karyakram (YUVIKA) is a learning and awareness creating **programme of the ISRO.**
- It imparts basic knowledge on **Space Technology, Space Science, and Space Applications to younger students with a preference to rural areas.**
- **Those who have finished class 8 and are currently studying in class 9 can apply for the programme.**

8. Consider the following statements regarding the recent conferment of "deemed-to-be-university" status on NCERT:

1. It enables NCERT to award degrees in its own name.
2. Such status is granted by the Central Government based on UGC recommendations.
3. It can affiliate colleges across India.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 1 and 3 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

- The Education Ministry has issued a notification declaring the National Council for Educational Research and Training (NCERT), as an institution deemed to be a university, enabling it to offer courses/programmes and confer degrees.
- The notification also mandated the NCERT to start new programmes, off-campus or on offshore campuses, "only in accordance with the norms and guidelines issued by the UGC."
- In broad terms, it means that the institution has **been granted permission to offer its own degree programs, which are equivalent to those provided by regular universities.**
- A deemed university or deemed-to-be-university is an **accreditation granted to higher educational institutions (HEIs) in India.**

10. With reference to Raja Ravi Varma, consider the following statements:

1. He is regarded as the father of modern Indian art.
2. He combined Greek realism with Indian themes.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

- Raja Ravi Varma (1848–1906) was a celebrated Indian painter and artist, widely considered the **father of modern Indian art.**
- He integrated **European oil painting techniques** (such as perspective and chiaroscuro) with Indian mythological and social themes.

11. Consider the following statements regarding the Jiyo Parsi Scheme:

1. It is a Central Sector Scheme.
2. It provides medical assistance for fertility treatment and pregnancy-related care.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- The Universal Parsi Registration Drive special facilitation camp, **organised by the Ministry of Minority Affairs** and around 300 fresh registrations were completed on the Jiyo Parsi portal of Jiyo Parsi Scheme.
- Jiyo Parsi is a flagship **Central Sector Scheme** of the Government of India aimed at arresting the **declining population of the Parsi community**.
- **It was launched in 2013-14** and seeks to stabilise and increase the Parsi population through structured interventions and scientific support.
- It provides Medical Assistance for fertility treatment and pregnancy-related care

12. Yuva Sangam is:

- A. A national youth exchange programme under Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat
- B. A skill development scheme for rural youth
- C. A scholarship programme for higher education abroad
- D. A startup funding initiative for young entrepreneurs

Answer: A

- Recently, registrations for institution-led exposure tours across paired regions under Yuva Sangam Phase-VI were held.
- Yuva Sangam is a youth exchange programme that brings young people from different parts of the country together.
- **Focus: It is designed for those aged 18–30 years, including students, National Service Scheme and Nehru Yuva Kendra Sangathan volunteers, and young professionals.**

13. The programme on “Administrative Capacity Building for Scientists and Academicians” has been launched under which framework?

- A. Mission Karmayogi
- B. Skill India Mission
- C. Digital India
- D. Atmanirbhar Bharat

Answer: A

- Union Minister of State Dr. Jitendra Singh launched the first dedicated programme on

“Administrative Capacity Building for Scientists and Academicians”.

- aiming to equip scientific and academic leaders with governance and decision-making skills under the Mission Karmayogi framework

14. With reference to the ECINet platform, consider the following statements:

1. It is meant only for election officials and not for voters.
2. It allows downloading of digital voter ID cards (e-EPIC).
3. It enables voters to connect with Booth Level Officers (BLOs).

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- Recently, the Election Commission of India (ECI) has urged voters to make informed choices by using the “Know Your Candidates” (KYC) module available on its ECINet platform.
- It is a single-point digital platform developed by the Election Commission of India (ECI).
- It is a new user-friendly digital interface for the electors and other stakeholders such as the election officials, political parties, and civil society.
- It integrates and reoriented over 40 of ECI’s existing mobile and web applications.
- Additional features include downloading digital voter ID cards (e-EPIC), connecting with election officials, and booking calls with Booth Level Officers (BLOs).

15. With reference to India’s Prototype Fast Breeder Reactor (PFBR), consider the following statements:

- a. It is located at Kalpakkam in Tamil Nadu.
- b. It has been developed by Bharatiya Nabhikiya Vidyut Nigam Limited (BHAVINI).
- c. It uses heavy water as a coolant.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- Prime Minister of India congratulated scientists as India’s first indigenous Prototype Fast Breeder Reactor (PFBR) at Kalpakkam, Tamil Nadu, successfully attained criticality.
- A Fast Breeder Reactor is an advanced nuclear reactor that generates more fissile material (fuel) than it consumes while producing electricity.

- It is fast because it uses high-energy (fast) neutrons to sustain the fission chain reaction, unlike conventional reactors that use slow neutrons.
- Developed By: The 500 MWe PFBR has been developed by Bharatiya Nabhikiya Vidyut Nigam Ltd (BHAVINI).
- Instead of water, it uses Liquid Sodium as a coolant.

16. SARAL AI, recently seen in news, is developed to:

- A. Promote digital payments in rural areas
- B. Monitor cyber security threats
- C. Simplify research publications into public-friendly content
- D. Provide AI-based healthcare solutions

Answer: C

- The Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF) is developing an AI-based platform, SARAL AI, to convert complex research publications into simplified social media content in 18 Indian languages.
- This initiative aims to make scientific advancements accessible to the general public in multiple Indian languages, including podcasts, short videos, posters, and social media content**

17. Poshan Pakhwada 2026 is being observed from:

- A. 1st to 15th March 2026
- B. 9th to 23rd April 2026
- C. 15th to 30th April 2026
- D. 1st to 15th April 2026

Answer: B

- The Ministry of Women and Child Development will commemorate the 8th edition of Poshan Pakhwada from 9th to 23rd April 2026.
- Aim: It aims to **raise awareness about the importance of nutrition and promote healthy eating habits through Jan Andolan and Jan Bhagidari.**
- Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Women and Child Development

18. The Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan (VBSA) Bill, 2025 proposes to replace which of the following bodies?

- University Grants Commission (UGC)
- All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE)
- National Council for Teacher Education (NCTE)

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

- The Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan (VBSA) Bill, 2025, introduced in the Lok Sabha, **seeks to revolutionize higher education by establishing a single apex regulatory body.**
- The Bill proposes the **creation of the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan (the Commission)** as the supreme regulatory authority for higher education in India.
- It **aims to implement the National Education Policy (NEP 2020) by replacing three major existing regulators:** the University Grants Commission (UGC), the All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE), and the National Council for Teacher Education (NCTE).

19. With reference to the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026, consider the following statements:

- It seeks to amend Articles 81, 82, and 334A of the Constitution.
- It mandates that delimitation can only occur after the 2031 Census.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- The Union Government has proposed The Constitution (One Hundred and Thirty-First Amendment) Bill, 2026, which seeks to increase the Lok Sabha's strength from 543 to 850 members.**
- It specifically targets Articles 81, 82, and 334A of the Constitution** to address long-standing demographic shifts and gender representation gaps.
- To enable immediate implementation of 1/3rd reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies by decoupling it from the requirement of a post-2026 Census.

20. The Startup India Fund of Funds (FFS) was originally launched in _____, and its second phase (FoF 2.0) was notified in _____.

- A. 2015, 2025
- B. 2016, 2026
- C. 2017, 2026
- D. 2016, 2025

Answer: B

- The Government has officially notified the Startup India Fund of Funds 2.0 (FoF 2.0) with a ₹10,000 crore corpus **to mobilize venture and growth capital for the domestic startup ecosystem.**

- Startup India FoF 2.0 is a **government-backed investment vehicle** designed to catalyze domestic capital for startups by contributing to the corpus of SEBI-registered Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs).
- Unlike a direct investment fund, **it acts as a Fund of Funds, meaning it invests in other venture capital funds which, in turn, invest in individual startups.**
- The second phase (2.0) was notified on April 13, 2026, building on the original FFS launched in 2016.

21. With reference to e-SafeHER, consider the following statements:

1. It is a cybersecurity awareness programme for rural women.
2. It is implemented by the Ministry of Home Affairs.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- **The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) launched e-SafeHER, a massive cybersecurity training initiative designed to empower one million women across rural India.**
- e-SafeHER is a specialized Cyber Security Awareness Training Programme tailored for rural women.

22. State-owned Khanij Bidesh India Limited (KABIL) has received environmental clearance from _____ for lithium exploration.

- A. Chile
- B. Bolivia
- C. Argentina
- D. Peru

Answer: C

- **State-owned Khanij Bidesh India Limited (KABIL) has received environmental clearance from the Argentine government to begin deep exploration of five brine lithium blocks in Catamarca province.**
- KABIL is a Joint Venture Company (JVC) formed by three Indian Government Enterprises: National Aluminium Company Ltd. (NALCO), Hindustan Copper Limited (HCL), and Mineral Exploration & Consultancy Limited (MECL).

23. NSTFDC (National Scheduled Tribes Finance and Development Corporation) celebrated its Foundation Day on:

- A. April 9
- B. April 10
- C. April 11
- D. April 12

Answer: B

- The National Scheduled Tribes Finance and Development Corporation (NSTFDC), a Public Sector Undertaking under the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, Government of India, is set to celebrate its 25th Foundation Day on April 10, 2026, at Vishwa Yuva Kendra, New Delhi.
- **Established in 2001, NSTFDC serves as an apex organization dedicated to the economic development of Scheduled Tribes across the country.**

24. The 9th edition of India International Water Week (IIWW-2026) will be held during:

- A. 15–19 August 2026
- B. 22–26 September 2026
- C. 1–5 October 2026
- D. 10–14 July 2026

Answer: B

- The 9th edition of India International Water Week (IIWW-2026) **will be held on the theme 'Climate Resilient Water Management'**
- From September 22nd - 26th 2026 .
- **Organised by the Union Ministry of Jal Shakti,** will include 49 sessions across various themes in the water sector

25. "Vishwa Sutra" is best described as:

- A. A government scheme for rural employment
- B. A designer collection showcasing Indian handlooms globally
- C. A textile export policy
- D. A digital platform for e-commerce

Answer: B

- Vishwa Sutra is a first-of-its-kind designer collection that positions Indian handlooms within a modern, global design
- **It features 30 state-specific weaves from across India, each artistically paired with design sensibilities, silhouettes, and cultural elements from 30 different nations.**

26. Maximum financial assistance per institution under the All India Council for Technical Education–Vibrant Advocacy for Advancement and Nurturing of Indian Languages (AICTE-VAANI) scheme is:

- A. Rs. 1 lakh
- B. Rs. 2 lakh
- C. Rs. 5 lakh
- D. Rs. 10 lakh

Answer: B

- The All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE) has launched the third edition of its flagship AICTE-VAANI scheme to strengthen the use of Indian languages in technical education.
- **The initiative aims to create a more inclusive academic ecosystem by enabling students to access technical knowledge in their native languages.**
- The AICTE-VAANI (Vibrant Advocacy for Advancement and Nurturing of Indian Languages) scheme seeks to bridge the language gap in higher education. Around 200 conferences, seminars, and workshops will be supported, with each institution receiving up to Rs. 2 lakh.

27. Consider the following statements regarding Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY):

1. PMGSY funds are used only for construction of roads, not maintenance.
2. The funding pattern for general states is 60:40.
3. PMGSY-IV was approved for the period 2024–25 to 2031–32.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 2 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- The Centre decided to extend the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana-III (PMGSY-III) beyond March 2025 till 2028-29, with an increase in the outlay by Rs 3,727 crore to Rs 83,977 crore
- **The first phase of the PMGSY was launched on December 25, 2000, by the then NDA government headed by Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee.**
- The second phase was launched in 2013.

Funding Pattern

- PMGSY is funded jointly by the Centre and States.
- The typical sharing pattern is 60:40 for general states and 90:10 for north-eastern and Himalayan states.

- Funds are allocated for the construction, maintenance, and upgradation of rural roads, ensuring the sustainability of assets

Objectives and Approach

- The primary objective of PMGSY is to ensure connectivity to eligible rural habitations based on population thresholds.
- **It focuses on providing reliable road access to markets, schools, and healthcare facilities.**
- The scheme also aims to improve rural livelihoods by facilitating economic activities, reducing transportation costs, and integrating rural areas with the broader economy.

Key Features

- The scheme ensures the construction of all-weather roads with standardised technical specifications.
- It uses modern technologies such as GIS-based monitoring and quality control mechanisms.
- **A key feature is its emphasis on connectivity to Gramin Agricultural Markets (GrAMs), which strengthens rural supply chains and agricultural marketing.**

28. The River Basin Management (RBM) Scheme is implemented under which ministry?

- A. Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
- B. Ministry of Rural Development
- C. Ministry of Jal Shakti
- D. Ministry of Agriculture

Answer: C

- The Government of India has approved the continuation of the River Basin Management (RBM) Scheme for the period 2026–27 to 2030–31 with a significantly increased outlay of ₹2,183 crore.
- **The RBM Scheme is a scientific and institutional framework under the Ministry of Jal Shakti** designed for the integrated management, protection, and sustainable development of India's river basins.
- It shifts water governance from localized projects to a basin-level approach, treating entire river systems—including tributaries, groundwater, and ecosystems—as a single hydrological unit.

29. Consider the following statements regarding the 106th Constitutional Amendment Act:

1. It provides one-third reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies.
2. The reservation is permanent and cannot be altered by Parliament.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- The Lok Sabha failed to pass the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026, which aimed to fast-track the implementation of 33% reservation for women in legislatures (introduced by the 106th Constitutional Amendment (2023) by enabling delimitation based on the 2011 Census.

The 106th Constitution Amendment Act (Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam)

- The 106th Amendment, passed in 2023, **remains the primary framework for reservation, though its implementation is currently stalled:**
- It mandates one-third (33%) reservation for women in the Lok Sabha, State Legislative Assemblies, and the Delhi Assembly.
- The **reservation is provided for a period of 15 years, which can be extended by Parliament.**
- It includes a sub-quota for women belonging to Scheduled Castes (SC) and Scheduled Tribes (ST) within the 33%.
- A **controversial clause states that reservation will only come into effect after delimitation is carried out following the first census conducted after the 2023 Act.**
- Reserved seats will be rotated to different constituencies after every delimitation exercise.

30. Consider the following statements regarding the RELIEF Scheme:

1. For existing ECGC policyholders, it provides up to 100% risk coverage for war-related and political losses.
2. It provides 50% reimbursement of extraordinary freight and insurance surcharges for non-insured MSMEs.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- The Government of India has expanded the geographical coverage of the RELIEF (Resilience &

Logistics Intervention for Export Facilitation) scheme to include Egypt and Jordan.

- **RELIEF** is a time-bound, targeted intervention launched to mitigate the financial and logistical risks faced by Indian exporters due to geopolitical tensions in West Asia.
- It acts as a financial buffer against extraordinary war-risk surcharges, freight hikes, and insurance spikes that threaten the competitiveness of Indian goods.
- **Launched In:** The scheme was officially launched on March 19, 2026, as part of the Export Promotion Mission (EPM).
- **Nodal Agency:** ECGC Limited (formerly Export Credit Guarantee Corporation of India).

Key Features:

- The scheme is structured into three complementary components with a total financial outlay of ₹497 Crore:
- For existing ECGC policyholders, it provides up to 100% risk coverage for war-related and political losses.
- Provides a 50% reimbursement of extraordinary freight and insurance surcharges (e.g., War Risk Surcharge).

31. The Urban Challenge Fund (UCF) is implemented by which ministry?

- A. Ministry of Finance
- B. Ministry of Urban Development
- C. Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
- D. Ministry of Commerce

Answer: C

- Union Minister launched the **Operational Guidelines for the Urban Challenge Fund (UCF) and the Credit Repayment Guarantee Sub-Scheme (CRGSS) to revolutionize urban infrastructure financing.**
- The Urban Challenge Fund is a market-linked, reform-driven, and outcome-oriented catalytic instrument. **Unlike traditional grant-based schemes, it uses limited central assistance to de-risk projects, encouraging cities to access market-based financing and private investments for large-scale urban transformation.**
- **Implementation Period:** FY 2025–26 to FY 2030–31.
- **Nodal Ministry:** Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA).

32. Which of the following is covered under the Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool?

1. Hull and Machinery
2. Cargo
3. Protection and Indemnity (P&I)
4. War Risk

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1, 2 and 4 only
- D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: D

- The Union Cabinet has approved the creation of a domestic maritime insurance pool with a sovereign guarantee of Rs 12,980 crore.
- **This is aimed at insulating India's maritime trade from global volatility.**
- The move is expected to significantly reduce dependence on foreign underwriters and ensure uninterrupted risk coverage for Indian shipping.

33. A Truck Mounted Attenuator (TMA) is best described as:

- A. A navigation device for trucks
- B. A fuel efficiency system
- C. A traffic surveillance camera
- D. An impact-absorbing road safety device

Answer: D

Truck Mounted Attenuator

- **Recently, the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) has introduced a truck mounted safety system i.e Truck Mounted Attenuator to reduce risks in construction and maintenance zones.**
- Truck Mounted Attenuators are specially designed impact-absorbing safety devices that play a critical role in protecting both workers and road users
- In the event of a collision, these systems absorb and dissipate kinetic energy, reducing the force of impact.

34. Consider the following statements regarding Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary:

1. It is a salt water wetland.
2. It lies on the East Asian–Australasian Flyway.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

- Recently, the Shekha Jheel Bird Sanctuary in Aligarh, Uttar Pradesh was designated as a Ramsar site, taking India's total to 99.

- **Location:** It is located in the state of Uttar Pradesh.
- **this marks the state's 12th Ramsar Site**
- It is a typical monsoonal wetland of the Gangetic plains.
- **It is a fresh water perennial water body that came into existence after the formation of the Upper Ganges Canal in 1852 which flows adjacent to the lake.**
- It acts as a crucial stopover on the Central Asian Flyway.

35. Consider the following statements regarding the Prime Minister Internship Scheme (PMIS):

1. It is implemented by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs.
2. It is only open to students who have already completed their graduation.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- The Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) has expanded the Prime Minister Internship Scheme (PMIS) to allow final-year graduate and postgraduate students to apply for paid internships.
- **The PMIS is a flagship phygital initiative of the Government of India designed to provide structured, paid internship opportunities to the youth in India's top 500 companies.**
- **Launched In:** The pilot phase of the scheme was launched in October 2024, following the announcement in the Union Budget 2024-25.
- **Nodal Ministry:** Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA).
- Participation is no longer restricted to those who have already completed their degrees; final-year undergraduate and postgraduate students are now eligible.
- **Students must submit a No Objection Certificate (NOC)** from their respective educational institutions.
- The NOC must explicitly state that the internship will not interfere with the student's academic requirements or attendance.

36. Consider the following statements regarding Atal Pension Yojana (APY):

1. It aims to provide social security mainly to workers in the unorganised sector.
2. Only government employees are eligible for this scheme.
3. Any Indian citizen between 18 and 40 years can join.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- **Atal Pension Yojana crosses milestone of over nine crore gross enrollments**
- The scheme was launched on 9th May, 2015, with the objective of creating a universal social security system for all Indians, especially the poor, the under-privileged and the workers in the unorganised sector.
- **Administered By:** Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority through National Pension System (NPS).
- **Eligibility:** Any citizen of India can join the APY scheme. The age of the subscriber should be between 18-40 years. The contribution levels would vary and would be low if a subscriber joins early and increases if she joins late.

37. The Online Gaming Authority of India functions under which of the following ministries?

- A. Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
- B. Ministry of Information and Broadcasting
- C. Ministry of Home Affairs
- D. Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports

Answer: A

- The government recently constituted the Online Gaming Authority of India, comprising six members.
- **It is a regulatory body established under the Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act 2025.**
- The authority will be a digital office under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), Government of India. It will be operational starting May 1.
- It will act as the central regulator for online games, including esports, bringing them under a formal registration and classification system.

38. India's first semiconductor fabrication plant under a Special Economic Zone (SEZ) has been granted to:

- A. Reliance Group
- B. Adani Group
- C. Tata Group
- D. Vedanta Group

Answer: C

- The government has cleared a special economic zone (SEZ) **for the country's first semiconductor fabrication plant, to boost efforts to develop a domestic chip manufacturing base and reduce import dependence.**
- The newly notified SEZ has been granted to Tata Semiconductor Manufacturing Private Ltd, which plans to invest around Rs 91,000 crore in the project.
- **Spread over 66.16 hectares, the facility at Dholera in Gujarat** is expected to create nearly 21,000 jobs.

39. The "Nari Shakti Vandan Run" will be held on:

- A. 15–16 April 2026
- B. 16–17 April 2026
- C. 17–18 April 2026
- D. 18–19 April 2026

Answer: C

- The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports will organise a nationwide "Nari Shakti Vandan Run" on 17 and 18 April 2026 across seven major cities, as part of its ongoing initiatives to promote women-led development and strengthen citizen participation in the vision of Viksit Bharat.
- **The event, themed #NariShaktiVandan, will be conducted in Delhi, Cuttack, Patna, Mumbai, Indore, Bengaluru and Jaipur.**
- The "Nari Shakti Vandan Run" is also being organised in the context of the special session of the Parliament from 16 to 18 April 2026,

40. The Chintan Shivir on "Antyodaya ka Sankalp, Amrit Kaal ka Pratibimb – Viksit Bharat @2047" is being organised by which ministry?

- A. Ministry of Rural Development
- B. Ministry of Home Affairs
- C. Ministry of Panchayati Raj
- D. Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment

Answer: d

- The Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment **will organise a three-day Chintan Shivir with States and Union Territories on the Theme "Antyodaya ka Sankalp, Amrit Kaal ka Pratibimb – Viksit Bharat @2047"** from April 24 to 26, 2026 in Chandigarh.

41. The theme of the First BRICS HWG Meeting 2026 was:

- A. Health for All
- B. Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability
- C. Universal Health Coverage
- D. Digital Health Transformation

Answer: B

- **The Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare hosted the First BRICS Health Working Group (HWG) Meeting 2026 in New Delhi** to deliberate on collaborative strategies for global health security.
- The BRICS Health Working Group (HWG) is a specialized platform under the BRICS framework.
- It **serves as a forum for senior health officials and technical experts** to coordinate on public health challenges, harmonize regulations, and share evidence-based policy interventions.
- **Host:** Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India (New Delhi).
- **Theme:** Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability

42. Consider the following statements regarding the Delimitation Bill, 2026:

1. It seeks to repeal the Delimitation Act, 2002.
2. The Delimitation Commission is constituted by the Election Commission of India.
3. The Chairperson of the Commission is a serving or former Election Commissioner.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. 1 and 2 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- The Delimitation Bill, 2026 was introduced in Lok Sabha on April 16, 2026.
- **The Bill provides for constitution of a Delimitation Commission for readjustment and reallocation of seats of Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies.**
- It **also seeks to repeal the Delimitation Act, 2002.**
- **Delimitation Commission:** The central government may, from time to time, constitute a Delimitation Commission

It will comprise of:

- (i) a Chairperson who is or has been a Supreme Court Judge,
- (ii) the Chief Election Commissioner or an Election Commissioner nominated by the Chief Election Commissioner, and

(iii) the State Election Commissioner of the concerned state.

- **The central government will appoint the Chairperson.**
- The central government will specify the term of the Commission by a notification. It may also extend the term.

43. Swachhta Pakhwada (2026) observed by the Ministry of Culture was held from:

- A. 1–15 April
- B. 10–25 April
- C. 16–30 April
- D. 20 April–5 May

Answer: C

- The Ministry of Culture, Government of India, is observing **Swachhta Pakhwada from 16 April to 30 April 2026, reaffirming its commitment to the vision of a clean and green India under the Swachh Bharat Mission.**

44. The NAMASTE Scheme is primarily aimed at:

- A. Providing universal health insurance coverage to unorganised workers
- B. Eliminating hazardous manual cleaning of sewers and septic tanks through mechanisation
- C. Promoting digital governance in urban local bodies
- D. Enhancing agricultural productivity through irrigation reforms

Answer: B

- The National Action for Mechanised Sanitation Ecosystem (NAMASTE) Scheme is a central sector scheme aimed at eliminating hazardous manual cleaning of sewers and septic tanks by promoting mechanised sanitation.
- It focuses on ensuring dignity, occupational safety, and sustainable livelihoods for sanitation workers while replacing manual scavenging with technology-driven sanitation systems.

45. The SARAS Aajeevika Mela 2026 is scheduled to be held in:

- A. Jaipur
- B. Lucknow
- C. Gurugram
- D. Bhopal

Answer: C

- The Ministry of Rural Development has finalised the Calendar of SARAS Aajeevika Melas at the National Level for the Financial Year 2026-27,
- The SARAS Aajeevika Mela 2026 will be held in Gurugram from 22nd October to 6th November.

46. A member is disqualified under the Anti-Defection Law if:

1. They voluntarily give up party membership
2. They vote against the party whip without permission
3. They abstain from voting with prior approval

Select the correct answer:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- **Key Features of the Anti-Defection Law**
- **Grounds for Disqualification:** A member can be disqualified if they voluntarily resign from their party or defy a party whip (voting instruction) during a division in the House.
- The Chairman of the Rajya Sabha or the Speaker of the Lok Sabha is the final authority to decide on disqualification petitions.
- An elected member is legally deemed to belong to the political party that set them up as a candidate for the election.
- The 91st Amendment also limited the size of the Council of Ministers to 15% of the total strength of the House to discourage using ministerial berths as bait for defection.

47. 'Soul Threads', recently in news, is:

- A. A government welfare scheme
- B. A heritage designer collection
- C. A digital payment platform
- D. A tourism campaign

Answer: B

- The Central Cottage Industries Corporation of India (CCIC) has launched its first heritage designer collection, Soul Threads, marking a major step in its revival and cultural promotion strategy.
- It is to celebrate and promote India's artisanal legacy through handloom, handicrafts, designer fashion, and cultural performances.

48. Under which Article of the Constitution did the Supreme Court of India uphold reproductive autonomy in allowing termination of pregnancy in exceptional circumstances?

- A. Article 14
- B. Article 19
- C. Article 21
- D. Article 32

Answer: C

- The Supreme Court of India permitted a 15-year-old girl to terminate her 31-week pregnancy, prioritising her fundamental rights and dignity.
- Legal Basis:

- Reproductive autonomy part of Article 21 (Right to Life).
- Includes dignity, privacy, and personal liberty.

49. What is the primary objective of "Operation WIPE"?

- A. To enhance cybersecurity against financial fraud in e-commerce
- B. To curb misuse of online platforms for illegal drug trade
- C. To regulate digital content on social media platforms
- D. To strengthen surveillance of cross-border data flows

Answer: B

- The Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) has launched "Operation WIPE" to curb the misuse of online platforms for the illegal sale and distribution of pharmaceutical drugs regulated under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act.
- **WIPE stands for "Web-based Illicit Activities Prevention & Enforcement".**

50. The Supreme Court of India held that safety of commuters and safe passage on highways fall under which Article of the Constitution?

- A. Article 14
- B. Article 19
- C. Article 21
- D. Article 32

Answer: C

- The Supreme Court has declared that the safety of commuters against road accidents and the right to safe passage on **highways are part of the fundamental right to life under Article 21 of the Constitution.**
- National Highways (NHs) comprise merely **2% of India's total road network but account for nearly 30% of all road fatalities, highlighting** severe infrastructural and administrative vulnerability.
- The Court held that Article 21 imposes a positive obligation on the State to ensure a safe environment, extending beyond protection from unlawful death; fatalities due to avoidable hazards reflect failure of this duty.

51. The Abhilekh Patal Portal is best described as:

- A. A platform for RTI applications
- B. A digital archival repository of historical records
- C. A government e-governance dashboard
- D. A database of court judgments

Answer: B**Abhilekh Patal Portal**

- It is a full-featured web-portal to access the National Archives of India's reference media and its digitized collections through the internet.
- It is a digital repository thoughtfully curated by the National Archives of India (NAI).
- It has a mission to provide easy access to India's historical archives, comprising an astounding 7 million records.

52. The Nasha Mukh Bharat Abhiyaan was launched by which ministry?

- A. Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
- B. Ministry of Home Affairs
- C. Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- D. Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports

Answer: C

Nasha Mukh Bharat Abhiyaan

- It was launched on 15th August 2020 by the Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment.
- It was initially launched in 272 identified most vulnerable districts and now it has been extended to all districts of the country with effect from 15th August 2023.

53. Prashast 2.0 is related to:

- A. Digital payments
- B. Disability screening in children
- C. Agricultural subsidies
- D. Skill development

Answer: B.

- The Union government is set to launch Prashast 2.0, an upgraded digital platform designed to identify 21 types of disabilities in children and improve support for Children With Special Needs (CWSN).
- The app aims to strengthen early screening, simplify certification and ensure better inclusion of such children in mainstream education.
- Prashast 2.0 will help school heads, teachers and special educators identify possible disabilities at the school level.
- The app is linked with the Samagra Shiksha scheme for inclusive education.

55. DPI@2047 for Viksit Bharat roadmap has been launched by:

- A. Ministry of Finance, Government of India
- B. NITI Aayog
- C. Reserve Bank of India
- D. Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

Answer: B.

- NITI Aayog has officially launched the DPI@2047 for Viksit Bharat roadmap, a **strategic initiative designed to propel India from foundational**

digital inclusion to a high-productivity, livelihood-led growth trajectory.

- The DPI@2047 Roadmap is a strategic framework developed by the NITI Frontier Tech Hub (FTH) in **partnership with EkStep Foundation and Deloitte**

Eminent Personalities in News

1. Consider the following statements regarding Dr.

B.R. Ambedkar:

1. His birth anniversary is celebrated as Ambedkar Jayanti on April 14.
2. He led the Mahad Satyagraha in 1931.
3. In 1947, Dr. Ambedkar became the Law Minister in the first Cabinet of independent India.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: c

- **Bhimrao Ramjo Ambedkar**, famously known as the **Father of the Indian Constitution**,
- **Born on 14 April 1891**, in **Mhow (now Ambedkar Nagar) in Madhya Pradesh**.
- His birth anniversary on 14 April every year as **Bhimrao Ambedkar Jayanti or Bhim Jayanti or Ambedkar Remembrance Day**.
- He also led the **Mahad Satyagraha in March 1927**.
- **In 1947**, Dr. Ambedkar became **Minister of Law in the first Cabinet of independent India**.

2. The literary magazine *Bangadarshan*, associated with the Bengali Renaissance, was started by:

- A. Rabindranath Tagore
- B. Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
- C. Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay
- D. Raja Ram Mohan Roy

Answer: C

- The death anniversary of Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay was observed on 8th April,
- Born on 27th June 1838 in Naihati, West Bengal, Bankim was a brilliant student and joined British service after completing his studies.
- Role in the Bengali Renaissance: Bankim started the literary magazine **Bangadarshan (1872)**, which played a key role in fostering Bengali nationalism.

3. The Satyashodhak Samaj (1873) was founded by:

- A. Raja Ram Mohan Roy
- B. Jyotirao Phule
- C. Swami Dayanand Saraswati
- D. B. R. Ambedkar

Answer: B

- **11th April - Mahatma Phule birth anniversary**
- Jyotirao Phule was an **Indian social activist, thinker, anti-caste social reformer and writer from Maharashtra**. He is also known as **Jyotiba Phule**.
- Phule along with his followers **formed Satyashodhak Samaj in 1873**

4. Under the Tinkathia system, farmers were forced to cultivate indigo on:

- A. 1/10th of their land
- B. 1/5th of their land
- C. 3/20th of their land
- D. Half of their land

Answer: C

5. The Champaran Agrarian Act (1918) resulted in:

- A. Abolition of the Tinkathia system
- B. Abolition of Zamindari system
- C. Introduction of Permanent Settlement
- D. Nationalisation of land

Answer: A

- 10th April marks the 108th anniversary of the Champaran Satyagraha, a defining moment in India's freedom struggle led by Mahatma Gandhi.
- On this day in 1917, in the Champaran district of Bihar, the movement was launched to address the grievances of indigo farmers who were compelled by British planters to cultivate indigo under the oppressive Tinkathia system.
- Tinkathia System: Under the tinkathia system, European planters forced ryots to cultivate indigo on 3/20th of their landholding, severely restricting their ability to grow food crops.

6. Consider the following statements regarding the Jallianwala Bagh massacre:

1. It was carried out under the command of Brigadier-General Reginald Dyer.
2. The Jallianwala Bagh massacre occurred on the day of Baisakhi.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- India marks the 107th anniversary of the Jallianwala Bagh massacre, paying homage to the hundreds of unarmed civilians killed by British forces in 1919.
- The Jallianwala Bagh massacre, also known as the Amritsar Massacre, was a brutal slaughter of unarmed Indian civilians by British troops under the command of Brigadier-General Reginald Dyer.
- April 13 was the festival of Baisakhi. Thousands of people—including men, women, and children—gathered at Jallianwala Bagh. Some were there to peacefully protest the arrests, while many rural visitors were simply there to celebrate the festival

7. Anubhava Mantapa, founded by Basaveshwara, is regarded as:

- A. First university of India

- B. First Parliament of India
- C. First temple of Karnataka
- D. First monastery of Lingayats

Answer: B.

- Basava Jayanti (celebrated on April 20 in 2026) marks the birth anniversary of Lord Basaveshwara, a **12th-century poet, philosopher, and social reformer who founded Lingayatism.**
- As per the Hindu calendar, the birth of Basavanna falls on the 3rd day of Vaisahaka month in the Shukla paksha.
- **He believed in a society free of the caste system, with equal opportunity for all and preached about manual hard work.**
- He also founded the Anubhava Mantapa, loosely translated as the forum of experiences, an academy which included Lingayat mystics, saints, and philosophers.
- **Thus, it was the first and foremost Parliament of India, where Sharanas (citizens of welfare society) sat together and discussed the socialistic principles of a Democratic set up.**

8. Parshuram Jayanti is observed on:

- A. Amavasya of Kartik
- B. Tithiya of Shukla Paksha in Vaishakha
- C. Purnima of Chaitra
- D. Ekadashi of Ashadha

Answer: B

- Parshuram Jayanti, observed on April 19, 2026, commemorates the birth of Lord Parshuram, the sixth avatar of Vishnu.
- **Celebrated on the Tithiya Tithi of Shukla Paksha in Vaishakha** (often coinciding with Akshaya Tithiya), he is considered an immortal Chiranjeevi

9. Consider the following statements about Chandra Shekhar:

1. He founded the weekly "Young India" in 1969.
2. He was elected to the Rajya Sabha from Haryana.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- **Shri Chandra Shekhar was born on April 17, 1927, in a farmer's family in village Ibrahimpatti in District Ballia, Uttar Pradesh. He was President of the Janata Party from 1977 to 1988.**
- In 1962, he was elected to the Rajya Sabha from Uttar Pradesh. He joined the Indian National Congress in January 1965.
- He came to be as 'Young Turk' leader

- He founded and edited YOUNG INDIAN, a weekly published from Delhi in 1969.
- During the Emergency (June 1975 to March 1977) YOUNG INDIAN had to be closed down.

10. With reference to the First Battle of Panipat, consider the following statements:

1. The battle took place on April 21, 1526.
 2. It marked the end of the Delhi Sultanate.
- Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?
- A. 1 only
 - B. 2 only
 - C. Both 1 and 2
 - D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C.

- April 21st marks the 500th anniversary of the First Battle of Panipat (April 21, 1526), a pivotal conflict where the outnumbered forces of Zahir-ud-din Muhammad Babur defeated the Lodi Sultanate.
- The First Battle of Panipat was a landmark military engagement that signaled the end of the Delhi Sultanate and the beginning of the Mughal Empire in India.
- **Happened In: The battle took place on April 21, 1526, on the plains of Panipat (present-day Haryana, India)**

11. With reference to Adi Shankaracharya, consider the following statements:

1. He founded the Dashanami Sampradaya.
 2. He supported the Mimamsa school based solely on ritual practices.
- Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?
- A. 1 only
 - B. 2 only
 - C. Both 1 and 2
 - D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- **The birth anniversary of Adi Shankaracharya, known as Shankaracharya Jayanti, is being observed, Tuesday, 21 April 2026.**
- This year marks the 1238th birth anniversary of the revered philosopher and saint.
- **According to the Hindu calendar, the Jayanti is celebrated on the Panchami Tithi of Vaishakha Shukla Paksha:**
- He also founded 'Dashanami Sampradaya,' which talks about leading a monastic life
- **He condemned the 'Mimamsa school of Hinduism', which was purely based on ritual practices**

12. The first recipient of the Dadasaheb Phalke**Award was:**

- A. Nargis
- B. Devika Rani
- C. Lata Mangeskar
- D. Meena Kumari

Answer: B

- On April 30, 2025, India celebrates the 155th birth anniversary of Dhundiraj Govind Phalke, famously known as Dadasaheb Phalke. Hailed as the Father of Indian Cinema
- **Born in 1860 in Trimbak, Maharashtra**
- **Raja Harishchandra (1913): India's First Feature Film**
- The first recipient of the Dadasaheb Phalke Award was Devika Rani, an Indian film actress, in 1969

National / International Festivals**1. Good Friday commemorates which of the following events?**

- (a) Birth of Jesus Christ
- (b) Resurrection of Jesus Christ
- (c) Crucifixion of Jesus Christ
- (d) Ascension of Jesus Christ

Answer: (c)

- **Good Friday is a solemn Christian holiday observed on the Friday preceding Easter.**
- **It commemorates the crucifixion of Jesus Christ —an event central to the Christian belief that Jesus is the Son of God.**

2. Easter is celebrated to commemorate:

- A. Birth of Jesus Christ
- B. Crucifixion of Jesus Christ
- C. Resurrection of Jesus Christ
- D. Ascension of Jesus Christ

Answer: C

- Easter is a central Christian festival that commemorates the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead, symbolising victory over sin and death.
- The date changes each year as it is determined by the lunar calendar, falling on the first Sunday after the full moon following the spring equinox.

3. With reference to Vishu, consider the following statements:

1. It is observed on the first day of the Malayalam month of Medam.
2. It is associated with the solar transition into Mesha Rashi.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- Vishu celebrated on **Monday, April 15, 2026.**
- The day commemorates **Lord Krishna's victory over the demon Narakasura**, symbolizing the triumph of good over evil.
- The festival signifies the **Sun's transition into Mesha Rashi.**
- Vishu is observed on the **first day of the Malayalam month of Medam**, (Chingam is the first month of the Malayalam calendar, but Vishu occurs in Medam).

4. Pana Sankranti marks the beginning of which Odia month?

- A. Chaitra
- B. Ashadha
- C. Baisakha
- D. Kartika

Answer: C

- Pana Sankranti, also known as **Maha Bishuba Sankranti**, is the **Odia New Year festival**.
- Celebrated **on the first day of the Odia calendar month of Baisakha**, which typically falls on April 14th or April 15th on the Gregorian calendar.

5. Puthandu marks the first day of which Tamil month?

- A. Thai
- B. Panguni
- C. Chittirai
- D. Aadi

Answer: C**Tamil New Year Puthandu**

- Celebrated as the **first day of the Tamil month of Chittirai.**
- As per Drik Panchang, Puthandu will be observed on April 14 in India.

6. Consider the following statements regarding Poila Baisakh:

1. It is also known as Shubho Noboborsho.
2. It is celebrated across Bengali communities.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- **Poila Baisakh** is an important festival celebrated by Bengali communities across **West Bengal, Tripura, Jharkhand, and Assam.**
- **Shubho Noboborsho**, also known as Pohela Boishakh, marks the **Bengali New Year.**
- It is also celebrated in Bangladesh.

7. Akshaya Tritiya is celebrated on:

- A. Full moon day of Chaitra
- B. Third lunar day of Krishna Paksha of Vaishakha
- C. Third lunar day of Shukla Paksha of Vaishakha
- D. Amavasya of Vaishakha

Answer: C.

- **Akshaya Tritiya is considered one of the most auspicious days in the Hindu calendar, symbolising prosperity, success, and new beginnings.**
- Celebrated on the **third lunar day (Tritiya) of the bright half of the month of Vaishakha.**
- The word “Akshaya” means “never diminishing,” reflecting the belief that wealth, charit
- and positive actions performed on this day multiply over time

State News**Ladakh****1. The local name of the Apricot Blossom Festival is:**

- A. Losar
- B. Hemis
- C. Chuli Mendok
- D. Sindhu Darshan

Answer: C**2. India's first Petroglyph Conservation Park has been established in which state/Union Territory?**

- A. Himachal Pradesh
- B. Uttarakhand
- C. Ladakh
- D. Jammu and Kashmir

Answer: C

- In a landmark initiative to preserve Ladakh's ancient heritage, Lt Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena laid the foundation stone for India's first Petroglyph Conservation Park on the banks of the Indus River on World Heritage Day.
- **Petroglyphs are prehistoric images, symbols, or carvings etched, pecked, or engraved directly onto rock surfaces.**
- The park aims to serve as a dedicated conservation space for centuries-old rock carvings (petroglyphs) that are increasingly under threat

3. The Sacred Piprahwa Relics of the Buddha were recently brought to:

- A. Sarnath
- B. Bodh Gaya
- C. Leh
- D. Kushinagar

Answer: C

- The Sacred Holy Piprahwa Relics of Tathagata Buddha have arrived in Leh, Ladakh, for a historic public exposition beginning on Buddha Purnima 2026.
- The term Tathagata is a profound title used in Buddhist texts to refer to a Buddha, particularly Shakyamuni Buddha.

4. Which of the following are the newly created districts in Ladakh?

- 1. Nubra
- 2. Sham
- 3. Changthang
- 4. Zaskar
- 5. Drass
- 6. Leh
- 7. Kargil

Select the correct answer:

- A. 1, 2, 3 only
- B. 3, 4, 5 only
- C. 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5 only
- D. 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6 and 7

Answer: C

- The Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh, Vinai Kumar Saxena, has approved the creation of five new districts, in total 7, aiming to strengthen administrative efficiency and grassroots governance.

The New Districts: The five newly created districts

- 1. Nubra
- 2. Sham
- 3. Changthang
- 4. Zaskar
- 5. Drass

Jammu & Kashmir**1. With reference to UNSC Resolution 47, consider the following statements:**

- 1. Its provisions were legally binding on both India and Pakistan.
- 2. It required Pakistan to withdraw forces before India reduced its military presence.
- 3. It provided for a UN-supervised plebiscite.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A**The resolution outlined a three-step sequence:**

- Pakistan was to use its best endeavors to secure the withdrawal of tribesmen and Pakistani nationals.
- **Once the Commission was satisfied that the invaders were withdrawing, India was to**

progressively reduce its forces to the minimum required for law and order.

- A UN-nominated Plebiscite Administrator would then conduct a free and impartial referendum to decide whether J&K would accede to India or Pakistan.

2. Mansar Lake, recently seen in the news, is located in:

- A. Himachal Pradesh
- B. Uttarakhand
- C. Jammu and Kashmir
- D. Punjab

Answer: C.

- A senior police officer recently reviewed security measures at Mansar Lake, **a prominent tourist destination in Samba district of Jammu and Kashmir.**
- It is a freshwater lake located in the Samba district of Jammu and Kashmir
- It lies in the foothills of the Shivalik range.

3. Hokersar Lake is located in:

- A. Himachal Pradesh
- B. Jammu and Kashmir
- C. Uttarakhand
- D. Ladakh

Answer: B

- **Hokersar, also known as Hokera, is a large natural wetland near Srinagar in Jammu and Kashmir.**
- It spans 13.75 sq.km. and rests at 1,585 meters above sea level.
- **The wetland lies in the Jhelum River basin and receives water mainly from the Doodhganga River (a tributary of Jhelum).**
- It is located in the northwest Himalayan biogeographic province of Kashmir, behind the snow-draped Pir Panchal.

4. With reference to the Vibrant Village Programme, consider the following statements:

1. It is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme.
2. It is limited only to Line of Control (LoC) villages.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- The Central Government has included six border villages in Jammu and Kashmir's Kathua district under the Vibrant Village Programme-II to improve infrastructure and ensure full delivery of welfare schemes.

- **Vibrant Village Programme is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme aimed at developing border villages in strategic areas.**

Himachal Pradesh

1. With reference to Himachal Pradesh, consider the following statements:

1. Himachal Pradesh became a full-fledged state on April 15, 1971.
2. It became a Union Territory on November 1, 1956.
3. The present strength of the Vidhan Sabha is 78.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B

- **April 15** has been observed every year as **'Himachal Day'**
- On **April 15, 1948**, the state was formed by merging **30 small and large princely states.**
- **HP became a part C state on 26th January 1950** with the implementation of the Constitution of India.
- After recommendation of the **State Reorganisation Commission**, HP became a **Union Territory on 1st November 1956.**
- On **18th December 1970** the State of HP Act was passed by **Parliament** and the new state came into being on **25th January 1971.** HP emerged as the **18th state of the Indian Union.** The present strength of the Vidhan Sabha is 68

Uttarakhand

1. The "Green Card system" recently introduced is associated with which state?

- A. Himachal Pradesh
- B. Sikkim
- C. Jammu & Kashmir
- D. Uttarakhand

Answer: d

- In Uttarakhand, the "Green Card system" for commercial passenger vehicles has been introduced to ensure the smooth and safe conduct of the Char Dham Yatra.
- The Green Card system will ensure the technical fitness and safety of commercial vehicles participating in the Yatra.

2. Lakhwar Hydroelectric Project is located in which state?

- A. Himachal Pradesh
- B. Uttarakhand
- C. Uttar Pradesh
- D. Haryana

Answer: B

Lakhwar Hydroelectric Project

- It is a multipurpose hydroelectric project planned on the Yamuna river near Lohari Village in the Dehradun District of Uttarakhand.
- **The main project components are a 204 m high concrete gravity dam, 3 steel-lined penstocks, and an underground powerhouse housing 3 vertical Francis turbines of 100 MW each.**

Punjab

1. Mission Samarth 4.0 has been launched by which state government?

- A. Haryana
- B. Rajasthan
- C. Punjab
- D. Gujarat

Answer: C

- The Punjab government has officially launched Mission Samarth 4.0, a new phase of its foundational learning flagship program that introduces a state-wide real-time attendance tracking system.
- Parents of students in the state-runs schools will now receive daily SMS alerts regarding their children's attendance

2. With reference to Guru Tegh Bahadur, consider the following statements:

1. He was conferred the title "Hind Di Chadar."
2. Guru Tegh Bahadur succeeded Guru Har Krishan Ji as the tenth Sikh Guru.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- Guru Tegh Bahadur (1621–1675) was the ninth of ten Gurus of the Sikh religion.
- **He was born as Tyaga Mal.**
- He came to be known by the name Teg Bahadur (Mighty of The Sword), given to him by Guru Hargobind after he showed his valour in a battle against the Mughals.
- In 1664, Guru Teg Bahadur succeeded Guru Har Krishan Ji as the ninth Sikh Guru.
- **He was revered with the honour of 'Hind Di Chadar'.**

3. Consider the following statements regarding Baisakhi:

1. It is observed on the first day of the month of Vaishakha in the Hindu solar calendar.
2. It is primarily associated with the winter crop harvest.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- Baisakhi, also known as Vaisakhi, is the popular spring harvest festival which is celebrated in Northern India, especially by the Sikh/Punjabi community.
- **It is traditionally observed on the first day of the month of Vaishakha in the Hindu solar calendar, which falls in April.**
- It is primarily a harvest festival, where farmers express gratitude for a good crop yield. It symbolizes prosperity, hard work, and new beginnings.

4. The Punjab government has decided to construct a glass bridge over _____ Lake.

- A. Beas
- B. Ravi
- C. Sutlej
- D. Chenab

Answer: C

- The Punjab government has decided to construct a glass bridge over Sutlej Lake in Nangal town of the Ropar district of the state.
- **This is stated to be North India's first such Glass Bridge.**

5. The term 'beadbi' refers to:

- A. Religious gathering
- B. Disrespect to holy scriptures
- C. Charity work
- D. Religious conversion

Answer: B

- The Punjab Cabinet approved stringent amendments to an Act on sacrilege, **proposing enhanced penalties, including life imprisonment, to deter incidents of 'beadbi' and uphold the sanctity of Guru Granth Sahib.**
- Also proposes a fine between Rs 5 lakh and Rs 25 lakh.
- There have been several incidents in the past involving 'beadbi' of Sri Guru Granth Sahib and other holy scriptures, which have deeply hurt public sentiments by bruising their psyche and caused unrest in society

6. Consider the following statements regarding the Jaagat Jot Sri Guru Granth Sahib Satkar (Amendment) Bill, 2026:

1. Offences under the law are classified as non-bailable and cognisable.
 2. The law introduces the concept of a "custodian" for the care and protection of a Saroop.
- Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?
- A. 1 only
B. 2 only
C. Both 1 and 2
D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- Punjab Governor Gulab Chand Kataria has given assent to the Jaagat Jot Sri Guru Granth Sahib Satkar (Amendment) Bill 2026, with Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann
- **The Bill proposes stringent punishments exclusively for acts of sacrilege involving the Guru Granth Sahib, which Sikhs revere as their eternal Guru.**
- This is the third such attempt by successive governments in Punjab to enact a stringent law on sacrilege.
- The offences have been classified as non-bailable and cognisable, triable by a sessions court, with investigations mandated to be conducted by officers not below the rank of deputy superintendent of police or assistant commissioner of police.
- **The law introduces the concept of a "custodian", encompassing individuals, institutions, and gurdwara committees responsible for the care and protection of a Saroop.**

Haryana

1. Consider the following statements regarding the Ghaggar River:

1. It is a perennial river flowing throughout the year.
2. The Hakra River flows in Pakistan as a continuation of the Ghaggar.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
B. 2 only
C. Both 1 and 2
D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

- The Ghaggar river is an intermittent river in India and Pakistan that flows only during the monsoon season.
- **It originates in the village of Dagshai in the Shivalik Hills of Himachal Pradesh at an elevation of 1,927 metres (6,322 ft) above mean sea level.**

- The river is known as Ghaggar before the Ottu barrage and as the **Hakra downstream of the barrage.**
- **After passing through the Ambala and Hissar districts of Haryana, it eventually dries up in the Great Indian (Thar) Desert.**
- The Hakra, which flows in Pakistan, is the continuation of the Ghaggar River in India, and they are together called the Ghaggar-Hakra River.

Delhi

1. The report "Landscapes Reconnected" has been released by NHAI in collaboration with the _____.

- A. Forest Survey of India
B. Wildlife Institute of India
C. Zoological Survey of India
D. National Biodiversity Authority

Answer: B

- **The National Highways Authority of India, in collaboration with Wildlife Institute of India, has released the report Landscapes Reconnected, documenting active wildlife use of underpasses along the Delhi–Dehradun Economic Corridor.**
- The Delhi–Dehradun Economic Corridor is a major greenfield highway and economic connectivity project.
- It is also being recognized as an eco-sensitive infrastructure model, integrating wildlife conservation features within highway development.

Uttar Pradesh

1. The Bankey Bihari Temple is located in which state?

- A. Rajasthan
B. Madhya Pradesh
C. Uttar Pradesh
D. Bihar

Answer: C

- **The Supreme Court recently made it clear that it would not make "any structural changes" to the present arrangement with regard to religious practices at the famous Bankey Bihari temple in Vrindavan.**
- It is a Hindu temple dedicated to Lord Krishna.
- It is located in the holy city of Vrindavan in the Mathura District of Uttar Pradesh.

2. The AI-based Urban Flood Management Cell (UFMC) has been established in which city?

- A. Lucknow
B. Varanasi
C. Gorakhpur
D. Kanpur

Answer: C

AI-based Flood Warning System

- Gorakhpur's AI-based Urban Flood Management Cell (UFMC) has received appreciation from the Prime Minister's Office and NITI Aayog for its data-driven and proactive flood management model.
- The Urban Flood Management Cell (UFMC) is India's first AI-enabled urban flood early warning and decision support system, established in Gorakhpur, Uttar Pradesh.

3. The 'MAATI-9' festival is primarily associated with which region of India?

- A. Bundelkhand
- B. Purvanchal
- C. Malwa
- D. Marwar

Answer: B

- Speaker of Lok Sabha Om Birla addressed the Purvanchal Mahotsav 'Maati-9' Festival highlighting the region's cultural and spiritual heritage.
- **MAATI-9 is a premier cultural festival of the Purvanchal region, centred on the theme Maati (soil).**
- It celebrates the deep bond between people and their ancestral roots through heritage, food, tourism, and arts.

4. Under the PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana, how many units of free electricity are targeted per month for beneficiary households?

- (a) 100 units
- (b) 200 units
- (c) 300 units
- (d) 500 units

Answer: c

- Uttar Pradesh has emerged as the top-performing State under the PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojna, in March 2026, setting a new national benchmark in rooftop solar deployment.
- About: It is a central scheme to promote the adoption of solar rooftop systems by providing substantial financial subsidies and ensuring ease of installation.
- The households will be able to get 300 units of electricity free every month.

5. The third edition of Sansad Khel Mahakumbh was held in which state?

- A. Bihar
- B. Uttar Pradesh
- C. Madhya Pradesh
- D. Rajasthan

Answer: B

- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh attended the third edition of the Sansad Khel Mahakumbh in Lucknow
- **The primary objective of the Sansad Khel Mahakumbh** is to provide a platform for young talent to showcase their abilities while nurturing discipline, teamwork, and a spirit of healthy competition.

6. Jal Pakhwada in Uttar Pradesh will be observed from:

- A. 10–20 April
- B. 15–25 April
- C. 17–30 April
- D. 20–30 April

Answer: C.

- In Uttar Pradesh, Jal Pakhwada will be organised from **17th April to 30th April** in all schools and educational institutions across the state under the 'Jal Shakti Abhiyan'.
- The government has taken a unique step in the field of water conservation by linking it directly with schools.

7. The traditional houses of the Tharu tribe are known as:

- A. Morung
- B. Zawlbuk
- C. Chang Ghar
- D. Badaghar

Answer: D

- The Lucknow bench of the Allahabad High Court **recently set aside a district-level committee's decision to reject the community forest rights claims of the Tharu tribe in Lakhimpur Kheri.**
- The Tharu tribe is one of the indigenous groups living in the Terai plain on the Indo-Nepal border.
- The Tharu are the largest and oldest ethnic group of the Terai region.
- They live in both India and Nepal.
- In the Indian Terai, they live mostly in Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, and Bihar.
- **In 1967, this tribe was documented as a Scheduled Tribe by the Government of India.**
- **Tharu traditional homes, known as "Badaghar," are made with local materials such as mud, wood, and thatch.**

8. Consider the following statements regarding the Ganga Expressway:

1. It connects Delhi to Prayagraj.
2. It is a 594-km-long expressway.
3. It has a 3.2 km long airstrip for emergency landing of aircraft.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **594-km-long Ganga Expressway**, one of the country's longest high-speed corridors, connecting Meerut to Prayagraj and aimed at transforming connectivity across Uttar Pradesh.
- **Designed for a speed of up to 120 kmph**
- A key feature of the expressway is a **3.2-km-long airstrip near Shahjahanpur** designed for emergency landing of Indian Air Force aircraft.

Madhya Pradesh

1. The "Unnat Krishi Mahotsav 2026: Exhibition and Training" is to be held in:

"उन्नत कृषि महोत्सव 2026: प्रदर्शनी और प्रशिक्षण" का आयोजन यहाँ किया जाएगा:

- A. Bhopal
- B. Indore
- C. Raisen
- D. Gwalior

Answer: C

- Union Minister for Agriculture & Farmers Welfare and Rural Development, Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan, stated that the **"Unnat Krishi Mahotsav 2026: Exhibition and Training" to be held in Raisen, Madhya Pradesh from April 11 to 13, .**

2. The committee constituted by the Madhya Pradesh Government to draft provisions for the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) is headed by:

- A. D.Y. Chandrachud
- B. Ranjana Prasad Desai
- C. N.V. Ramana
- D. Indu Malhotra

Answer: B

- The Madhya Pradesh Government has hastened the process of implementing the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) in the State by constituting a six-member panel headed by a retired Supreme Court Judge to draft a bill recommending provisions within 60 days.
- **Retired Supreme Court judge Justice Ranjana Prasad Desai will head the panel comprising a retired IAS officer, a legal expert, and an academician, among others.**

Bihar

1. Balirajgarh has been identified as an important site of which ancient kingdom?

- A. Magadha
- B. Kosala

- C. Avanti
- D. Videha

Answer: D

- Recently, the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) has begun excavation at Bihar's historic Balirajgarh site.
- **Location: It is located in the Madhubani district of Bihar.**
- It is believed that this site served as a major administrative hub of the ancient Videha Kingdom.

2. The duration of the Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses is:

- A. 5 years (2024–25 to 2028–29)
- B. 6 years (2025–26 to 2030–31)
- C. 7 years (2023–24 to 2029–30)
- D. 10 years (2025–26 to 2034–35)

Answer: B

- **The government launched Bihar's first-ever structured pulse procurement initiative under the Atmanirbhar Pulses Mission.** In a major development, NCCF has initiated organised procurement of masoor (lentil) in Bihar for the first time.

Features of Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses

- **Aim:** Boosting domestic production, reduce import dependence and achieving self-sufficiency (Aatmanirbharta) in pulses by December 2027.
- **Duration:** 6 Years (2025-26 to 2030-31).
- **Ministry:** Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare, Government of India
- **Focus Crops:** Tur/Arhar (pigeon pea); Urad (black gram) & Masoor (red lentil).

3. The Sanjay Gandhi Institute of Dairy Technology has been renamed as:

- A. National Dairy Institute, Patna
- B. Bihar Dairy Technology College
- C. Bihar State Institute of Dairy Technology
- D. Rajendra Dairy Institute

Answer: C

- The BJP-led government in the Bihar renamed the Sanjay Gandhi Biological Park as 'Patna Zoo', and the Sanjay Gandhi Institute of Dairy Technology as 'Bihar State Institute of Dairy Technology'.
- The State-run zoo, named after late Congress leader Sanjay Gandhi — the son of ex-Prime Minister Indira Gandhi and was opened to the public in 1973.

Chhattisgarh

1. The committee to draft the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) in Chhattisgarh will be headed by:

- A. Justice D.Y. Chandrachud
- B. Ranjana Prakash Desai
- C. Justice N.V. Ramana
- D. Indu Malhotra

Answer: B

- The Chhattisgarh government has decided to constitute a high-level committee to prepare a draft of the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) for its implementation in the state.
- The decision was taken at a cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai in Raipur.
- **Retired judge Ranjana Prakash Desai will lead the panel, while the chief minister has been authorised to nominate its members.**

Odisha

1. Consider the following statements regarding the Juang tribe:

1. They have a well-developed clan and kinship system.
2. Juang women traditionally wore garments made of leaves and were called "leaf-wearers" or Patuas.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: c

- **Juang is one of the 13 particularly vulnerable tribal groups (PVTGs) of the total 62 tribes found in Odisha.**
- They are primarily concentrated in the current districts of **Keonjhar and Dhenkanal in Odisha.**
- **The Juangs are known for their clan structure and kinship organisations.**
- **Clothing: Historically known as Patuas or "leaf-wearers," Juang women adorned leaf girdles, while men wore small loin cloths.**

2. The Sijimali Bauxite Mine is located in which state?

- A. Odisha
- B. Chhattisgarh
- C. Jharkhand
- D. Andhra Pradesh

Answer: a

- Recent violent clashes between tribal villagers and police in Odisha's Rayagada district have left dozens injured following protests against the construction of an approach road for the Sijimali bauxite mine.

- Sijimali is a massive high-grade bauxite reserve that was handed over to Vedanta Limited in 2023 through a government auction.

3. With reference to the Saora tribe, consider the following statements:

1. They have a tattooing tradition called 'Tantangbo'.
2. They follow a strictly monotheistic religion.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- **Lanjia Saora Tribe is one of the ancient tribes of Odisha and categorized as a particularly vulnerable tribal group.**
- **Other names:** Savaras, Sabaras, Saura, Sora, etc.
- **They have unique art practices, religious customs, as well as a dying tattooing tradition called 'Tantangbo'.**
- Their belief system is closely tied to nature, with rituals, music, and dance forming an integral part of everyday life.

4. The Subarnarekha River flows through which of the following states?

1. Jharkhand
2. West Bengal
3. Odisha
4. Bihar

Select the correct answer using the given code:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1, 2 and 3 only
- C. 2, 3 and 4 only
- D. 1, 3 and 4 only

Answer: B

- The Subarnarekha is a major rain-fed river in eastern India, known as the lifeline of the tribal communities in the Chhota Nagpur region.
- **Its name is derived from the Sanskrit words Subarna (gold) and Rekha (line/streak), referring to the tradition of finding gold particles in its sandy bed.**
- It originates near Piska/Nagri, close to Ranchi, the capital of Jharkhand.
- The river traverses three Indian states: Jharkhand, West Bengal, and Odisha.
- After flowing for a total length of 395 km, it joins the Bay of Bengal near Talsari in Odisha.

5. Consider the following statements regarding the Konark Sun Temple:

1. The temple was constructed using three types of stones—laterite, khondalite, and chlorite.
2. It was designated a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 1994.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
B. 2 only
C. Both 1 and 2
D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) has begun drilling a passage into the Jagamohan (assembly hall) of the 13th-century Konark Sun Temple, a UNESCO World Heritage Site, to remove sand packed inside by the British over a century ago.
- **It is located on the coastline of Odisha in the Puri district.**
- Textual evidence indicates that **Narasimha I (who reigned between 1238 and 1264) of the Eastern Ganga dynasty built the temple in 1250 CE.**
- It was designated a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 1984
- **The temple was constructed using three types of stones** – the laterite stone for the boundary walls, flooring, and staircase; Khondalite for the structure; and Chlorite stone for the door jams and lintel

Sikkim

1. What is Operation HimSetu?

- A. A joint military exercise between India and Nepal
B. A rescue operation launched by the Indian Army in North Sikkim
C. A border infrastructure development project
D. A disaster management policy of the Government of India

Answer: B

- The Army's Eastern Command launched a major rescue mission, Operation HimSetu, on Wednesday to evacuate over a thousand tourists stranded in North Sikkim after a series of massive landslides and a bridge collapse severed vital road links

2. "Sikkim Sundari" recently seen in news refers to:

- A. A military operation
B. A tourism campaign
C. A border road project
D. A community radio station

Answer: d

- **The Indian Army has launched "Sikkim Sundari", the first community radio station in a border village of Sikkim.**
- **"Sikkim Sundari" has been established to provide timely access to essential information in geographically isolated regions.**

3. Ru-Soam refers to:

- A. A traditional irrigation system
B. A bamboo-based suspension footbridge
C. A tribal dance form
D. A medicinal practice

Answer: B

- UNESCO and the Government of Sikkim have partnered to systematically document the Ru-Soam indigenous engineering practices of the Lepcha community.
- Ru-Soam refers to the traditional cane and bamboo footbridges engineered by the Lepcha community in Sikkim, particularly within the Khangchendzonga Biosphere Reserve.
- These structures are living expressions of indigenous ingenuity, crafted entirely from locally available, renewable materials.

Assam

4. Gamocha, the traditional towel also known as Bihuwaan, is associated with which of the following festivals?

- A. Baisakhi
B. Rongali Bihu
C. Onam
D. Pongal

Answer: B

▪ **Rongali Bihu Celebrations Mark Assamese New Year Festivities**

It is one of the major festivals of Assam which is commonly known as Bohag bihu.

- It is the most popular Bihu that celebrates the onset of the Assamese New Year and the coming of spring. During the celebration, traditional pat or muga silk or cotton mekhela chadors are worn by ladies (the two-piece attire).
- As a sign of affection and respect, gamocha, the traditional Assamese towel, also known as Bihuwaan, is exchanged

5. Exercise Jal Rahat was conducted at:

- A. IIT Guwahati
B. IIT Delhi
C. IIT Kanpur
D. IIT Roorkee

Answer: A

- The Indian Army conducted a large-scale joint flood relief exercise, "Exercise Jal Rahat," at the Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati.
- **The exercise was organised by the Red Horns Division under the Gajraj Corps** to strengthen preparedness for flood-related emergencies in the region.

Arunachal Pradesh

1. Bhismanagar, located in Arunachal Pradesh, is known for:

- A. Mughal architecture
- B. Ancient civilization remains
- C. Buddhist caves
- D. Colonial buildings

Answer: B

- India has officially rejected China's latest attempt to rename places in Arunachal Pradesh, labeling it a mischievous attempt to manufacture baseless narratives.
- **Capital:** Itanagar.
- **The state finds mention in the Mahabharata and Kalika Purana as the Prabhu Mountains.**
- Legend holds that Lord Krishna married Rukmini here and Sage Vyasa meditated in its hills.
- **Archaeological Heritage:** Remains at sites like Ita Fort (14th century) and Bhismanagar testify to its ancient civilization.

2. The Kamala and Kalai-II Hydroelectric projects have been approved in which state?

- A. Arunachal Pradesh
- B. Assam
- C. Sikkim
- D. Meghalaya

Answer: A

- The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) approved investing ₹26,069.5 crore for the construction of Kamala Hydro Electric project, alongside an investment of ₹14,105.83 crore to construct the Kalai-II hydro-electric project.
- Cumulatively, infusing about ₹40,176 crore to construct two major hydroelectric power projects in the northeastern state.
- The Kamala Hydro-electric project would account for a total installed capacity of 1,720 megawatts and is expected to generate 6,870 million units of energy annually.

Nagaland

1. Consider the following statements about the Konyak tribe:

1. It is a matriarchal society.
2. A majority follow Christianity.
3. They traditionally practiced facial and body tattooing.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 2 and 3 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- The Konyaks can be found in the Mondist of Nagaland and also in the Tirap and Changlang districts of Arunachal.
- The term 'Konyak' is believed to have been derived from the words 'Whao' meaning 'head' and 'Nyak' meaning 'black' translating to 'men with black hair'.
- The Konyak society is a patriarchal society and the eldest son of the family usually inherits the paternal property.
- The Konyaks are of Mongoloid origin and about 95% of the population follows the Christian faith now.
- Traditionally, facial and body tattoos were closely linked to social status and life achievements.

Manipur

1. Khongjom Day is observed annually in which state?

- A. Assam
- B. Nagaland
- C. Manipur
- D. Mizoram

Answer: C.

- On 23rd April, Manipur observed Khongjom Day at the Khongjom War Memorial Complex in Thoubal District.
- The event was graced by Governor Ajay Kumar Bhalla.
- Every year, Khongjom Day is observed on April 23 to commemorate the valour and sacrifice of Manipuri heroes who laid down their lives in the historic Anglo-Manipuri War of 1891.

2. The tagline of the Assam Rifles' community radio station 'Radio Highway', launched in Manipur is:

- A. Voice of the Hills
- B. Border Vaani
- C. Manipur Speaks
- D. Pallel ki Vaani

Answer: d

- Assam Rifles launches a Community Radio Station at Pallel Garrison in Manipur
- The station, named "Radio Highway" with the tagline "Pallel ki Vaani," was established under Operation Sadbhavana.
- Its primary goal is to bridge communication gaps in remote areas of Manipur where difficult terrain and limited mobile connectivity present significant challenge

Meghalaya

1. The Uiam River is a tributary of the:

- A. Barak River
- B. Brahmaputra River

- C. Teesta River
D. Manas River

Answer: B.

- **Uiam Lake**, also known as **Barapani Lake**, is a **man-made reservoir** in the state of Meghalaya 15 km north of Shillong, the capital of Meghalaya.
- **Uiam River**, is a **tributary of the Brahmaputra River**.

2. Kulsi River is considered an important refuge for the endangered:

- A. Gharial
B. Gangetic Dolphin
C. Golden Mahseer
D. Smooth-coated Otter

Answer: B.

- A proposed hydropower project on the Kulsi River is facing opposition from local residents.
- It is a south-bank tributary of the Brahmaputra River.
- The river is known as Khri in the upper catchments, and after being joined by two **other tributaries, namely Krishniya and Umsiri, within the Khasi hills in Meghalaya**, it flows northwest and enters Assam at Ukium.
- It is considered one of the **last refuges of the endangered Gangetic dolphin (Platanista gangetica gangetica) in Assam**.

3. The Meghalaya Cabinet has declared which of the following as official languages of the state, in addition to English?

- A. Khasi and Garo
B. Khasi and Mizo
C. Garo and Bodo
D. Khasi and Assamese

Answer: A

- The Meghalaya cabinet announced the indigenous Khasi and Garo languages as the official languages of the state, in addition to English.
- The approval of the Meghalaya Official Languages Ordinance, 2026 by the state cabinet.
- **The move comes amid a long-standing demand for the inclusion of Khasi and Garo – the languages of the state's two largest tribes – in the Eight Schedule of the Constitution.** Currently, all official business in the state is carried out in English

Rajasthan

1. Consider the following statements regarding Amber Fort:

It is built on the banks of the Yamuna River.

Its architecture is exclusively Mughal in style.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
B. 2 only
C. Both 1 and 2
D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D.

- The Rajasthan High Court, while hearing a plea against **alleged illegal elephant rides near Amber Fort**, recently issued notices to the state govt. and multiple respondents.
- Amber Fort, also known as Amer Fort, is located in Amer, a town located approximately 11 kilometers from the city of Jaipur in Rajasthan.
- **It was constructed atop a hill.** It was originally **built by Raja Man Singh I**, the Kachwaha Rajput ruler, in the late 16th century.
- **Man Singh was one of the trusted generals of Emperor Akbar** and one among the Navaratnas of his court.
- It underwent significant expansion and renovation under the reign of Jai Singh I as he is credited with constructing the impressive Diwan-i-Khas (Hall of Private Audience) and the Sheesh Mahal (Mirror Palace) within the fort complex.
- **It is a UNESCO World Heritage Site. Its architecture is a noteworthy fusion of Rajput (Hindu) and Mughal (Islamic) styles.** It was built using pink and yellow sandstones.

Gujarat

1. NARIT-AI has been introduced primarily to:

- A. Enhance cyber security operations
B. Improve conviction rates in narcotics cases
C. Monitor financial frauds
D. Regulate digital currencies

Answer: B

- **The Gujarat Police has introduced** the Narcotics Analysis & RAG-based Investigation Tool (NARIT-AI) **to address declining conviction rates in drug-related cases**, which fell to 25% in 2022.
- NARIT-AI is a specialized, private artificial intelligence system designed to assist law enforcement officers in the investigation and prosecution of complex narcotics cases.
- **it operates within a closed environment specifically trained on Indian legal statutes and judicial precedents.**

2. Kankaria Coaching Depot, India's first 'water-neutral' railway depot, is located in which state?

- A. Maharashtra
B. Rajasthan

- C. Gujarat
D. Madhya Pradesh

Answer: C

- Kankaria Coaching Depot in Ahmedabad has become India's first 'water-neutral' railway depot **by recycling wastewater used in coach washing and maintenance.**
- The Kankaria Coaching Depot in Ahmedabad, Gujarat, is the first railway depot in India to achieve water neutrality by treating and reusing wastewater generated during routine railway coach cleaning and maintenance.
- It **minimizes freshwater dependency by ensuring that almost all operational water demand is met through recycled water, promoting sustainable railway infrastructure.**

Maharashtra

1. "Operation Dhahabu Blitz" refers to:

- A. An anti-smuggling operation targeting gold trafficking
B. A cyber security drill by CERT-In
C. A military exercise of the Indian Army
D. A space mission by ISRO

Answer: A

- DRI Mumbai busts gold smuggling syndicate in Op Dhahabu Blitz; approx. 30 kg gold worth ₹38 crore seized, 24 women carriers arrested
- Under Operation Dhahabu Blitz, 24 foreign nationals were intercepted.

2. The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) recently discovered a T-shaped stepped reservoir on which island?

- A. Majuli Island
B. Rameswaram Island
C. Diu Island
D. Elephanta Island

Answer: D

- The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) has unearthed a 1,500-year-old T-shaped stepped reservoir on Elephanta Island, highlighting advanced ancient water management.
- A T-shaped massive structure (14.7m long) built with imported stone blocks from the mainland, used to combat the island's rocky runoff and store monsoon water.
- Elephanta Island, locally known as Gharapuri (City of Caves), is a UNESCO World Heritage site located in the Mumbai Harbour.
- The caves are carved out of [solid basalt rock](#), typical of the Deccan Trap formations.

3. Recently, the 'My Village, Health-Prosperous Village' campaign was launched by which of the following states?

- A. Gujarat
B. Madhya Pradesh
C. Karnataka
D. Maharashtra

Answer: d

- The Maharashtra government on April 1 rolled out the '**Mazhe Gaav, Aarogya Sampann Gaav**' (**My Village, Health-Prosperous Village**) campaign, a statewide initiative to bolster rural healthcare delivery and expand access to public health services.
- The programme is being implemented by the Public Health Department .

4. Consider the following statements regarding incentives under the Maharashtra AI Policy 2026:

1. Up to 20% capital subsidy is provided.
2. 100% stamp duty exemption is offered.
3. Power tariff subsidy is ₹5 per unit for 5 years.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- The state Cabinet approved the Maharashtra Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy 2026, aiming to attract over Rs 10,000 crore in investment and generate 1.5 lakh jobs by 2031
- The policy proposes setting up a Maharashtra AI Mission, five AI innovation cities and six sectoral Centres of Excellence
- To attract investment, incentives include up to 20 per cent capital subsidy, 100 per cent stamp duty exemption and a power tariff subsidy of Rs 2 per unit for up to 10 years, along with reimbursements for patents, certification costs and participation in international exhibitions.

5. The Virli Khandar archaeological site is located in:

- A. Madhya Pradesh
B. Maharashtra
C. Chhattisgarh
D. Telangana

Answer: B

- An ongoing excavation at a megalithic site in Virli Khandar has revealed distinctive burial architecture, rare artefacts and unusual pottery arrangements, offering fresh insights into ancient funerary practices in Vidarbha.
- **The site, located in Pauni tehsil of Bhandara district, in Maharashtra is currently being excavated**

6. 'Khagol Darshan Mahotsav 2026', recently in news, is:

- A. A cultural dance festival
- B. A stargazing festival
- C. A wildlife conservation event
- D. A space launch mission

Answer: B

- The Maharashtra Tourism Development Corporation (MTDC) has launched the **Khagol Darshan Mahotsav 2026, the state's first-ever stargazing festival.**
- The event is taking place at **Lonar Crater in Buldhana and Harihareshwar in Raigad from April 24 to 26, 2026.**

Goa

1. The headquarters of the Commonwealth Parliamentary Association is located in:

- A. Ottawa, Canada
- B. Canberra, Australia
- C. New Delhi, India
- D. London, United Kingdom

Answer: d

- Recently, the Commonwealth Parliamentary Association India Region Zone VII Conference was inaugurated in Goa by the Lok Sabha Speaker.
- Commonwealth Parliamentary Association is one of the oldest established organisations in the Commonwealth.

2. Which of the following best describes SAMPANN?

- (a) A decentralised manual pension system
- (b) A cloud-based end-to-end pension management platform
- (c) A blockchain-based telecom monitoring tool
- (d) A satellite-based communication system

Answer: b

- Recently, the Goa government and the Cochin Port Authority have taken a significant step towards modernizing pension disbursement by signing agreements to onboard the SAMPANN digital platform.
- SAMPANN (System for Accounting and Management of Pension) is the flagship digital pension and financial management platform of the Department of Telecommunications.
- It is managed by the Office of the Controller General of Communication Accounts (CGCA).
- It is a cloud-based, end-to-end pension management system of the Department of Telecommunications.

Telangana

1. The 'Arrive Alive' campaign is related to:

- A. Cyber security awareness
- B. Road safety and accident prevention

C. Women safety initiatives

D. Anti-drug campaign

Answer: B

- Cyberabad Police, Hyderabad, Telangana launched the 'Arrive Alive' campaign in Gachibowli, aimed at preventing road accidents and promoting safe travel among motorists and pedestrians.
- **The top priority for police is to ensure that every citizen reaches home safely and stressed that road safety is a shared responsibility.**

2. Which state has recently made cancer a notifiable disease?

- A. Karnataka
- B. Tamil Nadu
- C. Telangana
- D. Maharashtra

Answer: C

- The Telangana government has issued orders making cancer a notifiable disease, mandating compulsory registration and reporting of all diagnosed cases across the State as part of a move to strengthen surveillance and public health response.

3. Operation Chabutra is primarily aimed at:

- (a) Promoting tourism
- (b) Controlling late-night crime and public disturbances
- (c) Urban infrastructure development
- (d) Slum rehabilitation

Answer: (b)

- The initiative titled Operation Chabutra is being carried out across Hyderabad, Telangana particularly in the south and Old City areas, where police **say complaints of harassment, intimidation and petty crime tend to surface after midnight.**
- The operation involves **intensified patrolling and surprise crackdowns on groups of youths gathering on streets after midnight.**

4. The **EAGLE Force** initiative is primarily related to:

- A. Cybercrime prevention
- B. Anti-drug enforcement
- C. Disaster management
- D. Wildlife protection

Answer: B

- The Telangana Police launched an AI-enabled website for the **Elite Action Group for Drug Law Enforcement (EAGLE Force)**, aimed at strengthening public participation and enhancing the State's anti-drug efforts.

- The website introduces a suite of artificial intelligence-driven tools focused on prevention and early intervention.

5. 'Operation Octopus 2.0' is aimed at cracking down on:

- A. Drug trafficking networks
- B. Organised cyber fraud networks
- C. Illegal mining syndicates
- D. Human trafficking rackets

Answer: B

- **Hyderabad City Police** arrested 52 persons, including 32 bank officials, in a coordinated multi-state crackdown on organised cyber fraud networks under 'Operation Octopus 2.0',
- Carried out across nine States over seven days, targeting bank officials, mule account holders and intermediaries allegedly involved in facilitating large-scale cyber frauds.

6. Hussain Sagar Lake is located in:

- A. Bengaluru, Karnataka
- B. Hyderabad, Telangana
- C. Udaipur, Rajasthan
- D. Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh

Answer: B.

- Hussain Sagar lake is **emitting a strong foul odour as rising summer temperatures trigger heavy algal bloom.**
- It is an artificial lake located in Hyderabad, Telangana.
- It is also called Tank Bund and lies on a tributary of River Musi.
- **It is the largest heart-shaped mark among the marks** formed by 78 heart-shaped lakes and 9 heart-shaped islands on the face of the earth.

7. The 'Spandana' all-women first responder system, recently seen in news, has been launched by which state?

- A. Karnataka
- B. Telangana
- C. Maharashtra
- D. Tamil Nadu

Answer: B

- The Telangana government launched 'Spandana', an all-women first responder system aimed at strengthening safety measures for women and children in the city.

8. The National Institute for Pre-Clinical Research (NIPCR) is located in:

- A. Bengaluru
- B. Pune
- C. Hyderabad
- D. Ahmedabad

Answer: C

- **The Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) has officially upgraded and renamed its Hyderabad-based animal resource facility to the National Institute for Pre-Clinical Research (NIPCR).**
- The National Institute for Pre-Clinical Research (NIPCR) is a flagship permanent institute under the aegis of the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR).

Andhra Pradesh

1. Which city has been designated as the sole capital of Andhra Pradesh under the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation (Amendment) Bill, 2026?

- (a) Hyderabad
- (b) Visakhapatnam
- (c) Amaravati
- (d) Vijayawada

Answer: (c)

- Parliament has passed the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation (Amendment) Bill, 2026, with the Rajya Sabha approving it
- The Lok Sabha has already passed a Bill, which amends the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014. **It accords statutory status to Amaravati as the sole capital of Andhra Pradesh.**

2. Araku Valley is famous for:

- A. Wheat production
- B. Organic coffee cultivation
- C. Sugarcane farming
- D. Oilseed production

Answer: B.

- **The 17th annual Old Seed Festival held in Killoguda village of the Araku region in Andhra Pradesh** highlighted the importance of conserving indigenous seed diversity and strengthening natural farming practices.
- **Organised by the Sanjeevini organisation,**
- **Araku Valley is famous for organic coffee cultivation and tribal farming systems.**

Karnataka

1. The Guru Bhairavaikya Mandira, recently inaugurated, is located in which state?

- A. Tamil Nadu
- B. Andhra Pradesh
- C. Karnataka
- D. Kerala

Answer: C

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi on April 15, 2026, inaugurated the Guru Bhairavaikya Mandira at Sri Kshetra Adichunchanagiri in Karnataka's Mandya district.

- The Guru Bhairavaikya Mandira has been built in honour of Sri Sri Sri Dr Balagangadharanatha Mahaswamiji, the 71st pontiff of the Adichunchanagiri Math.

2. Appemidi mango has received Geographical Indication (GI) tag in:

- A. 2005
- B. 2007
- C. 2009
- D. 2012

Answer: C

- Appemidi mango (tender mango in Kannada) is facing the threat of climate change and experts are stressing the need for in-situ conservation of the natural trees in the Aghanashini valley of Karnataka.
- Appemidi Mango is found exclusively in the **Uttara Kannada and Shivamogga districts of Karnataka.**
- It is small and tender; it is regarded as the king among raw mango varieties. **It has received GI (geographical indication) tag in 2009 in recognition of its culinary and cultural heritage,**

3. Sree Chamundeshwari Temple is located in:

- A. Tamil Nadu
- B. Karnataka
- C. Kerala
- D. Andhra Pradesh

Answer: B

- The Karnataka High Court has taken strong exception to the State defying judicial orders prohibiting construction activities in Sree Chamundeshwari Temple, Mysuru
- **It is a Hindu temple located on the top of Chamundi Hills, about 13 km from the palace city of Mysuru in the state of Karnataka.**
- It is dedicated to Goddess Chamundeshwari, who is an avatar of Durga.

4. The "Namma 112" emergency response system is associated with which city?

- A. Hyderabad
- B. Chennai
- C. Mumbai
- D. Bengaluru

Answer: D.

- The Bengaluru police rolled out a first-of-its-kind multilingual upgrade to the Namma 112 emergency response system, designed to ensure that cries for help are no longer lost in translation.

5. The 'Aditya' high-speed bullet train manufacturing plant is located in:

- A. Bengaluru
- B. Hyderabad
- C. Chennai
- D. Pune

Answer: A

- **Union Railway minister Ashwini Vaishnaw inaugurated Atma nirbhar high speed bullet train manufacturing plant Aditya in Bengaluru BEML Limited (formerly known as Bharat Earth Movers Limited)**
- **Aditya, a specialised complex dedicated to the manufacturing of high-speed rail**

Keralam

1. 'Operation Earth Guard' was launched in which state?

- 'A. Tamil Nadu
- B. Karnataka
- C. Kerala
- D. Andhra Pradesh

Answer: C

- The Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau (VACB) **launched a Statewide surprise inspection drive titled 'Operation Earth Guard'** following intelligence inputs about widespread irregularities, violations and corruption in the excavation and transportation of ordinary earth across **Kerala**

2. Consider the following statements regarding the Muthuvan tribe:

1. The Muthuvan practice clan endogamy and community exogamy.
2. They follow a unique governance system called the Kani System.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: b

- A recent report by the Kerala Food Commission has **spotlighted significant discrepancies in the distribution of ration supplies in Edamalakkudy, Kerala's sole tribal panchayat, primarily inhabited by the Muthuvan tribe.**
- The Muthuvans, or Mudugars, live in the Western Ghats mountains in the Indian states of Kerala and Tamil Nadu.
- There are **two different groups** among the Muthuvan, and they speak slightly different

dialects, **they call each other Malayalam Muthuvan and Pandi Muthuvan.**

- They are known for coexisting with the wildlife with their traditional knowledge and understanding of hills.
- The Muthuvan adhere to community endogamy and clan exogamy.
- These tribal people follow a unique system of governance called the 'Kani System'.

3. The 'Uyare' initiative primarily aims to:

- A. Promote digital banking
- B. Strengthen grassroots entrepreneurship among women
- C. Develop infrastructure in rural areas
- D. Enhance agricultural productivity

Answer: B

- Indian Institute of Management Kozhikode has launched the 'Uyare' project.
- The initiative is a research-led initiative aimed at strengthening grassroots entrepreneurship among women associated with the Kudumbashree network.

4. Thrissur Pooram is associated with which temple?

- A. Guruvayur Temple
- B. Sabarimala Temple
- C. Vadakkunnathan Temple
- D. Padmanabhaswamy Temple

Answer: C

Thrissur Pooram

- It is one of the most popular temple festivals in Kerala.
- It is held at the **Thekkinkadu Maidanam of Vadakkunnathan Temple in the heart of the Thrissur district, every year in the Malayalam month of Medam (April-May).**

Tamil Nadu

1. Consider the following statements regarding the Noyyal River:

1. It is a seasonal river dependent on monsoon rainfall.
 2. It flows into the Arabian Sea.
- Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?
- 1 only
 - B. 2 only
 - C. Both 1 and 2
 - D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- **Noyyal River is a tributary of the Kaveri River and flows through Tamil Nadu.**

- It begins from numerous small streams in the Vellingiri Hills of the Western Ghats.
- It flows through the districts of Coimbatore, Tirupur, and Erode and meets the Cauvery River at the Noyyal village in Karur District. **It is a seasonal river with rapid flows during the monsoon periods.**

2. The prehistoric rock painting site 'Oor Pare' was recently rediscovered in:

- A. Karnataka
- B. Kerala
- C. Tamil Nadu
- D. Andhra Pradesh

Answer: C

- Recently, the Yaakai Heritage Trust reported the rediscovery of a prehistoric rock painting site called Oor Pare in the Nilgiris district of Tamil Nadu.
- The site is located near Vellarikombai village in the Kotagiri region, at an altitude of around 1100 meters above sea level.

3. The Pykara River is considered sacred by which tribal community?

- A. Santhal
- B. Bhil
- C. Toda
- D. Gond

Answer: C

- The Madras High Court has refused to lift the temporary stay on operating boating services for tourists on Pykara Lake in the Nilgiris district, Tamil Nadu.
- Pykara Lake is situated at a distance of about 20 km from Ooty, in the Nilgiri district of Tamil Nadu.
- The Pykara River, which originates from the Mukurthi peak, is the largest river in the district and is revered by the Todas, an Adivasi community, who consider it to be sacred.

Defence

1. Consider the following statements regarding INS Nireekshak:

1. It was built by Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited.
2. It was commissioned in 1995.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

INS Nireekshak

- It is a Dive Support and Submarine Rescue Vessel of the Indian Navy.
- **Built by Mazgaon Shipbuilders in 1985**, the ship has been in service with the Navy since 1989 and was commissioned in the year 1995.
- Pakistan has successfully test-fired an indigenously developed 'Taimoor' air-launched cruise missile (ALCM).
- **The anti-ship weapon system can reportedly strike land and sea targets at ranges of up to 600 km.**

2. The first high-level conference of the Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) to be hosted by India will be chaired by whom?

- A. Union Home Minister
- B. Union Defence Minister
- C. Prime Minister of India
- D. National Security Advisor

Answer: C

- India will host the first high-level conference of Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) where Prime Minister Narendra Modi will be the chairperson.

3. Consider the following statements regarding Astra Mk-2:

1. It has a strike range of around 240 km.
2. It is designed for air-to-air combat.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- **India is planning to equip Mirage 2000 jets with Astra Mk2 missiles, enabling long-range interception up to 240 km and strengthening aerial dominance.**
- It is a Beyond Visual Range (BVR) air-to-air missile.

- It is being developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO).
- Range: 200–240 km (high altitude conditions)

4. 'Prajna', recently seen in the news, is an indigenous:

- A. Missile defence system
- B. Quantum communication network
- C. Cybersecurity platform
- D. Satellite imaging system

Answer: c

- The Ministry of Home Affairs has received an indigenously developed satellite imaging system, **'Prajna', to enhance the real-time decision support for the security agencies.**
- The **AI-enabled system**, developed by the DRDO's Centre for Artificial Intelligence and Robotics (CAIR), will strengthen the country's internal security, playing a key role in monitoring sensitive regions and supporting counter-terrorism operations.

5. The R-37M missile has been developed by:

- A. United States
- B. Israel
- C. France
- D. Russia

Answer: D

- In a major development for India's air superiority, **Moscow, Russia recently greenlit the sale of its formidable R-37M ultra-long-range air-to-air missile to New Delhi.**
- The R-37M missile, known by its NATO reporting name AA-13 Axehead, is a long-range air-to-air missile developed by Russia.
- It is **designed to eliminate enemy fighter jets and drones beyond visual range (BVR).**
- People often call the **R-37M an "AWACS Killer"** because it can go after large and important enemy aircraft.

6. INS Kalpeni is a Fast Attack Craft built by which of the following shipyards?

- A. Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- B. Cochin Shipyard Limited
- C. Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers Limited
- D. Hindustan Shipyard Limited

Answer: C

- An Indian Navy fast attack craft, INS Kalpeni, recently arrived at Gan in the Addu Atoll, marking a significant step in the ongoing maritime engagement between India and the Maldives.
- It is a fast attack craft of the Indian Navy.

- It belongs to a series of 10 Fleet Car Nicobar class Waterjet Fast Attack Craft (FAC) built by the Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE), Kolkata for the Indian Navy.

7. Project DANTAK, recently in news, is associated with:

- A. Space research in India
- B. Infrastructure development in Bhutan
- C. River interlinking in India
- D. Defence manufacturing

Answer: B

- Project DANTAK of the Border Roads Organisation (BRO) celebrated its 66th Raising Day, in Thimphu, Bhutan.
- Project DANTAK is a premier infrastructure development initiative by the Government of India in the Kingdom of Bhutan.
- Organisation: It is a project under the Border Roads Organisation (BRO) of India.

8. The International Hall of Fame of the US Army War College inducted General _____, making him the third Indian Army Chief to receive this honour after General _____ and General _____.

- A. Manoj Pande; V K Singh; Bikram Singh
- B. Upendra Dwivedi; V K Singh; Bikram Singh
- C. Bipin Rawat; Dalbir Singh Suhag; V K Singh
- D. Dalbir Singh Suhag; Bikram Singh; Bipin Rawat

Answer: B

- India's Army chief General Upendra Dwivedi was inducted into the International Hall of Fame of the US Army War College in Pennsylvania, becoming the third Indian head of the army to receive such honour.
- General Dwivedi, a distinguished fellow of the US Army War College, is the third Indian Chief of Armed Forces to be inducted in the International Hall of Fame after General V K Singh and General Bikram Singh.

9. The Atlas drone swarm system, recently in news, has been developed by:

- A. China Aerospace Science and Technology Corporation
- B. Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
- C. Israel Aerospace Industries
- D. China Electronic Technology Group Corporation

Answer: D

- The Chinese recently unveiled the Atlas drone swarm system, a state-of-the-art military asset

capable of launching and controlling nearly 100 drones through a single human operator.

- The Atlas system is an independent, mobile drone **swarm operations unit that serves as a mini-battlefield network on wheels.**
- Developed By:** The system is manufactured by the China Electronic Technology Group Corporation (CETC), a state-owned conglomerate.

10. Consider the following statements regarding Exercise 'Pragati':

It is a bilateral exercise between India and Sri Lanka.

It will be held at Umroi in Meghalaya.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: b

- The Indian Army is set to host military delegations from 11 friendly countries for the inaugural edition of the multilateral exercise 'Pragati' at the Foreign Training Node in Umroi, Meghalaya.
- 'Pragati' – an acronym for Partnership of Regional Armies for Growth and Transformation in the Indian Ocean Region – symbolises efforts toward cooperative growth and security.

11. The NASM-SR is best described as:

- A. Surface-to-air missile
- B. Ballistic missile
- C. Air-launched anti-ship missile
- D. Submarine-launched nuclear missile

Answer: C

- India achieved a significant milestone in its **indigenous maritime strike program by successfully conducting the maiden salvo launch of the Naval Anti-Ship Missile Short Range (NASM-SR) from a Sea King helicopter.**
- An advanced, air-launched anti-ship missile system designed **to replace aging foreign-origin missiles like the British Sea Eagle**

12. With reference to Exercise Cyclone-IV, consider the following statements:

- It is a joint special forces exercise between India and Egypt.
- The 4th edition is being held in India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- The Indian Army contingent has departed for Egypt to participate in the fourth edition of the India - Egypt Joint Special Forces Exercise, Cyclone - IV, scheduled to be conducted at Anshas from 09 to 17 April 2026.
- It is a joint special force exercise held between India – Egypt.
- It is the fourth edition of this exercise.

13. Consider the following statements:

1. Exercise Dustlik is conducted between India and Uzbekistan.
2. It is a naval exercise.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- Recently, the Indian Army contingent departed for participating in the 7th edition of the Exercise Dustlik.
- It is a joint military exercise conducted between India and Uzbekistan.
- The drill is scheduled to be conducted at the Gurumsaray Field Training Area in Namangam, Uzbekistan, from April 12-25,

14. Consider the following statements regarding the Samudra Sahas Expedition:

1. It includes routes between Mumbai, Vijaydurg, and Goa.
2. It is conducted solely by the Indian Navy.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- The Samudra Sahas Sailing Expedition, undertaken by the Regiment of Artillery as part of its bicentenary celebrations, was ceremonially flagged off from Marve, Mumbai
- The voyage is being conducted in four legs: Mumbai to Vijaydurg, Vijaydurg to Goa, Goa to Vijaydurg and Vijaydurg to Mumbai.
- The expedition is being conducted with administrative and operational support from the Indian Navy and the Indian Coast Guard.

15. The Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW SWC) Malwan has been manufactured by which of the following organizations?

- A. Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
- B. Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- C. Cochin Shipyard Limited
- D. Hindustan Shipyard Limited

Answer: C

- Malwan is a high-tech, waterjet-propelled warship designed specifically for specialized naval operations in coastal and shallow waters.
- Manufacturer: The ship was indigenously designed and constructed by Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL), Kochi.

16. Which of the following constellations is featured in the crest of INS Shachi, the lead ship of the Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel (NGOPV) class?

- A. Orion
- B. Cassiopeia
- C. Andromeda
- D. Ursa Major

Answer: D

- The Indian Navy marked a major indigenous shipbuilding milestone with the launch of Shachi (Yard 1280), the first of eleven Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessels (NGOPVs), at Goa Shipyard Limited.
- Shachi is the lead ship of the Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel (NGOPV). The name is derived from Indian mythology, meaning one who renders assistance.
- The crest of INS Shachi, the lead ship of the Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel (NGOPV), features the Ursa Major constellation (also commonly referred to as the Saptarishi constellation in India).

17. INS Taragiri has been built by:

- (a) Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL)
- (b) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)
- (c) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL)
- (d) Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL)

Answer: (c)

- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh commissioned the advanced stealth frigate INS Taragiri in Visakhapatnam.
- The warship is an advanced stealth frigate under Project 17A of the Indian Navy.
- Built by Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL), Mumbai,

18. India commissioned its third nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine (SSBN), INS _____ (S4). INS _____ was the first vessel under the SSBN project and was launched in July 2009 and commissioned in 2016, followed by INS _____.

- (a) Aridhaman; Arihant; Arighat
- (b) Chakra; Arihant; Kalvari
- (c) Arihant; Vagir; Khanderi
- (d) Arighat; Sindhughosh; Vela

Answer: (a)

- India commissioned its third nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine (SSBN) Aridhaman (S4).
- INS Aridhaman, a larger 7,000-tonne vessel, will carry more K-15 missiles, as well as the longer-range K-4 nuclear-capable submarine-launched ballistic missiles (SLBM) that can hit targets 3,500 km away.
- INS Arihant was the first vessel under the SSBN project, and was followed by INS Arighat. INS Arihant was launched in July 2009 and was quietly commissioned in 2016.
- The second indigenous SSBN, INS Arighat, was commissioned in August 2024.

19. Project Chetak is associated with which organization?

- A. National Highways Authority of India
- B. Border Roads Organisation
- C. Central Public Works Department
- D. Indian Army Corps of Engineers

Answer: B

- Project Chetak of the Border Roads Organisation (BRO) celebrated its 47th Raising Day at Bikaner in Rajasthan, marking over four decades of dedicated service in the strategically important regions of the western sector.
- On this day in 1980, the project played a vital role in developing and maintaining infrastructure in Rajasthan, Punjab and the northern parts of Gujarat.

20. INS Sunayna belongs to which class of vessels?

- A. Shivalik-class
- B. Kolkata-class
- C. Saryu-class
- D. Talwar-class

Answer: C

- Recently, the Indian Navy's offshore patrol vessel INS Sunayna reached Male as part of its deployment under the Indian Ocean Ship (IOS) SAGAR initiative.
- It is the second Saryu-class offshore patrol vessel of the Indian Navy.

- It was designed and constructed indigenously by the Goa Shipyard Limited.
- It was commissioned at Kochi on 15th October 2013.

21. Exercise Brahmastra was conducted at:

- A. Mahajan Field Firing Range
- B. Pokhran Field Firing Range
- C. Chandipur Test Range
- D. Balasore Range

Answer: B

- The Indian Army demonstrated the combat strength of its latest attack helicopter, the Boeing AH-64 Apache, during a live firing exercise 'Brahmastra' at the Pokhran Firing Range.
- The exercise aimed to test both operational readiness and coordination between pilots and ground crews

22. The Advanced Light Helicopter (ALH) Mk III (MR) is manufactured by:

- A. Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
- B. Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- C. Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
- D. Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)

Answer: C

- Recently, the Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) handed over four Advanced Light Helicopter (ALH) Mk III Maritime Role (MR) helicopters to the Indian Coast Guard.
- It is the maritime variant of the indigenous Dhruv Advanced Helicopter.
- These have been indigenously manufactured by Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL).

23. The first edition of the Indian Navy's biannual Commanders' Conference 2026 was held at:

- A. INS Vikramaditya
- B. Nausena Bhawan, New Delhi
- C. Naval War College, Goa
- D. Southern Naval Command, Kochi

Answer: B

- First edition of Indian Navy's biannual Commanders' Conference 2026 is scheduled over a period of three days at Nausena Bhawan, New Delhi, from 14 Apr to 16 Apr 2026.
- The Apex Level Conference offers a stage for comprehensive review of Navy's operational posture to protect national maritime interests, capability development and strategic alignment with national security objectives.

24. The Hwasong-11Ga missile, recently in news, is developed by:

- A. China
- B. Russia
- C. North Korea
- D. South Korea

Answer: C

- North Korea recently conducted a series of weapons tests including the launch of a Hwasong-11ga fitted with a cluster munition warhead.
- The Hwasong-11Ga, known as the KN-23 in the West, is a short-range ballistic missile.
- It was developed by North Korea

25. INS Dhruv, India's first dedicated missile-tracking and ocean-surveillance ship, was commissioned in which year?

- A. 2019
- B. 2020
- C. 2021
- D. 2022

Answer: C

- Recently, the Indian Navy has deployed its specialised missile-tracking and ocean-surveillance vessel INS Dhruv into the Arabian Sea immediately before Pakistan's declared live-firing window.
- It is India's first dedicated nuclear missile tracking and ocean surveillance ship.
- It was commissioned on 10 September 2021

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Science & tech

1. Consider the following statements regarding the Curiosity Rover:

1. The rover detected organic molecules, including some identified for the first time on Jupiter.
2. It is a joint mission of NASA and ESA.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: d

- The Curiosity rover, part of NASA's Mars Science Laboratory mission, has found a mix of organic molecules on Mars.
- This includes chemicals that are considered to be the "building blocks of life".
- **Of the 21 carbon-containing molecules in the sample, seven have been detected for the first time on Mars,** The detection has renewed the confirmation that the red planet once use to have the right chemistry to support life.

2. Consider the following statements regarding the Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope:

1. It will operate from Low Earth Orbit like the Hubble Space Telescope.
2. It is designed to study dark energy, galaxy formation, and exoplanets.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B.

- NASA has completed the final assembly of the Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope
- **built at the Goddard Space Flight Center in Maryland,** the observatory is expected to become one of the most powerful survey telescopes ever developed.
- **Roman will study dark energy, galaxy formation and distant planetary systems on an unprecedented scale**
- Its main mirror is 2.4 metres wide, similar in size to the Hubble Space Telescope.
- The Roman Space Telescope **will operate from Lagrange Point 2 (L2),** nearly one million miles from Earth.

3. BlueBird 7 satellite, launched aboard Blue Origin's New Glenn rocket, is designed to:

- A. Support lunar exploration
- B. Connect directly with smartphones
- C. Monitor climate change
- D. Provide GPS navigation

Answer: B

- The reusable booster of the New Glenn rocket launched from Florida by Jeff Bezos' company Blue Origin touched down successfully but the rocket failed to deploy the AST BlueBird 7 SpaceMobile communications satellite it was carrying into the correct orbit.
- The booster, named "Never Tell Me the Odds," landed successfully on the drone ship Jacklyn after launch from Cape Canaveral, Florida.

4. The proposed launch year of the G20 Satellite is:

- A. 2025
- B. 2026
- C. 2027
- D. 2030

Answer: C

- Indian Space Research Organisation Chairman V. Narayanan announced that the **proposed G20 Satellite is expected to be launched in 2027 for G20 member nations.**
- **It is designed to study climate change indicators, monitor air pollution patterns, and improve global weather observation and forecasting systems.**

5. The chemical formula of fructose is:

- A. $C_6H_{12}O_6$
- B. $C_{12}H_{22}O_{11}$
- C. $C_6H_{10}O_5$
- D. $C_5H_{10}O_5$

Answer: A.

- A recent study presents **fructose as a significant biological driver of conditions such as obesity, metabolic syndrome, and related chronic illnesses,** challenging conventional understandings of dietary sugars.
- It is a **member of a group of carbohydrates known as simple sugars, or monosaccharides.**
- **Chemical Formula:** $C_6H_{12}O_6$ (same as glucose but with a different structure).

6. Dung beetles have been observed to navigate in straight lines at night using:

- A. Earth's magnetic field
- B. Sunlight reflection
- C. Band of light from the Milky Way
- D. Ocean currents

Answer: C

- Scientists have discovered that **dung beetles roll in remarkably straight lines—even in complete darkness by using the band of light created by our galaxy, the Milky Way.**
- The Dung Beetle, scientifically known as the Scarabaeidae family within the Animal Kingdom's order Coleoptera.
- They are robust, compact insects known for their hard, protective exoskeletons and strong, clawed legs adapted for digging and rolling dung.

7. The Rosalind Franklin mission is a joint initiative of which of the following space agencies?

- A. National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) and Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- B. European Space Agency (ESA) and National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)
- C. European Space Agency (ESA) and Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (JAXA)
- D. National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) and Roscosmos State Corporation for Space Activities (Roscosmos)

Answer: B.

- NASA has **given approval for the agency's Rosalind Franklin Support and Augmentation (ROSA) project** to begin implementation, underscoring the agency's continued partnership with ESA's (European Space Agency) Rosalind Franklin mission.
- The **mission, part of the European-led ExoMars programme**, aims to search for signs of past or present life on the Red Planet.
- The Rosalind Franklin rover, developed under the leadership of the European Space Agency with support from NASA, is specifically designed to detect biosignatures of life.

8. The term "memristor" refers to:

- A. A memory storage device only
- B. A resistor with fixed resistance
- C. A device whose resistance depends on past current flow
- D. A semiconductor diode

Answer: C

- **Researchers from the University of Cambridge have reported a new kind of brain-inspired nanodevice, a hafnium-oxide memristor that could dramatically cut artificial intelligence's (AI) energy use.**
- 'Memristor' is a combination of 'memory' and 'resistor'.
- It is an **electronic component whose resistance depends on the history of current flow, allowing it to "remember" past electrical states.**
- A resistor is a small device that applies a fixed amount of resistance to a current passed through it.

9. Glutathione is best described as:

- A. Hormone produced by the pancreas
- B. Antioxidant produced in the body
- C. Vitamin synthesized in the intestine
- D. Enzyme secreted by the stomach

Answer: B

- Glutathione is an antioxidant produced in the body through enzymatic reactions.
- It is a tripeptide consisting of three amino acids (glutamate, cysteine, and glycine) and is naturally produced in the liver.

10. 'Designer rice' has been developed by scientists at:

- A. Indian Agricultural Research Institute (IARI)
- B. CSIR–National Institute for Interdisciplinary Science and Technology (CSIR-NIIST)
- C. Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)
- D. Central Food Technological Research Institute (CFTRI)

Answer: B.

- **Scientists at CSIR – National Institute for Interdisciplinary Science and Technology in Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala, have developed a "designer rice" that packs three times the protein of normal grains** while maintaining a low glycemic index (below 55) to help manage diabetes.
- Instead of genetic modification, the scientists have used **food-processing technology.**
- They took broken rice, the bits usually sold at a discount—ground them into flour, and blended them with protein and micronutrients like iron, folic acid, and Vitamin B12.

11. The R78C malaria vaccine is being developed through collaboration between:

- A. World Health Organization (WHO) and Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)
- B. University of Oxford and Serum Institute of India
- C. United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF) and Bharat Biotech
- D. National Institutes of Health (NIH) and Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)

Answer: B

- The University of Oxford and Serum Institute of India (SII) have entered a license agreement to develop a multi-stage malaria vaccine, R78C.
- This effort aims to enhance malaria vaccine outcomes by targeting different stages of the parasite lifecycle.

12. Recently, the lunar mineral Cerium–Magnesium Chancesite was discovered by researchers from which country?

- A. India
- B. United States
- C. China
- D. Russia

Answer: C

- Chinese researchers have discovered a new lunar mineral named Cerium–Magnesium Chancesite, marking the 11th known mineral identified from the Moon.
- The finding was announced by the China Geological Survey and is considered a major development in extraterrestrial geology.

13. Artemether-lumefantrine, recently in news, is related to:

- A. Treatment of dengue fever
- B. Treatment of malaria
- C. Vaccine for tuberculosis
- D. Prevention of influenza

Answer: B

- The **World Health Organization announced that it had given prequalification approval to a malaria treatment for newborns** and infants for the first time.
- Artemether-lumefantrine is the first antimalarial formulation designed specifically for the youngest victims of the mosquito-borne disease.

14. The Giant Magellan Telescope is planned to be located in:

- A. Chile
- B. Australia
- C. USA
- D. South Africa

Answer: A

- The Giant Magellan Telescope (GMT) is currently in its final design phase as of April 2026.
- The Giant Magellan Telescope Consortium is advancing plans for the Giant Magellan Telescope (GMT), a next-generation observatory that could reshape how scientists study planets, stars, and galaxies.
- The telescope is planned for Las Campanas Observatory in Chile's Atacama Desert, a location known for its exceptionally dark, dry, and stable skies – ideal conditions for astronomy.

15. Which of the following statement/s about dopamine is/are correct?

- 1. It acts as a chemical messenger in the nervous system.
- 2. It mediates pleasure and reward in the brain.
- 3. It is produced only in the brain.

Select the correct answer:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- Dopamine is a hormone and a type of neurotransmitter, or chemical messenger, made in your brain.
- Your nervous system uses it to send messages between nerve cells. These messages also travel between your brain and the rest of your body.
- Dopamine is the chemical that mediates pleasure in the brain.
- Dopamine is also made in other parts of your body, where it acts as a hormone.

16. Consider the following statements regarding Keytruda:

- 1. It is manufactured by a German pharmaceutical company.
- 2. It is an immunotherapy drug used in cancer treatment.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

- Recent investigations have exposed a dangerous counterfeit market for Keytruda in India, where hospital-level breaches and high drug prices have led to fakes being sold to desperate patients.
- Keytruda is the brand name for Pembrolizumab, a revolutionary immunotherapy drug used to treat various advanced and aggressive cancers.
- Unlike traditional treatments that attack the tumor directly, Keytruda is a checkpoint inhibitor that helps the body's own immune system identify and destroy cancer cells.

17. GLP-1 receptor agonists primarily act by:

- A. Increasing glucose production in the liver
- B. Stimulating insulin secretion and reducing glucagon levels
- C. Destroying pancreatic beta cells
- D. Increasing fat absorption

Answer: b

- Multiple variants of GLP-1 drugs have been recently introduced in the Indian market, and concerns have emerged regarding their on-demand availability through retail pharmacies, online platforms, wholesalers, and wellness clinics.
- GLP-1 drugs (glucagon-like peptide-1 receptor agonists) are medications developed to treat both type 2 diabetes and obesity by correcting hormonal imbalance - stimulating insulin release and suppressing excess glucagon -to bring blood sugar back under control.

18. The Antariksh Venture Capital Fund is registered with which regulatory body?

- A. Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
- B. Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)
- C. Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)
- D. National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)

Answer: c

- Recently, the Union Minister said that India's dedicated Antariksh venture capital fund for the space sector has progressed steadily, with investment in selected startups expected to begin from the first quarter of FY2027.
- It is a close ended fund registered with the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) as a Category II Alternative Investment Fund (AIF).
- It is a SEBI registered Alternative Investment Fund.

19. With reference to the Artemis II mission, consider the following statements:

1. It will be the first crewed mission under NASA's Artemis programme.
2. The mission will land astronauts on the lunar surface.
3. It will use the Space Launch System (SLS) rocket and Orion spacecraft for carrying astronauts.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- NASA is set to launch the Artemis II mission on, April 1, 2026, marking the first time humans will venture to the Moon's neighbourhood since the Apollo 17 mission in 1972.
- The Artemis II mission will take three to four days to reach the Moon's neighbourhood — roughly the same time the Apollo missions took to land on the lunar surface.
- Both the SLS rocket and the Orion spacecraft being used for this mission

20. The crater "Integrity" derives its name from:

- A. A NASA core principle
- B. The Artemis II spacecraft
- C. An international space treaty
- D. A historic Apollo mission

Answer: B

- Artemis astronauts at the outer edge of human space travel had named a crater in honour of the deceased wife of mission commander Reid Wiseman - call it Carroll
- The crater can be seen "at certain times of the Moon's transit around Earth
- The Artemis II crew dubbed another crater "Integrity," in honor of the name they have given their spacecraft.

21. The Artemis II mission set a new record for the farthest human journey from Earth. What was the maximum distance reached by its astronauts?

- A. 200,000 miles
- B. 248,655 miles
- C. 252,752 miles
- D. 300,000 miles

Answer: C

- NASA's Artemis II entered its fifth day in space on 6th April. The astronauts are now preparing for a

close flyby of the Moon and to reach a record-breaking distance from Earth.

- The Orion spacecraft, carrying four astronauts, reached about 252,752 miles from Earth during a flyby of the Moon's far side, surpassing the Apollo 13 record of 248,655 miles set in 1970.
- Four astronauts aboard NASA's Artemis II test flight around the Moon made history at 12:56 p.m. CDT, at 11:27 PM India Standard Time.

22. Which of the following missions achieved the milestone of the first-ever ship-to-ship communication between a human Moon mission and the International Space Station?

- A. Apollo 11
- B. Artemis II
- C. Chandrayaan-3
- D. Gaganyaan

Answer: B

- NASA's Artemis II mission made history again when the crew, traveling on their Orion spacecraft, completed the first-ever ship to ship call between a human moon mission and the International Space Station.
- This was the first time people traveling near the Moon communicated directly with people in a spacecraft orbiting Earth. During the call, Christina Koch on Artemis II spoke with Jessica Meir on the space station.
- The two had earlier worked together on the first all-female spacewalk in 2019.

23. Consider the following statements regarding the PACE mission:

1. It studies global ocean biology, aerosols, and clouds.
2. It was launched into a geostationary orbit.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- Researchers recently found that NASA's PACE satellite can now detect nitrogen dioxide pollution at a fine enough scale to isolate emissions from individual factories and highway corridors.
- The Plankton, Aerosol, Cloud, and ocean Ecosystem (PACE) is a NASA satellite mission that studies global ocean biology, aerosols, and clouds.

- PACE's primary instrument is the Ocean Color Instrument (OCI), a highly advanced optical spectrometer to measure the ocean's colour across a spectrum from ultraviolet to shortwave infrared.

24. What is Claude Mythos?

- A. A next-generation quantum computing processor developed for cryptography
- B. A large-scale cloud computing platform for data storage and analytics
- C. A global cybersecurity framework for critical infrastructure protection
- D. An advanced artificial intelligence model developed by Anthropic

Answer: D

- Artificial intelligence company Anthropic has unveiled a preview of what it says is the most powerful model it has ever built — an advanced system called Claude Mythos —
- Anthropic has opted for a limited preview under a new cybersecurity initiative called "Project Glasswing", through which the model will be made available only to a small group of technology companies, infrastructure operators and security organisations.

25. Mission Mitra is being conducted in:

- (a) Thar Desert
- (b) Andaman & Nicobar Islands
- (c) Ladakh high-altitude region
- (d) Western Ghats

Answer: (c)

- Mission Mitra stands for Mapping of Interoperable Traits & Reliability Assessment.
- Under Mission Mitra, ISRO's Human Space Flight Centre (HSFC) is placing the selected astronaut team in high-altitude, low-oxygen, extreme-cold conditions to study how humans perform- physically and mentally- when pushed to the edge, in an environment that can mimic parts of deep-space stress.
- The mission is being carried out in Ladakh's high-altitude terrain, known for its freezing cold, low oxygen levels and isolation.

26. Direct-to-Device (D2D) satellite communication enables:

- A. Communication only via satellite phones
- B. Direct connectivity between satellites and standard smartphones
- C. Internet only in urban areas
- D. Replacement of fiber optic cables

Answer: B

- The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) recently organized a high-level workshop through the Telecommunication Engineering Centre (TEC) to explore Direct-to-Device (D2D) satellite communication.
- Direct-to-Device (D2D) is an emerging satellite communication technology that allows standard, off-the-shelf mobile devices (like your smartphone) to connect directly to satellites without the need for specialized hardware, satellite phones, or intermediate ground equipment.

27. The South Atlantic Anomaly (SAA) is best described as:

- A. A region of high atmospheric pressure
- B. A dip in Earth's magnetic field
- C. A deep ocean trench
- D. A tectonic fault zone

Answer: B

- The South Atlantic Anomaly is actually splitting into two zones now, making things trickier for satellites in low Earth orbit.
- The South Atlantic Anomaly (SAA), or the "Bermuda Triangle of Space", is a dip in the Earth's magnetic field which allows cosmic rays and charged particles to reach lower into the atmosphere.
- It is southeast of South America and southwest of Africa. In this area, the planet's magnetic field dips down.

28. Consider the following applications:

1. Secure communication
2. Quantum computing
3. Precision sensing

Which of the above are key focus areas of the National Quantum Mission?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

The National Quantum Mission (NQM)

- The Union Minister for Science & Technology, recently announced that the National Quantum Mission (NQM) has achieved a historic 1,000-km secure quantum communication milestone in less than two years.
- The National Quantum Mission is a specialized initiative aimed at seeding, nurturing, and scaling up scientific and industrial R&D in Quantum Technology (QT).

- It seeks to make India a leading nation in the quantum domain, which is considered the next frontier of computing and communication.
- **Launched in:** The mission was formally approved by the Union Cabinet in April 2023 and became operational in October 2024.

29. The term "super-Earth" is used in planetary science to describe which of the following?

- A. Gas giant planets larger than Jupiter
- B. Rocky exoplanets with masses higher than Earth but significantly lower than ice giants like Neptune
- C. Artificial satellites designed to mimic Earth-like conditions
- D. Planets composed entirely of hydrogen and helium

Answer: B

- Astronomers have identified a peculiar planetary system located nearly 120 light-years away from Earth, challenging long-held theories of how solar systems form.
- The system contains two Earth-like planets, often referred to as "super-Earths", but its overall structure defies conventional models observed in our own Solar System.
- The newly discovered system hosts two rocky planets similar in size and composition to Earth.
- Such planets, known as super-Earths, are slightly larger than Earth and may possess rocky surfaces or layered interiors.

30. With reference to Newcastle disease, consider the following statements:

1. It affects only domestic poultry.
2. It is a highly contagious disease.
3. Nervous manifestations such as tremors and paralysis can occur.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 2 and 3 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

- Recently, reports of Newcastle disease circulating across Europe, poultry producers across the UK are being urged to step up vigilance as the virus continues its westward spread.
- It is caused by avian paramyxovirus serotype 1, affects chickens and a wide range of other birds.
- It is a highly contagious and often severe disease found worldwide that affects birds including domestic poultry.

- The disease appears in three forms: lentogenic or mild, mesogenic or moderate and velogenic or very virulent.
- The lentogenic strains are very widespread but cause few disease outbreaks. Nervous signs – tremors, paralyzed wings and legs, twisted necks, circling, spasms, and paralysis

31. The Bacille Calmette-Guérin (BCG) vaccine is primarily used for prevention of:

- A. Malaria
- B. Tuberculosis
- C. Measles
- D. Hepatitis B

Answer: B

- The Bacille Calmette-Guérin (BCG) Vaccine is a live attenuated (weakened) vaccine primarily used to provide protection against Tuberculosis (TB).
- It is the only licensed vaccine available against TB and is one of the most widely administered vaccines in the world, typically given to newborns.

32. The BIRAC-BioNEST Incubation Centre was inaugurated at which institution?

- A. National Chemical Laboratory (NCL)
- B. Central Food Technology and Research Institute (CFTRI)
- C. Indian Institute of Science (IISc)
- D. National Institute of Nutrition (NIN)

Answer: B

- Union Minister for Science and Technology Dr. Jitendra Singh inaugurated the BIRAC-BioNEST Incubation Centre at the Central Food Technology and Research Institute (CFTRI).
- The initiative aims to bridge the gap between laboratory research and commercial applications by fostering startup-driven technologies in food processing and biotechnology.

33. Psychedelics are best described as substances that:

- A. Enhance physical strength
- B. Increase immunity
- C. Only act as painkillers
- D. Induce altered perception and consciousness

Answer: d

- Recent study revealed that Psychedelics can temporarily 'loosen' the brain patterns that support the feeling of a 'me', allowing researchers to watch that system reorganise itself in real time.
- These are drugs that induce states of altered perception, behaviour, consciousness and

thought, often with increased awareness of the senses.

- Psychedelics are non-addictive and non-toxic. Compared to illicit drugs, psychedelics cause much less harm to the end user.

34. With reference to sulphur (S), consider the following statements:

1. It does not dissolve in water.
2. It is used in fertilizer production and petroleum refining.
3. It is a weak organic acid.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- Sulphur (identified by the letter S) is a non-metallic chemical element.
- It can be found as a pure element or as sulphate or sulphide minerals.
- In its pure form, sulfur is a tasteless, odorless, brittle solid with a pale yellow color.
- It's a poor conductor of electricity that doesn't dissolve in water.
- It combines directly with almost all the elements with the exception of gold, platinum and the noble gases.
- Sulphuric acid is a strong mineral acid which is used in ore processing, fertilizer manufacturing, oil refining, waste water processing and chemical synthesis.

35. With reference to the "Spacecraft Mission Operations: SMOPS- 2026", consider the following statements:

1. It was jointly organised by the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) and the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO).
2. It was the first edition held in Delhi.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: d

- The second edition of the International Conference on "Spacecraft Mission Operations: SMOPS- 2026" with the theme "Innovative Operations for Smart and Sustainable Space

Mission Management – Next Generation” held in Bangalore, India.

- The conference, jointly organised by the Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO), the Astronautical Society of India (ASI), and the International Academy of Astronautics (IAA).
- It aims to cover a wide range of topics related to mission operations management, advanced mission design, automation, large constellations management, human spaceflight mission, space robotics, space policy, lunar and interplanetary exploration, cybersecurity in space systems, artificial intelligence, etc.

Environment

1. Consider the following statements regarding the Mookambika Wildlife Sanctuary:

1. The sanctuary derives its name from the deity of the Kollur Mookambika Temple.
2. Kodachadri Peak lies within the sanctuary.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- **Sewage from commercial activities related to religious tourism in Kollur has emerged as a threat to the Mookambika Wildlife Sanctuary in Udupi district**, with the depleted Souparnika river carrying sewage and sludge to the core area in summer.
- It is located in the Udupi district of **Karnataka**.
- Set in the Western Ghats, the sanctuary covers an area of approximately 370 sq.km.
- **The sanctuary is named after the presiding deity of the Kollur Mookambika Temple**, which is located within its boundaries.
- **At the heart of the sanctuary lies the revered Kodachadri Peak**, often referred to as a “botanical paradise.”

2. The fruit commonly known as Jamun is scientifically called:

- A. *Mangifera indica*
- B. *Musa paradisiaca*
- C. *Syzygium cumini*
- D. *Psidium guajava*

Answer: C

- According to a new study, Jamun has been found to have originated much earlier than previously

believed, with India playing a central role in its evolutionary history.

- It is an important indigenous minor fruit of commercial value.
- The scientific name of the jamun tree is *Syzygium cumini*.
- It is **also known as black plum**, Indian black cherry, Ram jamun etc. in different parts of India.

3. *Stauranthera aureoglossa*, recently discovered, is a:

- A. Mammal species
- B. Bird species
- C. Plant species
- D. Fungal species

Answer: C

- A team of botanists recently discovered a **new plant species with a unique ‘golden tongue’ in the shaded streams of the Himalayas, named *Stauranthera aureoglossa***.
- It is a new plant species.
- It was **discovered in** the dense, mid-elevation evergreen forests of the Kamle and Upper Subansiri districts of **Arunachal Pradesh**.

4. The “Dolphin Friends” volunteer network has been launched in:

- A. Varanasi
- B. Prayagraj
- C. Patna
- D. Kanpur

Answer: B

- The forest department in Prayagraj has launched the Dolphin Friends volunteer network **to strengthen conservation of the endangered Gangetic dolphin through community participation and regular river monitoring**.

5. Which of the following conditions are associated with a Super El Niño?

1. Sea surface temperature anomaly $\geq 2^{\circ}\text{C}$ in Niño 3.4 region
2. Strong westerly wind bursts pushing warm water eastward
3. Subsurface heat buildup in the Pacific Ocean

Select the correct answer:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 1 only

Answer: C

- A Super El Niño is an exceptionally strong event defined by sea surface temperature anomalies in the Niño 3.4 region spiking by at least 2OC (3.6OF) above the long-term average.
- **Only a few such events have occurred since 1950, with some models now predicting the strongest event in 140 years for the 2026–27 cycle.**
- A massive buildup of heat below the ocean surface is already feeding into seasonal forecasts, often a precursor to rapid surface intensification.
- **Strong bursts of wind from the west act as fuel, racing more warm water eastward and preventing the system from neutralizing.**
- The general rising trend in ocean temperatures makes modern El Niños appear stronger than historical ones, as the baseline temperature of the Pacific is already elevated.

6. Col. Sher Jung National Park is located in:

- A. Uttarakhand
- B. Himachal Pradesh
- C. Haryana
- D. Punjab

Answer: B

- The Himachal Pradesh High Court quashed a recent notification **declaring areas of at least three grama panchayats around the Col Sher Jung National Park at Simbalbara in Sirmour district as an Eco-Sensitive Zone (ESZ).**
- Col. Sher Jung National Park, also known as Simbalbara National Park, is located in the Paonta Valley of the Sirmour (Sirmour) **district in Himachal Pradesh along its border with Haryana.**

7. Amchang Wildlife Sanctuary is located in:

- A. Arunachal Pradesh
- B. Assam
- C. Meghalaya
- D. Nagaland

Answer: B

- The **Gauhati High Court recently directed the Assam govt to respond to a petition alleging that the forest department floated an e-tender for felling trees in Amchang Wildlife Sanctuary without obtaining mandatory forest clearance from the central govt.**
- It is located in the eastern fringe of Guwahati city in Assam.

8. annatto:

It contains antimicrobial compounds.
It is used as a natural food colouring agent.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Applications of Annatto

- The annatto seed is widely used as a **natural food colour and dye.**
- Its color can also be extracted from the seed and then **added to foods as a dye.**
- Some also use annatto to boost the **flavor of certain dishes.**
- It has a mild, **peppery flavor** when used in large amounts as well as a nutty and floral scent.
- Annatto is **rich in several key antimicrobial compounds**, which can limit the growth of bacteria, fungi, and parasites

9. The natural habitat of *Cyrtodactylus jayadityai* is:

- A. Alpine forests
- B. Coastal wetlands
- C. Lowland forest patches
- D. Desert ecosystems

Answer: C.

- Recently, researchers **discovered a new gecko species in Tripura** and named it as *Cyrtodactylus jayadityai*.
- It is a newly discovered species of bent-toed gecko from Tripura.
- **Habitat:** It inhabits lowland forest patches.

10. Consider the following statements:

1. ***Mogrus* spiders are typically found in arid regions.**
2. **These species are commonly found only in Antarctica.**
3. **They are medium-sized jumping spiders.**

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 2 only
- C. 1 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- A team of scientists recently discovered two new species of jumping spiders named ***Mogrus shushka* and *Mogrus pune***, thriving in the country's drylands and urban green spaces.
- These are **two newly discovered arachnids belonging to the genus *Mogrus***, a group of

medium-sized jumping spiders typically found in the arid regions of Africa, Europe, and Asia.

11. The species *Dillenia nagalim* is classified as:

- A. Vulnerable
- B. Endangered
- C. Critically Endangered
- D. Least Concern

Answer: C

- A team of researchers recently discovered a new plant species in Manipur's Kamjong district, naming it *Dillenia nagalim*.
- The species is currently known only from a single location, making it endemic to the area.
- The plant grows in open tropical deciduous forests.
- The species has been provisionally classified as "Critically Endangered" under IUCN criteria.

12. Consider the following conditions for tornado formation:

1. Presence of warm, moist air
2. Interaction with cool, dry air
3. Strong high-pressure stability

Which of the above given statement/s is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A.

About Tornado

- It is a vertical, land-based column of violently rotating air that forms from the base of a thunderstorm to the ground.
- A collision of warm, moist air (usually from tropical regions) with cool, dry air (typically from polar or upper regions), especially in the presence of a low-pressure system or trough, leads to the formation of thunderstorms and may trigger tornadoes.
- Tornado formation is closely linked to interactions between contrasting air masses.
- It typically exhibits wind speeds ranging from 105 to 322 km/h, but some extreme events can exceed this range.

13. India's Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) were first submitted in _____ for the target year _____, and subsequently updated in _____ for the target year _____.

- A. 2015 – 2025; 2022 – 2030
- B. 2016 – 2030; 2021 – 2035

- C. 2015 – 2030; 2022 – 2025
- D. 2012 – 2020; 2020 – 2030

Answer: A

- India has submitted its revised climate targets for 2031-2035 to the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC),
- This is India's third NDC, the first two having been submitted in 2015, pertaining to the year 2025, and then in 2022, for 2030.

14. Sea slugs are considered indicators of:

- A. Deep-sea hydrothermal activity
- B. Healthy coral reef ecosystems
- C. Freshwater biodiversity
- D. Ocean acidification

Answer: B

- A rare sea slug, *Discodorid cebuensis*, has been recorded in India for the first time after being spotted recently at Haji Ali, Mumbai.
- Sea slugs, sometimes called ocean slugs, water slugs, or nudibranchs, are soft-bodied marine molluscs found in all the world's oceans, from shallows to the deep sea.
- They have no shells, quills, or mantle cavities. They are usually found in coral reefs, and their presence is a significant indicator of a strong coral ecosystem.

15. "Cyborg botany" refers to:

- A. Genetic modification of plants for higher yield
- B. Integration of plants with electronic components to sense and communicate data
- C. Study of plant diseases using traditional methods
- D. Artificial cultivation of plants without soil

Answer: B

- Cyborg botany is an emerging hybrid field that integrates living plants with electronic components to create cybernetic organisms capable of sensing and communicating biological information.

16. The Srivilliputhur–Meghamalai Tiger Reserve is located in:

- A. Karnataka
- B. Kerala
- C. Tamil Nadu
- D. Andhra Pradesh

Answer: C

- Srivilliputhur- Meghamalai Tiger Reserve
- It is located in the state of Tamil Nadu.

- It lies in the ecologically sensitive Western Ghats region.

17. Namdapha Tiger Reserve lies along the international border between:

- A. India–China
- B. India–Bhutan
- C. India–Myanmar
- D. India–Nepal

Answer: C

- Indian scientists **recently discovered a rare, fanged mud-nesting frog, *Limnonectes Motijheel*, in Namdapha Tiger Reserve, Arunachal Pradesh.**
- It is named after Motijheel Lake, known for its **rich amphibian diversity.**
- Namdapha, a national park and tiger reserve, lies on the international **border between India and Myanmar within Changlang District in the state of Arunachal Pradesh.**

18. What is a heatwave?

- A. A period of heavy rainfall
- B. A period of abnormally high temperature
- C. A sudden drop in temperature
- D. A strong wind system

Answer: B

- A heatwave is a period of abnormally high temperatures, **more than the normal maximum temperature, that occurs during the summer season.**
- It is a condition of air temperature which becomes fatal to the human body** when exposed.
- Qualitatively, it is defined based on the temperature **thresholds over a region in terms of actual temperature or its departure from normal.**

19. Consider the following statements regarding Cyanobacteria:

- Cyanobacteria can fix atmospheric nitrogen.
- They lack membrane-bound organelles.
- They are strictly unicellular and never form colonies.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

About Cyanobacteria

- They are photosynthetic microscopic organisms found naturally in all types of water.
- They were originally called blue-green algae (though they are not true algae) because dense

growths often turn the water green, blue-green, or brownish-green.

- They are usually unicellular, though they often grow in colonies large enough to see.

20. What is the IUCN status of the Olive Ridley Turtle?

- A. Endangered
- B. Critically Endangered
- C. Vulnerable
- D. Least Concern

Answer: C

- Olive Ridley turtles from Tamil Nadu have begun migrating towards the Sri Lanka Dome, a little-known but highly productive ocean region.
- Conservation Status of Olive Ridley Turtle
- IUCN Red List: Vulnerable**
- CITES: Appendix I
- Wildlife Protection Act, 1972: Schedule 1

21. With reference to Boramdeo Wildlife Sanctuary, consider the following statements:

- It is located in Chhattisgarh.
- It is part of the Kanha–Achanakmar Corridor.

Which of the above given statement/s is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- The Chhattisgarh government is set to launch a new jungle safari in **the Boramdeo Wildlife Sanctuary soon.**
- Boramdeo Wildlife Sanctuary, also known as Boramdev **Wildlife Sanctuary, is located in the Kawardha district of Chhattisgarh.**
- It is part of the Kanha-Achanakmar Corridor, which connects **Kanha National Park in Madhya Pradesh with Achanakmar Wildlife Sanctuary in Chhattisgarh.**

22. What is the IUCN status of Nilgiri Tahr?

- A. Vulnerable
- B. Endangered
- C. Critically Endangered
- D. Least Concern

Answer: B

- The largest population is found in **Eravikulam National Park (Kerala), with other significant populations in the Nilgiris and Anamalai hills.**
- IUCN Red List: Listed as Endangered.**
- It is the **State Animal of Tamil Nadu.**

- An endemic species to the Western Ghats.

23. Which of the following rivers originate from the Hindu Kush Himalaya region?

1. Indus
2. Mekong
3. Yellow River
4. Amu Darya

Select the correct answer:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1, 2 and 3 only
- C. 2, 3 and 4 only
- D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: D

- According to a new report by the International Centre for Integrated Mountain Development Hindu Kush Himalaya (HKH) region sees a record 27% drop in snow persistence.
- Hindu Kush Himalaya extends around 3,500 km over eight countries — Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, China, India, Nepal, Myanmar, and Pakistan.
- The HKH region is the source of ten large Asian river systems: the Amu Darya, Indus, Ganges, Brahmaputra, Irrawaddy, Salween, Mekong, Yangtze, Yellow River, and Tarim.
- HKH may be divided into three main sections: the eastern Hindu Kush, the central Hindu Kush, and the western Hindu Kush, also known as the Bābā Mountains.

24. Cyrtodactylus raimonaensis is named after:

- A. A scientist who discovered it
- B. A river in Assam
- C. A nearby national park
- D. A tribal community

Answer: C

- Cyrtodactylus raimonaensis
- It is a species of bent-toed gecko.
- It belongs to the Cyrtodactylus genus which is amongst the largest groups of geckos worldwide.
- It has been found near Raimona National Park in Kokrajhar district, Assam and named after the park itself.

25. Eturnagaram Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which state?

- A. Maharashtra
- B. Chhattisgarh
- C. Odisha
- D. Telangana

Answer: D

- Eturnagaram Wildlife Sanctuary is located near the border of Maharashtra, Chhattisgarh, and Telangana of Telangana.
- It was established in 1952.
- It has a water source called Dayyam Vagu, which separates the sanctuary into two parts.
- The river Godavari also passes through it.
- The famous Sammakka-Saralamma Temple is situated inside the sanctuary.

26. Kali Tiger Reserve is formed by combining which two protected areas in Karnataka?

- A. Bandipur National Park and Nagarhole National Park
- B. Dandeli Wildlife Sanctuary and Anshi National Park
- C. Bhadra Wildlife Sanctuary and Kudremukh National Park
- D. Bannerghatta National Park and Cauvery Wildlife Sanctuary

Answer: b

- The Union environment ministry proposes an Eco-Sensitive Zone around Karnataka's Kali Tiger Reserve, spanning 663.32 sq km.
- It is located in the central portion of the Uttara Kannada (North Canara) district of Karnataka.
- The Tiger Reserve comprises two important protected areas of the region viz., Dandeli Wildlife Sanctuary (475.018 Km²) and Anshi National Park (339.866 Km²).

27. Morchella mushroom, recently in news, belongs to which of the following groups?

- A. Basidiomycota
- B. Ascomycota
- C. Bryophyta
- D. Pteridophyta

Answer: B

- Recently, the Sheri Kashmir University of Agriculture and Sciences (SKUAST) in Srinagar has cultivated the Morchella mushroom for the first time in controlled condition.
- It is an edible mushroom from the Ascomycota group.
- Morels or Morchella is locally known as Kangaech or Gucci mushroom.

28. Consider the following statements regarding the conservation status of the Indus River dolphin (Platanista minor):

1. It is listed as Endangered on the IUCN Red List.
2. It is included in Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- The Indus River dolphin (*Platanista minor*) is one of the rarest mammals.
- It presently only occurs in the Indus River system, along with a remnant population in the Beas River.
- It is functionally blind. It has extremely reduced eyes without lenses.
- Conservation Status
- IUCN Red List: Endangered
- Wildlife Protection Act 1972: Schedule I.

29. Which of the following statements regarding Kuno National Park is correct?

- A. It was established as a national park in 2000
- B. It lies in the Western Ghats
- C. It was upgraded from a wildlife sanctuary in 2018
- D. It is located along the Indo-Nepal border

Answer: C

Kuno National Park:

- It is located in the Sheopur district of Madhya Pradesh.
- It is nestled near the Vindhyan Hills.
- Originally established as Kuno Wildlife Sanctuary in 1981, it was upgraded to a national park in 2018.
- The park's historical significance lies in its role as a relocation site for Asiatic lions under the "Asiatic Lion Reintroduction Project,".

30. The Himalayan Griffon vulture (*Gyps himalayensis*) is classified as:

- A. Endangered
- B. Vulnerable
- C. Near Threatened
- D. Critically Endangered

Answer: C

- The Dudhwa Tiger Reserve witnessed a rare sight of several Himalayan Griffon vultures collapsing.
- A total of 25 vultures were found dead, while six were rescued in an unconscious state and given injections.
- The International Union for Conservation of Nature's (IUCN) Red List lists the raptor (*Gyps himalayensis*) as 'Near Threatened'.

31. Vantara has announced the setting up of a wildlife and veterinary sciences university in which state?

- A. Maharashtra
- B. Rajasthan
- C. Gujarat
- D. Madhya Pradesh

Answer: C

- Vantara, the wildlife conservation initiative founded by Reliance Industries Executive Director Anant Ambani, announced the setting up of a university, dedicated to wildlife and veterinary sciences, in Jamnagar, Gujarat
- The university will offer undergraduate, postgraduate, fellowship, and specialised programmes in disciplines such as wildlife medicine and surgery, behavioural sciences, genetics, epidemiology, conservation policy and One Health.

32. The IUCN status of the Antarctic fur seal is:

- A. Least Concern
- B. Vulnerable
- C. Endangered
- D. Near Threatened

Answer: C

▪ About Antarctic Fur Seals:

- The Antarctic fur seal is a marine mammal that is part of the eared seal family.
- Their survival is intrinsically linked to the Antarctic marine ecosystem, particularly the availability of krill, which is their primary food source.
- IUCN Status: Endangered

33. Which two institutions have been designated as National Repositories by the National Biodiversity Authority?

- A. Indian Agricultural Research Institute (IARI) and National Institute of Oceanography (NIO)
- B. Centre for Marine Living Resources and Ecology (CMLRE), Kochi and Agharkar Research Institute (ARI), Pune
- C. Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) and Botanical Survey of India (BSI)
- D. Wildlife Institute of India (WII) and Forest Survey of India (FSI)

Answer: B

- The National Biodiversity Authority (NBA) notified two premier scientific institutions—Referral Centre Bhavasagara at the Centre for Marine Living Resources and Ecology (CMLRE), Kochi and MACS Microorganism & Fungal Collection at

Agharkar Research Institute (ARI) Pune —as designated National Repositories under Section 39 of the Biological Diversity Act, 2002.

- A National Repository is a government-designated institution authorized to keep voucher specimens (physical samples) of biological resources in safe custody.

34. Per- and polyfluoroalkyl substances (PFAS), recently in news, have been listed as persistent organic pollutants (POPs) under which of the following international agreements?

- A. Kyoto Protocol
- B. Paris Agreement
- C. Stockholm Convention
- D. Montreal Protocol

Answer: c

- Recently, the European Union (EU) Parliament approved updated EU water pollution standards and added Per- and polyfluoroalkyl substances (PFAS) into the pollutants list which needs to be monitored.
- These are toxic, man-made, hazardous chemicals.
- These are also known as the Forever Chemicals.
- These subgroups are currently listed under the Stockholm Convention as industrial POPs.

35. Barnawapara Wildlife Sanctuary is located in:

- A. Odisha
- B. Madhya Pradesh
- C. Chhattisgarh
- D. Jharkhand

Answer: C

- Recently, Blackbucks were reintroduced into their natural habitat at Rampur grassland in Barnawapara Wildlife Sanctuary.
- Barnawapara Wildlife Sanctuary Location: It is located in the northern part of the Mahasamund district of Chhattisgarh.
- It is named after the Bar and Nawapara forest villages, which are in the heart of the sanctuary.
- The tributaries of Mahanadi are the source of water.

36. Earthquake lights (EQL) are best described as:

- (a) Electromagnetic disturbances in the ionosphere
- (b) Luminous phenomena caused by ionisation of air due to electrically charged rocks
- (c) Thermal radiation from friction along fault lines
- (d) Optical effects due to atmospheric pressure changes

Answer: (b)

- Earthquake lights are flashes, streaks, balls, or tall pillars of light that sometimes appear in the sky right before, during, or just after an earthquake.
- Earthquakes happen when huge tectonic plates push and grind against each other.
- This stress squeezes rocks in the crust, especially those containing quartz or certain minerals.
- The pressure creates electric charges inside the rocks.
- These charges then flow upward through cracks and faults until they reach the surface. Once there, they bump into air molecules and ionise them, stripping electrons and creating glowing plasma.

37. Tar balls, recently seen in news, are best described as:

- A. Aggregates of marine microorganisms
- B. Hardened residues of weathered crude oil
- C. Volcanic ash deposits in oceans
- D. Plastic waste accumulated in oceans

Answer: B

- Tar balls are small, dark, sticky, or hardened blobs of weathered crude oil found floating on the ocean surface or washed ashore on beaches.
- They are essentially the remnants of oil that has undergone physical and chemical changes due to environmental exposure.
- Tar balls are complex mixtures consisting of:
 - Hydrocarbons: Primarily heavy, high-molecular-weight compounds like paraffins and aromatics.
 - Asphaltenes: These provide the characteristic black color and sticky texture.

38. The Indian Softshell Turtle (*Nilssonia gangetica*) is listed under which category of the IUCN Red List?

- A. Vulnerable
- B. Endangered
- C. Critically Endangered
- D. Near Threatened

Answer: B

- Indian softshell turtles (*Nilssonia gangetica*) are one of the largest freshwater turtle species in the world.
- It is also known as the Ganges Softshell turtle.
- Conservation Status
- IUCN Red List: Endangered
- Wildlife Protection Act, 1972: Schedule I

39. The conservation status of the Indian crested porcupine according to the IUCN Red List is:

- A. Endangered
- B. Vulnerable

- C. Near Threatened
D. Least Concern

Answer: D

- Recently, it was observed that the Indian crested porcupine has begun feeding on saffron corms beneath the soil, hollowing out harvests before they can bloom in Kashmir.
- It mainly occurs on rocky hill sides but is also found in tropical and temperate scrublands, grasslands, and forests.
- They are also found throughout the Himalayan Mountains, reaching up to elevations of 2400 meters.
- Conservation Status IUCN Red List: Least Concerned

40. The volcanic activity of Mount Semeru is associated with which of the following tectonic settings?

- A. Subduction of the Indo-Australian Plate beneath the Sunda Plate
B. Divergent boundary between Pacific Plate and Eurasian Plate
C. Transform boundary between Indo-Australian Plate and Pacific Plate
D. Intraplate hotspot within the Eurasian Plate

Answer: A

- The Mount Semeru, the tallest and one of the most active volcanoes in Indonesia, erupted multiple times, sending thick ash plumes up to 1,100 metres into the sky.
- Mount Semeru, also known as Mahameru (The Great Mountain), is an active stratovolcano (composite volcano).
- Located on the Pacific Ring of Fire, where the Indo-Australian Plate subducts beneath the Sunda plate (which is part of Eurasian Plate).
- Location: Island: East Java, Indonesia.

41. Consider the following statements regarding oak forests in India:

1. Oaks are dominant climax species in moist temperate Himalayan forests.
2. They are found only in tropical evergreen forests.
3. They play an important role in soil and water conservation.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
B. 2 only
C. 1 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- Oaks found in Uttarakhand are Banj oak, Moru oak, Kharsu oak, Rianj oak, and Phaliath oak
- These are the dominant, climax tree species of the moist temperate forests in the Indian Himalayan region.
- Oaks thrive in a variety of climates but are commonly found in temperate zones. They can endure cold winters and warm summers.
- They can tolerate different soil types, including sandy, loamy, and clayey soils.
- The species are providers of numerous ecosystem services such as conservation of soil, water, native flora and fauna, and serve as a lifeline for the local communities.

42. The Umred–Pauni–Karhandla Wildlife Sanctuary is connected to which of the following tiger reserves through forest corridors?

- A. Kanha Tiger Reserve
B. Tadoba-Andhari Tiger Reserve
C. Bandhavgarh Tiger Reserve
D. Satpura Tiger Reserve

Answer: B

- Recently, a melanistic (black-colored) spotted deer, commonly known as a chital, has been spotted at the Umred–Pauni–Karhandla Wildlife Sanctuary near Nagpur.
- Location: It is spread over Pauni tehsil in Bhandara district and Umred, Kuhi, and Bhivapur Taluka of Nagpur district in Maharashtra.
- The forest along the Wainganga River connects this sanctuary to the Tadoba Andhari Tiger Reserve.

43. India has withdrawn its candidacy to host which Conference of Parties (COP) under the UNFCCC?

- A. COP31 (2026)
B. COP32 (2027)
C. COP33 (2028)
D. COP34 (2029)

Answer: C

- India has withdrawn its candidacy to host the 33rd Conference of Parties (COP33) to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) in 2028, citing a "review of its commitments for 2028."
- Following the confirmed hosts of Australia and Turkey (COP31, 2026), and Ethiopia (COP32, 2027), India's withdrawal leaves South Korea as the only contender to fill the vacancy for COP33 in 2028.

44. consider the following statements regarding lead:

1. It is a soft and highly malleable metal.
2. It has high electrical conductivity.
3. It is resistant to corrosion.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 2 only
- C. 1, 2 and 3
- D. 1 only

Answer: A

- It is a naturally occurring element found in small amounts in the earth's crust.
- Properties
- It is a soft, silvery white or grayish metal in Group 14 (IVa) of the periodic table.
- Lead has a bright lustre and is a dense, ductile, very soft, highly malleable, bluish-white metal that has poor electrical conductivity.
- It is also highly resistant to corrosion and because of this property is used to contain corrosive liquids (e.g. sulphuric acid).

45. With reference to the above statement, consider the following:

1. La Niña is declared when this value is equal or over 0.5 degree Celsius.
2. El Niño is declared when this value is equal or lower 0.5 degree Celsius.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: d

- With reference to El Niño–Southern Oscillation (ENSO), consider the following statements:
- ENSO is a coupled ocean–atmosphere phenomenon involving interactions between sea surface temperature and atmospheric circulation.
- ENSO events occur at strictly regular intervals of five years.

46. Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

- A 'very strong' El Niño is likely to develop along the Pacific Ocean during the latter half of this year and persist till the end of 2026, the US-based

National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA)

- The El Niño Southern Oscillation (ENSO) is a global ocean-atmospheric phenomenon that is based on the ocean surface temperature along the equatorial and central Pacific Ocean.
- These phases alternate once every two to seven years.

47. The IUCN Red List status of Rice's whale is:

- A. Vulnerable
- B. Endangered
- C. Critically Endangered
- D. Near Threatened

Answer: C

- Scientists fear that the USA administration's plan to expand oil drilling in the Gulf of Mexico will push Rice's Whales to extinction.
- Rice's whales are members of the baleen whale family Balaenopteridae.
- These are most closely related to Bryde's whales.
- Conservation Status : IUCN Red List: Critically Endangered.

48. Which country has emerged as the global leader in biodiversity compliance by issuing the highest number of Internationally Recognized Certificates of Compliance (IRCCs) under the Nagoya Protocol?

- A. India
- B. China
- C. Brazil
- D. South Africa

Answer: A

- India has emerged as the global leader in biodiversity compliance, issuing 3,561 Internationally Recognized Certificates of Compliance (IRCCs), which accounts for over 56% of the total certificates issued worldwide under the Nagoya Protocol.
- The Nagoya Protocol is a supplementary agreement to the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD).
- It provides a transparent legal framework for the effective implementation of one of the three objectives of the CBD: the fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising out of the utilization of genetic resources.

49. Which of the following Indian cities has been selected under the inaugural "20 Cities Towards Zero Waste" initiative?

- A. Varkala

- B. Indore
C. Panaji
D. Mysuru

Answer: A

- Varkala Municipality in Kerala has been selected as the only city from India in the inaugural "20 Cities Towards Zero Waste" initiative.
- It is an initiative led by the UN Secretary-General's Advisory Board on Zero Waste, with support from UN-Habitat and the UN Environment Programme (UNEP).

50. Kugti Wildlife Sanctuary is located in which state?

- A. Uttarakhand
B. Jammu & Kashmir
C. Himachal Pradesh
D. Sikkim

Answer: C

- Recently, a rare white female albino Himalayan 'tahr' has been recorded in the Kugti Wildlife Sanctuary at Bharmour in Chamba district.
- Kugti Wildlife Sanctuary is the second largest sanctuary located in Himachal Pradesh.
- It houses the famous Manimahesh temple, an attraction to thousands of pilgrims despite the difficult terrain and extreme cold conditions.

51. Navegaon-Nagzira Tiger Reserve was declared a tiger reserve in:

- A. 2006
B. 2010
C. 2013
D. 2018

Answer: C

- The Navegaon Nagzira Tiger Reserve (NNTR) in Maharashtra's Gondia will get control of the buffer notified area in its vicinity from April 1.
- Navegaon-Nagzira Tiger Reserve is located in the state of Maharashtra.
- It is located in the heart of the central Indian Tiger Landscape, which contributes almost 1/6 of the total tiger population of the country.
- It was declared a tiger reserve in 2013; it is the fifth tiger reserve in Maharashtra.

Index/rankings/reports

1. Which district secured the first rank in India for awareness activities under the eighth National Nutrition Fortnight campaign?

- A. Pune
B. Nashik
C. Nagpur
D. Ahilyanagar

Answer: d

- **Ahilyanagar district of Maharashtra has secured the first rank in the country** for conducting awareness activities under the eighth National Nutrition Fortnight campaign implemented by the Women and Child Development Department.
- **The district has recorded a total of 324,075 activities so far.**

2. According to the State of India's Bats (Solbats) 2024-25 report, which state recorded the highest bat diversity in India?

- A. Meghalaya
B. Assam
C. West Bengal
D. Kerala

Answer: C

- The first-ever national assessment, State of India's Bats (Solbats) 2024-25, has flagged
- a critical data deficit and research neglect despite bats being the largest order of mammals in the country.
- It is India's first comprehensive national-level assessment of bat species, conducted by the Nature Conservation Foundation (NCF) and Bat Conservation International (BCI).
- The report aims to map the diversity, distribution, and conservation status of bats to provide a baseline for future environmental.
- **West Bengal (68 species) and Meghalaya (66 species) have the highest bat diversity in India.**
- While caves and trees remain primary natural roosts, bats are increasingly utilizing man-made structures like dilapidated buildings and government monuments.

3. According to the Bloomberg Billionaires Index, _____ has become the richest individual in Asia and is ranked _____ globally.

- A. Mukesh Ambani – 10th
B. Gautam Adani – 19th
C. Ratan Tata – 25th
D. Azim Premji – 15th

Answer: B

- Gautam Adani has moved ahead of Mukesh Ambani to become the richest individual in Asia, according to the latest update from the Bloomberg Billionaires Index.
- Adani, Founder-Chairman, Adani Group, now placed 19th in the global list with a net worth of \$92.6 billion.
- **On the global stage, Elon Musk continues to dominate the rankings**, retaining the top position with an estimated net worth of \$656 billion.

4. Which of the following states emerged as top performers in the Panchayat Advancement Index (PAI) 2.0?

1. Tripura
2. Kerala
3. Odisha
4. Gujarat

Select the correct answer:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1, 2 and 3 only
- C. 2 and 4 only
- D. 1, 3 and 4 only

Answer: B

- **The Ministry of Panchayati Raj** released the Panchayat Advancement Index (PAI) 2.0 Report for 2023–24 on National Panchayati Raj Day.
- **State Level Performance: Top Performers – Tripura, Kerala and Odisha.**
- **Zero Achievers (A+): Nationally, zero Gram Panchayats** achieved the Achiever (Grade A+) status, which requires a composite score of 90 and above.

5. According to the latest SIPRI report, India ranked _____ in global defence spending in 2025.

- A. Third
- B. Fourth
- C. Fifth
- D. Sixth

Answer: C

- **India ranked as the world's fifth-largest defence spender in 2025**, according to the latest report by the Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI).
- **SIPRI stands for Stockholm International Peace Research Institute and is based in Sweden.**

6. The FAO Food Price Index measures:

- A. Annual change in domestic food prices
- B. Monthly change in international food commodity prices
- C. Inflation rate of agricultural products in India

D. Global GDP growth related to agriculture

Answer: B

- Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) Food Price Index rose in March 2026, largely due to higher energy costs linked to the escalating conflict in the Middle East
- It is a measure of the monthly change in international prices of a basket of food commodities.
- It consists of the average of five commodity group price indices (cereal, vegetable, dairy, meat and sugar), weighted with the average export shares.

7. Base year: 2014-16.

The Annual Survey of Incorporated Services Sector Enterprises (ASISSE) has been launched by:

- A. Reserve Bank of India
- B. National Statistics Office
- C. NITI Aayog
- D. Ministry of Finance

Answer: B

- Recently, the National Statistics Office (NSO) has launched the first-ever Annual Survey of Incorporated Services Sector Enterprises (ASISSE).
- Alongside the survey, the NSO has also released a user-friendly guide titled "Know Your Survey: A User Guide to ASISSE" to enhance awareness and participation.
- It is launched by the National Statistics Office, under the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI).

8. Arrange the following countries in descending order of renewable energy installed capacity (highest to lowest):

India
China
United States

Select the correct answer using the code below:

- A. 2 – 3 – 1
- B. 3 – 2 – 1
- C. 2 – 1 – 3
- D. 3 – 1 – 2

Answer: A

- India has climbed to the 3rd position globally in renewable energy (RE) installed capacity, surpassing Brazil, according to the Union Ministry of New and Renewable Energy.
- Key Data / Stats:
- Global Rank: 3rd (after China and United States)

- India has emerged as the third-largest country in the world in renewable energy installed capacity, reflecting rapid progress in green infrastructure.

International

1. Scarborough Shoal is disputed between:

- A. China and Vietnam
- B. China and Philippines
- C. Philippines and Malaysia
- D. China and Japan

Answer: B

- China is employing ships and a barrier to tighten control of the entrance to the Scarborough Shoal in the South China Sea amid roiling tension with the Philippines over the disputed feature.
- Scarborough Shoal is a disputed atoll in the South China Sea, claimed by both China and the Philippines as part of their territory.**

2. The Druzhba Pipeline was built by which of the following?

- A. European Union
- B. United States
- C. Soviet Union
- D. China

Answer: C.

- The Druzhba pipeline that carries Russian oil through Ukraine to Hungary and Slovakia has been repaired and can resume operations, the Ukrainian President has announced recently, ending a months-long standoff between Kyiv and Budapest.
- The Druzhba Pipeline, also known as the Friendship Pipeline, is one of the biggest crude oil pipeline networks in the world.**
- It was built in the 1960s to supply oil from the USSR to countries in Europe.

4. The archaeological site of Áspero is associated with which of the following civilizations?

- A. Norte Chico civilization
- B. Maya Civilization
- C. Inca Civilization
- D. Aztec Civilization

Answer: A

- Archaeologists in Peru recently **uncovered a structure at Áspero that appears to have been used to observe the sky**, adding detail to what is known about early scientific practices in the Caral Civilisation.
- It is a late preceramic archaeological site associated with the Norte Chico civilization** (also

called Caral-Supe civilization), one of the oldest known civilizations in the Americas.

5. The first India–Africa Forum Summit was held in:

- A. 2005
- B. 2008
- C. 2011
- D. 2015

Answer: B

- India is set to host the Fourth India-Africa Forum Summit (IAFS) 2026 in late May, marking the first such gathering in over a decade since 2015.**
- The India–Africa Forum Summit (IAFS) is the official institutional platform for African-Indian relations. It serves as a high-level consultative mechanism between the Government of India and the member states of the African Union (AU) to promote South-South cooperation.
- Established In:** First Summit: April 4–8, 2008, in New Delhi, India.

6. The headquarters of United Nations Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific (UN ESCAP) is located in:

- A. Manila
- B. Jakarta
- C. Bangkok
- D. Singapore

Answer: C

- UN ESCAP is the most inclusive intergovernmental platform in the Asia-Pacific region and serves as one of the five regional commissions of the United Nations.** It comprises 53 member states and 9 associate members, representing nearly two-thirds of the world's population.
- Established In:** 1947 in Shanghai as the Economic Commission for Asia and the Far East (ECAFE) to aid post-WWII reconstruction.
- Renamed to ESCAP in 1976 to reflect its broader social mandate and relocated its headquarters to Bangkok, Thailand.**

7. The “Snapback Mechanism,” recently seen in news, is associated with:

- A. Paris Climate Agreement
- B. Iran Nuclear Deal (JCPOA)
- C. Missile Technology Control Regime (MTCR)
- D. Nuclear Suppliers Group (NSG)

Answer: B

- The sanctions on Iran have been reimposed via a mechanism known as “snapback” which was

included in the 2015 nuclear deal signed between Iran and the world powers.

- These sanctions come as Iran's economy is already struggling. France, the UK and Germany triggered the re-imposition of sanctions on Iran at the UN Security Council.
- **Snapback Mechanism:** It allows any Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action (JCPOA) participant, to reimpose UN sanctions if Iran commits "significant non-performance."

8. The 'Yellow Line' strategy, recently seen in news, refers to:

- A. A maritime trade corridor in the Mediterranean Sea
- B. A military demarcation and fortified buffer zone used by Israel Defense Forces (IDF)
- C. A peace agreement between Israel and Lebanon
- D. A border fence between Israel and Gaza

Answer: B

- The Israeli government has officially expanded the Yellow Line strategy from the Gaza Strip to southern Lebanon, **establishing a militarized buffer zone that extends up to the Litani River.**
- **The Yellow Line is a specific military demarcation and strategic construct used by the Israel Defense Forces (IDF) to establish a fortified, static buffer zone within hostile territory.**
- Unlike traditional political borders, it serves as a free-fire zone where Israel maintains direct, open-ended military control.

9. Consider the following statements regarding the Yangtze River:

1. It is the longest river in Asia.
2. The Yangtze empties into the East China Sea.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

- China recently completed an 11.18-km-long high-speed underwater tunnel beneath the Yangtze River, **enabling bullet trains to run at speeds of up to 350 kmph.**
- **The Yangtze River, known in China as the Chang Jiang or Yangzi, is the longest river in both China and Asia** and the third-longest river in the world after the Nile River and the Amazon River.

- It is also considered the longest river to exclusively flow within the borders of a single nation.
- The Yangtze empties into the East China Sea near Shanghai in east-central China.

10. The Colorado River originates in the:

- A. Appalachian Mountains
- B. Rocky Mountains
- C. Sierra Nevada
- D. Cascade Range

Answer: B.

- Recently, the mystery of the Colorado River's missing water has finally been solved by scientists from the University of Washington, **revealing a critical shift in the American West's hydrological cycle.**
- It is a **major river of North America.**
- **Origin:** It rises in the Rocky Mountains of Colorado, U.S.

11. The theme of the Indian Ocean Conference 2026 was:

- A. Security and Growth in the Indian Ocean
- B. Collective Stewardship for Indian Ocean Governance
- C. Maritime Cooperation for Blue Economy
- D. Sustainable Oceans for Shared Prosperity

Answer: B.

- **India Foundation, in association with the Government of Mauritius, organised the 9th Indian Ocean Conference—IOC 2026—in Mauritius from April 10 to 12, 2026.**
- **The theme of the conference** was "Collective Stewardship for Indian Ocean Governance."

12. "Pax Silica", recently seen in news, is an initiative led by which country?

- A. Japan
- B. United States
- C. Philippines
- D. South Korea

Answer: B

- The Philippines has joined a United States-led initiative, "Pax Silica", **aimed at securing global semiconductor and technology supply chains.**
- As part of the initiative, the United States and the Philippines will jointly develop a 4,000-acre industrial hub in Luzon.
- The project is expected to be located within the Luzon Economic Corridor, a **key manufacturing**

and logistics region that includes the capital, Manila.

13. Lake Issyk-Kul is located in:

- A. Kazakhstan
- B. Uzbekistan
- C. Kyrgyzstan
- D. Tajikistan

Answer: C

- Underwater archaeologists recently unveiled a hidden city in **Lake Issyk-Kul, revealing a lost civilization from seven hundred years ago.**
- It is **located in northeastern Kyrgyzstan.**
- **The water in the lake is blue and brackish.**

14. The UNESCO Chair on Gender Inclusion and Skill Development has been established at:

- A. Indian Institute of Technology Delhi
- B. Jawaharlal Nehru University
- C. Tata Institute of Social Sciences
- D. Symbiosis Skills and Professional University

Answer: D

- **Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Skill Development & Entrepreneurship and Minister of State for Education Jayant Chaudhary successfully launched the UNESCO Chair on Gender Inclusion and Skill Development**
- **The initiative was part of the International Conference on “Women Leading the Future of Work” organised in collaboration with UNESCO at Symbiosis Skills and Professional University (SSPU), Pune**

15. The Luzon Strait separates Luzon Island from:

- A. Japan
- B. Indonesia
- C. Malaysia
- D. Taiwan

Answer: D

- **China’s military Southern Theater Command recently conducted live-fire drills, rapid maneuvers, and sea-air coordination exercises in waters east of Luzon Island**
- **Luzon is the largest and most economically significant island in the Philippine archipelago.**
- **It is situated in the northern part of the Philippines, bounded by the Philippine Sea to the east, the South China Sea to the west, and the Luzon Strait to the north, which separates it from Taiwan.**

16. The Bnei Menashe community is primarily associated with which Indian states?

- A. Nagaland and Assam
- B. Mizoram and Manipur
- C. Tripura and Meghalaya
- D. Arunachal Pradesh and Sikkim

Answer: B

- **The Government of India’s advisory about the security situation in Israel, amid the ongoing war in West Asia, came into focus recently when Israel airlifted around 240 individuals from Mizoram to Tel Aviv as part of Israel’s ‘Operation Wings of Dawn’.**
- **The Bnei Menashe, known in India as the Shinlung, is an ethnic community that hails from the northeastern states of Mizoram and Manipur.**

17. The Chernobyl nuclear power plant was located in:

- A. Russia
- B. Belarus
- C. Ukraine
- D. Kazakhstan

Answer: C

- **The world marks the 40th anniversary of the Chernobyl disaster, which remains the most expensive man-made catastrophe in history with costs exceeding \$700 billion.**
- **The Chernobyl disaster is the worst accident in the history of nuclear power generation.**
- **It involved a catastrophic meltdown and explosions at Unit 4 of the Chernobyl nuclear power station, located near the industrial town of Pripyat in the former Soviet Union (now Ukraine).**

18. The world’s first permanent underground repository for highly radioactive nuclear waste (Onkalo facility) is being operationalised by:

- A. Finland
- B. Sweden
- C. France
- D. Canada

Answer: A

- **Finland is preparing to operationalise the world’s first permanent underground repository (the Onkalo facility) for highly radioactive nuclear waste.**
- **Located beneath Olkiluoto Island, the Onkalo facility is designed to safely store spent nuclear fuel for up to 100,000 years.**

19. Tuvalu is situated approximately between:

- A. India and Australia
- B. Australia and Hawaii
- C. Japan and Philippines
- D. USA and Canada

Answer: B

- As the Pacific island nation of Tuvalu battles rising sea levels that threaten to put large parts of the island entirely underwater by the end of this century, its citizens are making efforts to safeguard their future while preparing for the worst impacts of climate change.
- Tuvalu, formerly known as the Ellice Islands, is a Polynesian island country in the west-central Pacific Ocean.
- It sits about halfway between Australia and Hawaii.

20. Consider the following statements regarding the Atacama Desert:

1. It is the driest desert in the world.
2. It lies between the Andes Mountains and the Pacific Ocean.
3. It is rich in coal deposits.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- **Location:** It is the driest desert in the world, located in northern Chile.
- **It is nestled between the Andes Mountains on the east and the Pacific Ocean on the west.**
- It forms a continuous strip for nearly 1,000 km along the narrow coast of the northern third of Chile.
- **Bordered by:** It is bordered by Argentina, Peru, and Bolivia

21. Recently, which country has announced its exit from the Organisation of the Petroleum Exporting Countries and OPEC+ effective May 1, 2026?

- A. Qatar
- B. Abu Dhabi
- C. Nigeria
- D. United Arab Emirates

Answer: D

- The United Arab Emirates has announced it will exit the Organisation of the Petroleum Exporting Countries and the broader OPEC+ alliance, with the decision taking effect from May 1, 2026.

- It is a permanent intergovernmental organization of oil-exporting countries.
- It was established in 1960 by the five founding members Iran, Iraq, Kuwait, Saudi Arabia, and Venezuela.

22. Pompeii, recently in news due to AI-based reconstruction, is located in:

- A. Greece
- B. Turkey
- C. Spain
- D. Italy

Answer: d

- AI has helped archaeologists at Pompeii reconstruct the face and final moments of a man killed during the AD 79 eruption of Mount Vesuvius.
- It is a preserved ancient Roman city located near modern-day Naples, Italy.
- It lies at the southeastern base of Mount Vesuvius.

23. Which country is hosting the 2026 Defence Ministers' meeting of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation?

- A. Kyrgyzstan
- B. Uzbekistan
- C. Kazakhstan
- D. Tajikistan

Answer: A

- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh will visit Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, on April 27–28 to participate in the Defence Ministers' meeting of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO).
- The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation was founded in 2001 and focuses on political, economic, and security cooperation.
- India and Pakistan became full members of the SCO in 2017.

24. A Currency Swap Arrangement between two countries refers to:

- A. Permanent exchange of currencies for trade settlement
- B. Agreement to exchange currencies with predetermined terms and conditions
- C. Loan agreement in domestic currency only
- D. Barter trade mechanism

Answer: B

What is the Currency Swap Arrangement?

- The word swap means exchange.
- A currency swap between two countries is an agreement or contract to exchange

currencies with predetermined terms and conditions.

- The facility is to provide swap support as an **alternative source of funding for short-term foreign exchange liquidity requirements.**

25. DataKaveri Systems is associated with:

- A. Defence manufacturing
- B. Smart city data platforms
- C. Space exploration
- D. Banking regulation

Answer: B

- India and Japan have signed a major Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to incorporate **construction data in the urban AI systems, enhancing the development of smart cities in both countries.**
- This agreement was declared during the outer venues of the first **Japan-India AI Strategic Dialogue, and it connects Japanese openBIM standards with the Indian platform of IUDX.**
- **The initiative aims to improve** how construction data is used in smart city planning and digital governance.
- **DataKaveri Systems is the commercial arm of IISc Bengaluru's Centre of Data for Public Good.**

26. The term "Komorebi," recently seen in news, refers to:

- A. A traditional festival
- B. Sunlight filtering through tree leaves
- C. A poetic literary form
- D. A meditation practice

Answer: B

- The Japanese word Komorebi has recently gone viral globally, trending across social media platforms for its poetic expression of sunlight filtering through tree leaves.
- Komorebi is a beautiful Japanese word that refers to the dappled sunlight that passes through the leaves and branches of trees.
- It reflects the close relationship between language and natural surroundings in Japanese culture.

27. The city of _____ has become the first in the United States to host a life-size statue of Swami Vivekananda.

- A. New York
- B. Chicago
- C. Seattle
- D. San Francisco

Answer: C

- City of Seattle has become the first city government in the United States to host a life-size statue of Swami Vivekananda at Westlake Square Park.
- The life-size bronze statue was jointly unveiled by Seattle Mayor Katie Wilson and the Consul General of India in Seattle.

28. The term "Axis of Autocracy," seen in international relations discourse, is often used to refer to which of the following countries?

- (a) Russia and China
- (b) United States and Israel
- (c) United States and China
- (d) Israel and Iran

Answer: a

- China, Russia, and Iran are regarded as part of the "Axis of Autocracy," a term used in Washington policy circles to refer to the strategic alignment of authoritarian states.
- This term is often seen in the news, especially in the context of the ongoing conflict.
- Recently, it came into focus again when, a day before the ceasefire was announced, China and Russia, Iran's key strategic allies, vetoed a United Nations Security Council (UNSC) resolution aimed at enhancing security and protecting commercial shipping in the Strait of Hormuz.

29. The Chagos Islands are located in which ocean?

- A. Atlantic Ocean
- B. Pacific Ocean
- C. Indian Ocean
- D. Arctic Ocean

Answer: C

- Recently, Britain's government said that it had put on hold its deal to cede sovereignty of the Chagos Islands.
- Chagos Islands Location: It is an island group located in the central Indian Ocean.
- It is about 1,000 miles (1,600 km) south of the southern tip of the Indian subcontinent.
- It is an overseas territory of the United Kingdom that was established on November 8, 1965

30. The "Madman Theory" in international relations means:

- A. A policy of peaceful talks
- B. A method of using economic penalties
- C. A theory about global cooperation
- D. A strategy where a leader acts unpredictable to scare opponents

Answer: d

- The Madman Theory has returned to global strategic discourse amid debates over the foreign policy posture of Donald Trump during the ongoing West Asia crisis.
- The Madman Theory is a foreign policy and strategic doctrine in which a leader deliberately cultivates an image of being unpredictable, irrational, or willing to take extreme action.
- The aim is to make adversaries believe that escalation—including war or even nuclear confrontation—is possible, thereby forcing concessions.

31. Which of the following rivers is associated with Angola?

- A. Nile
- B. Congo
- C. Cuanza
- D. Zambezi

Answer: C

- Angola emerges as an important alternative to West Asia in gas supplies to India
- Location: It is located on the southwestern Atlantic Coast of Africa.
- Maritime Boundary: It shares a border with the Atlantic Ocean.
- Capital City: Luanda
- Major rivers: Cuango River and Cuanza River, vital for hydropower and inland water transport

32. The United Nations Development Partnership Fund (India–UN Fund) was established in:

- A. 2015
- B. 2017
- C. 2019
- D. 2021

Answer: B

- Recently, the Indian Permanent Mission to New York with the board of directors of the United Nations Development Partnership Fund reviewed the whole gamut of the fund's operations.
- It was established in 2017, with \$150 million, led by the Government of India.
- The Fund supports Southern-owned and -led, demand-driven and transformational sustainable development projects across the developing world.

33. Denis Manturov recently in news is:

- A. Foreign Minister of China
- B. Defence Minister of India

- C. National Security Advisor of USA
- D. Deputy Prime Minister of Russia

Answer: D

- Russia's First Deputy Prime Minister Denis Manturov visited India on 2nd- 3rd April, 2026.
 - The Russian First Deputy PM's visit to New Delhi comes days after India cleared procurement of a fresh batch of five S-400 missile systems from Russia.

34. Consider the following countries:

1. Mali
2. Niger
3. Ghana
4. Nigeria

Which of the above share a border with Burkina Faso?

- A. 1, 2 and 3 only
- B. 2, 3 and 4 only
- C. 1 and 4 only
- D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

Answer: A

- Burkina Faso is a landlocked country in western Africa.
- **Bordering countries:** It shares its borders with six other nations: Mali to the north and west, Niger to the east, and Benin to the southeast, while to the south it touches Togo, Ghana, and Ivory Coast.
- **Capital City:** Ouagadougou

35. Lake Neuchâtel, recently seen in news, is located in:

- A. France
- B. Switzerland
- C. Germany
- D. Austria

Answer: B

- Lake Neuchâtel is the largest lake entirely within Switzerland.
- It is nestled at the foot of the Jura Mountains.

36. Who composed the Shikshapatri?

- A. Dayanand Saraswati
- B. Sahajanand Swami
- C. Ramanujacharya
- D. Swami Vivekananda

Answer: B

- The Bodleian Libraries at the University of Oxford have launched a **nationwide UK tour of the Shikshapatri to mark its 200th anniversary.**
- The Shikshapatri is one of the most significant and rare Hindu scriptures. Shikshapatri, which means

a letter of teachings was **composed in 1826 at Vadtal in Gujarat by Sahajanand Swami.**

- Organised in collaboration with leaders of the Swaminarayan faith, the **tour will showcase the manuscript in major temples, offering thousands the chance to view the sacred text that emphasises ethical living and spiritual guidance.**

37. Which country has recently completed its withdrawal from the World Health Organization (WHO)?

- A. Brazil
- B. Chile
- C. Argentina
- D. Mexico

Answer: c

- Argentina has officially completed its withdrawal from the World Health Organization (WHO), effective March 2026, following a one-year notification period initiated by President Javier Milei's administration.
- The WHO is a specialized agency of the United Nations responsible for international public health. It acts as a coordinating authority on global health work, setting norms and standards while providing technical support to countries.
- Established in: It was founded on April 7, 1948.

38. Consider the following statements regarding the United Nations Security Council:

- It consists of 15 members.
- All members have veto power.
- Non-permanent members are elected for two-year terms.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 2 only
- C. 1 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- India's Permanent Representative to the UN, asserted **that any UNSC reform without expanding permanent membership and granting veto power would only perpetuate existing imbalances.**

Structure and Membership

- The UNSC consists of 15 members, each having one vote.
- Five permanent members (P5) with veto power:

- China, France, Russia, the United Kingdom, and the United States.
- Ten non-permanent members, elected by the UN General Assembly for two-year terms, with equitable geographical representation:
 - 5 from Africa/Asia, 1 from Eastern Europe, 2 from Latin America, and 2 from Western Europe/others
- The UNSC is headquartered at the United Nations Headquarters in New York City.
- UNSC Reform Proposal (2024)
- Proposed by: G4 Nations (India, Brazil, Germany, Japan)

Sports

National/ international Championships

1. Consider the following statements regarding the Khelo India Tribal Games (KITG) 2026:

Karnataka topped the medal tally with 28 gold medals.

"Morveer" is the official mascot of the Khelo India Tribal Games 2026.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

- Karnataka emerged as the overall champion at the inaugural Khelo India Tribal Games (KITG) 2026, while host state Chhattisgarh finished ninth in the final medal tally.
- Mascot: "Morveer" is the official mascot of the Khelo India Tribal Games 2026.
- Champion: Karnataka secured the top position in the medal tally with 23 gold, 8 silver and 7 bronze medals (Total: 38).

2. The medal tally of Indian Greco-Roman wrestlers at the Asian Wrestling Championships 2026 includes:

- A. 1 silver, 4 bronze
- B. 2 silver, 3 bronze
- C. 3 silver, 2 bronze
- D. 2 gold, 3 bronze

Answer: B

- Indian Greco-Roman wrestlers win five medals at Asian Wrestling Championships 2026 in Bishkek
- Indian Greco-Roman wrestlers finished the continental championship with a rich haul of five medals - two silver, three bronze.

3. Which of the following correctly represents India's medal tally at the World Archery Para Series 2026?

- A. 7 Gold, 5 Silver, 4 Bronze
- B. 6 Gold, 4 Silver, 3 Bronze
- C. 7 Gold, 2 Silver, 4 Bronze
- D. 8 Gold, 3 Silver, 2 Bronze

Answer: A

- The inaugural World Archery Para Series held in Bangkok, Thailand (concluded 4 April 2026),
- India finished on top with an overwhelming seven gold.
- Overall, India won 16 medals - seven gold, five silver and four bronze.

4. How many total medals did India win across men's and women's categories at the Asian Boxing Championships 2026?

- A. 10
- B. 12
- C. 14
- D. 16

Answer: D

- 2026 Asian Boxing Championships - Vishvanath Suresh won the 50kg title at the Asian Boxing Championships 2026 in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia, as Indian men concluded their campaign at the continental meet with a total of six medals - one gold, a silver and four bronze.
- The Indian boxing squad finished second on the table with five golds, one fewer than Kazakhstan.

Cricket

1. Who was named the ICC Men's Player of the Month for March 2026?

- A. Virat Kohli
- B. Rohit Sharma
- C. Sanju Samson
- D. Shubman Gill

Answer: C

- Sanju Samson named ICC men's Player of the Month for March, New Zealand's Amelia Kerr have been named the ICC Women's Player of the Month for March 2026

Chess

1. Aronyak Ghosh, recently seen in the news, became India's:

- A. 90th Grandmaster (GM)
- B. 93rd Grandmaster (GM)
- C. 95th Grandmaster (GM)
- D. 100th Grandmaster (GM)

Answer: C

- Aronyak Ghosh becomes India's 95th Grandmaster

2. Which Indian Grandmaster won the FIDE Women's Candidates Tournament 2026?

- A. Koneru Humpy
- B. D. Harika
- C. Tania Sachdev
- D. R. Vaishali

Answer: D

- In chess, India's Grandmaster R. Vaishali won the FIDE Women's Candidates Tournament 2026 in Cyprus and qualify for the World Chess Championship.

3. Bodhana Sivanandan represents which country in international chess?

- A. England B. India
- C. USA D. Australia

Answer: A

- Indian-origin chess prodigy Bodhana Sivanandan has become England's top-rated female player, according to the latest rating list of the International Chess Federation (FIDE).
- moved from Tiruchirappalli in Tamil Nadu to England in 2007, has 2366 FIDE rating points.

Hockey

1. Which team won the 16th Hockey India Sub-Junior Women's National Championship?

- A. Hockey Jharkhand B. Hockey Haryana
- C. Hockey Odisha D. Hockey Punjab

Answer: a

- **Hockey Jharkhand** continued its dominance at the grassroots level by clinching the 16th Hockey India sub-junior women's National championship, marking a third consecutive title (2024, 2025, 2026)
- The **State has secured an impressive 34 medals** in women's competitions alone, including 10 gold, 11 silver and 13 bronze medals.

2. Which of the following correctly describes India's medal tally at the ISSF Junior World Cup 2026?

- A. 5 Gold, 5 Silver, 6 Bronze
- B. 6 Gold, 5 Silver, 5 Bronze
- C. 5 Gold, 6 Silver, 5 Bronze
- D. 6 Gold, 6 Silver, 4 Bronze

Answer: C

- Indian shooters topped the standings at the ISSF Junior World Cup 2026 in Cairo, Egypt, with a rich haul of 16 medals - five gold, six silver and five bronze .

- Hemant Burman won silver in the men's 50 metre rifle 3 positions event

3. Which country hosted the World Masters Sports Championships 2026?

- A. India B. China
C. Thailand D. Indonesia

Answer: C

- The World Masters Sports Championships 2026 held in Sriracha, Thailand, from 17th to 20th April 2026.

4. Who became the youngest player to complete 1,000 runs in T20 cricket?

- A. Mitchell Owen B. Chris Gayle
C. Vaibhav Suryavanshi D. Virat Kohli

Answer: C

- Vaibhav Suryavanshi became the youngest player, and the fastest by balls faced, to complete 1,000 runs in Twenty20 cricket as the 15-year-old smashed a 36-ball century in the Indian Premier League
- 36-ball century in the Indian Premier League was the third fastest in IPL history, after Chris Gayle's 30-ball ton in 2013 and Suryavanshi's own 35-ball hundred last year.

5. KL Rahul became the _____ cricketer to score 150 in IPL history and registered the _____ individual score by an Indian in the league.

- A. second, lowest
B. third, highest
C. fourth, highest
D. third, lowest

Answer: B

- KL Rahul, become the third cricketer to hit 150 runs in tournament history and registering the highest individual score by an Indian player in the IPL.
- After Chris Gayle (175 against Pune Warriors India in 2013) and Brendon McCullum (158* against Royal Challengers Bengaluru in 2008), **KL is the third batsman to score 150 runs in a single IPL inning.**

Grand prix

1. Who won the Spanish Grand Prix 2026?

- A. Fabio Quartararo
B. Francesco Bagnaia
C. Marc Marquez
D. Jorge Martin

Answer: C

Football

Which team won the AFC Champions League 2026 ?

- A. Al-Ittihad
B. Al-Ahli
C. Machida Zelvia
D. Urawa Red Diamonds

Answer: B

Al-Ahli Saudi FC Defend AFC Champions League Elite Title with 1–0 Win over Machida Zelvia

- In football, Al-Ahli of Saudi Arabia successfully defended the AFC Champions League 2026 Elite crown after beating first-time finalist Machida Zelvia of Japan

Miscellaneous

1. What is 'Operation Upstream'?

- A. A joint CBI-WADA action plan to curb anti-doping activities
B. A national scheme to promote sports nutrition among athletes
C. A programme to modernize sports training centres
D. An initiative to increase athlete participation in international events

Answer: A

- Operation Upstream, a joint CBI-WADA action plan, will target supply chains that move prohibited performance-enhancing drugs, and punish coaches, physios of doping athletes.
- Currently, India is the country with the most number of dope offenders in the WADA list of suspended athletes from 2024.

2. Who became the first athlete to run a marathon under 2 hours (non-record conditions)?

- A. Sebastian Sawe
B. Kelvin Kiptum
C. Eliud Kipchoge
D. Mo Farah

Answer: C

- Sebastian Sawe made history at the London Marathon by becoming the first athlete to run a sub-two-hour marathon in a competitive race.
- **The 31-year-old Kenyan crossed the line to win in one hour 59 minutes 30 seconds, more than one minute faster than the late Kelvin Kiptum's previous record .**

3. The 25th All India Police Water Sports Cluster Championship is being hosted by:

- A. Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF)
B. Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP)
C. Border Security Force (BSF)
D. Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB)

Answer: B

- The 25th All India **Police Water Sports Cluster Championship will begin at Tehri Lake in Uttarakhand.**
- Organised under the aegis of the Indo-Tibetan Border Police, **the event will continue until April 12.**
- In this national-level championship, more **than 440 athletes from 19 police** teams across the country are participating.

4. Rupa Bayor is associated with which sport?

- A. Boxing
- B. Judo
- C. Karate
- D. Taekwondo

Answer: D

- Rupa Bayor from Arunachal Pradesh has become the first Indian Taekwondo athlete to achieve World Taekwondo (WT) World Ranking No. 5
- She previously made history as the first Indian to reach World Rank 6 and Asia Rank 1.

5. Who broke the late Shivrath Singh's marathon record of 2:12:00 set in 1978 at the NN Marathon Rotterdam?

- A. Avinash Sable
- B. Gopi Thonakal
- C. Sawan Barwal
- D. Neeraj Chopra

Answer: C

- At the NN Marathon Rotterdam, a World Athletics Gold Label Road Race, the 28-year-old Army havildar Sawan Barwal from Mandi in Himachal Pradesh, clocked 2 hours 11 minutes and 58 seconds to break the late Shivrath Singh's marathon record of 2:12:00 set in 1978.
- India's oldest athletic record was broken by the long-distance runner making his debut in the marathon.

Banking / finance

1. In **April 2026**, the Union Cabinet approved an increase in Dearness Allowance (DA) and Dearness Relief (DR) for Central Government employees and pensioners by:

- A. 1%
- B. 2%
- C. 3%
- D. 5%

Answer: B

- The Union Cabinet chaired by the Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi has approved to release an additional instalment of Dearness Allowance (DA) to Central Government employees and Dearness Relief (DR) to pensioners w.e.f. 01.01.2026 **representing an increase of 2% over the existing rate of 58% of the Basic Pay/Pension, to compensate against price rise.**
- The combined impact on the exchequer on account of increase in both Dearness Allowance and Dearness Relief would be Rs.6791.24 crore per annum.

2. Borrowers' Platform is primarily aimed at:

- A. Negotiating collective debt restructuring
- B. Strengthening debt management among developing countries
- C. Regulating global trade disputes
- D. Financing climate adaptation projects

Answer: B

- Recently, **developing countries have launched the first-ever Borrowers' Platform at the International Monetary Fund (IMF)-World Bank Spring Meetings 2026.**
- Borrowers' Platform is a dedicated space **enabling developing countries that are borrowers to come together, share knowledge, exchange experiences and speak collectively on debt issues.**
- It brings together finance ministers and central bank governors from developing countries to strengthen debt management capacity, enhance coordination and amplify their collective voice in global debt discussions.

3. According to the latest estimates by the International Monetary Fund, India's rank in global GDP (2025–26) is:

- A. 4th
- B. 5th
- C. 6th
- D. 7th

Answer: C

- India has slipped to the 6th spot in global GDP rankings, according to the most recent estimates by the International Monetary Fund (IMF) for 2025–26.

- The Indian economy is estimated at \$3.92 trillion in 2025, placing it behind the UK (\$4 trillion) and Japan (\$4.44 trillion).

4. The “Super Sales Saathi” app has been released by which organization?

- A. State Bank of India
- B. Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India
- C. Life Insurance Corporation of India
- D. Securities and Exchange Board of India

Answer: C

- Life Insurance Corporation of India has launched two new mobile applications — MyLIC and Super Sales Saathi — **to strengthen customer service and digital accessibility in the insurance sector.**
- MyLIC is a customer-centric app that integrates policy management, claims, payments, loans, and e-KYC into one platform.
- **Super Sales Saathi is a dedicated app for LIC’s agents and intermediaries, enabling digital sales, customer servicing, and performance monitoring.**

5. Mission SAKSHAM has been launched by:

- A. Ministry of Finance
- B. NABARD (National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development)
- C. Reserve Bank of India (Reserve Bank of India)
- D. SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board of India)

Answer: C.

- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has launched Mission SAKSHAM for capacity building of the Urban Co-operative Banking sector.
- It aims to enhance managerial and operational capabilities, improve compliance culture, and strengthen institutional resilience across UCBs.

6. PaRRVA has been operationalised by:

- A. Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
- B. Ministry of Finance, Government of India
- C. NITI Aayog
- D. Securities and Exchange Board of India

Answer: D

- SEBI has operationalised the Past Risk and Return Verification Agency (PaRRVA), which will commence full-scale operations on May 4, 2026, following a successful pilot phase.
- A dedicated agency and data infrastructure designed to validate and authenticate the past performance metrics (risk and return) of regulated market entities.
- **Launched By:** The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI).

7. The primary purpose of E-PRAAPTI is to:

- A. Provide pension to employees
- B. Link bank accounts with Aadhaar
- C. Identify and link old EPF accounts with UAN
- D. Manage stock market investments

Answer: C

- The Employees’ Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) is set to launch E-PRAAPTI, a dedicated digital platform designed to help members identify, track, and link old, inoperative EPF accounts with their Universal Account Number (UAN).
- E-PRAAPTI is a streamlined digital solution developed to bridge the gap between physical-mode legacy accounts and the current digital UAN ecosystem.

8. Consider the following statements regarding the Reserve Bank of India (RBI):

1. RBI was established based on the recommendations of the Hilton Young Commission.
2. On April 1, 1935, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) was established.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

- On April 1, 1935, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) was established in accordance with the provisions of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934.
- It is responsible for monetary stability, currency management, inflation targeting, regulating the banking system, and setting interest rates.
- It was set up on the basis of the recommendations of the Royal Commission on Indian Currency (Hilton Young Commission) which was set up in 1926. It recommended establishing a central bank to be called the ‘Reserve Bank of India’.

9. India’s foreign exchange reserves include which of the following?

1. Foreign Currency Assets (FCA)
2. Gold
3. Special Drawing Rights (SDRs)
4. Reserve Tranche Position (RTP) in IMF

Select the correct answer:

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1, 2, 3 and 4
- D. 1 and 4 only

Answer: C

- Foreign exchange reserves are an important component of the Balance of Payment (BoP) and an essential element in the analysis of an economy's external position.
- In times of crisis, adequate foreign exchange reserves give comfort, acting as a buffer and giving strength to a country's macroeconomic fundamentals.
- The RBI has the primary responsibility of collection, compilation and dissemination of data relating to foreign exchange reserves.
- India's foreign exchange reserves comprise foreign currency assets (FCA), gold, special drawing rights (SDRs) and reserve tranche position (RTP) in the International Monetary Fund (IMF).

10. Consider the following statements:

1. bob SAMVAD is an AI-powered conversational platform.
2. It aims to eliminate language barriers in banking services.
3. It is designed only for online banking users.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 only
- C. 1 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- Bank of Baroda (Bank) unveiled its bob SAMVAD, in Mumbai .
- The platform is an industry-first AI-powered multilingual conversational platform aimed at transforming customer interactions at its branches.
- Designed to eliminate language barriers, the platform enables customers and branch staff to communicate seamlessly with each other in their preferred language.

11. In the April 2026 Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) meeting, the RBI kept the repo rate unchanged at:

- A. 5.00%
- B. 5.25%

C. 5.50%

D. 4.75%

Answer: B

- RBI MPC Meeting 2026 Highlights: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) announced its monetary policy decision, 8 April 2026
- The RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra-led **Monetary Policy Committee (MPC)** held its first bi-monthly policy meeting for FY27 from April 6 to April 8
- The RBI's rate setting panel - **Monetary Policy Committee (MPC)** - kept repo rates unchanged at 5.25%, and maintained policy stance at 'Neutral'.

12. Consider the following statements regarding Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY) loan categories:

1. Shishu category provides loans up to ₹50,000.
2. Kishore category covers loans from ₹50,000 to ₹5 lakh.
3. Tarun category provides loans above ₹20 lakh.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY) is a flagship initiative by the Government of India that was launched in 2015 and aimed at providing affordable credit to micro and small enterprises.
- **Loan amount: Up to ₹20 lakh for non-farm income-generating activities in sectors such as manufacturing, processing, trading, and services.**
- **Categories of Loans:**
- **Shishu: Loans up to ₹50,000, aimed at new and micro enterprises.**
- **Kishore: Loans ranging from ₹50,000 to ₹5 lakh, for businesses in the growth phase.**
- **Tarun: Loans from ₹5 lakh to ₹10 lakh, for businesses looking to expand further.**
- **Tarun Plus: Loans from ₹10 lakh to ₹20 lakh, for those who have successfully repaid previous loans under the "Tarun" category.**

13. A bonus issue of shares refers to:

- A. Issue of shares at a discount to new investors
- B. Issue of shares only to promoters
- C. Buyback of shares by the company

D. Free additional shares given to existing shareholders

Answer: D

- India's largest insurer, Life Insurance Corporation of India, recently announced the first ever bonus issue.
- A bonus issue, also known as a scrip issue or a capitalization issue, occurs when a company listed on a stock exchange decides to offer free additional shares to the existing shareholders.
- The company decides the number of bonus shares to be allotted to every individual investor for holding a certain number of shares over a set period of time and accordingly rewards them.

C. A tax on farm produce

D. A tax imposed only during economic slowdown

Answer: a

- A windfall tax is a higher tax rate levied by the government on specific industries or companies when they experience unexpected, outsized profits—often referred to as windfall gains—due to favorable external conditions rather than their own business maneuvers or investments.
- In the energy sector, these gains typically occur when global geopolitical tensions drive up crude oil and fuel prices.

14. Windfall tax is best described as:

- A. A higher tax on unexpected profits due to external factors
- B. A tax on normal business income